

Jo and Simon's life is turned upside down when Jo's ex-husband comes out of prison, wanting to be a part of Jo's life again. A series of events changes the couple's dynamic forever and it goes from her criminal ex being imprisoned, to Simon being the one 'locked up'...

THE CUCKOLD
COLLECTION

Locked Up

PAUL
GARLAND

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The Cuckold Collection

Early in 2020, I decided to start a new series of original stories, focusing more on the ‘cuckolding’ types of relationship rather than just the ‘hotwife’ aspect, which my ‘No Angels’ and ‘Cerulean Erotica Presents’ series explored, albeit more ambiguously in some books than in others.

I came up with six different themes that I wanted to explore and after I completed the first book, ‘Size Matters,’ a friend of mine inspired another story and so ‘Ex Appeal’ became the second in the series. The third book, ‘Dark Curiosity’ was inspired by a true story a friend told me and now I’ve written the fourth story, my longest date to date: *Locked Up*. This one is the closest I’ve come to writing a ‘bully’ story and also explores the theme of enforced chastity. I really hope you enjoy this new story as much as I enjoyed writing it.

If you’re not already aware of my other books, feel free to check out my other series; ‘No Angels’ (six novels and two novelettes), ‘Cerulean Erotica Presents’ and ‘Sexy Season Shorts’, all available from your favourite digital eBook retailers.

Thanks for reading!

Chapter 1

“No way,” I said, as I switched off the alarm. “It can’t be seven o’clock already.”

I looked at the time on the clock next to the bed. The red numbers glowed smugly in the darkness of the bedroom.

7.00 AM.

“It feels like I’ve barely slept,” I moaned, swinging my legs out of the warm bed into the cool air of the freezing-cold bedroom. “I put my head on the pillow, then boom! Time to get up.”

“I slept fine,” Joanne said, pushing herself up into a sitting position behind me.

I turned to look at my gorgeous wife who was pushing her curly dark hair out of her eyes before trying to rub the sleep out of them. We’d been together for fifteen years - since we were both in our mid-twenties - and married for almost ten, but my attraction to Jo hadn’t dwindled in that time at all. I loved her pretty blue eyes, her brunette mop of curly hair, her loud laugh and her awkward smile. When we first met, she was slimmer, but even now, curvier than she’d been back then, I still loved her body. Her breasts had been bigger than a handful back then, but now they were even larger and drew the eye of many passing strangers anywhere we went.

“You always sleep fine,” I grumbled. It was true. Jo was one of those lucky people that seemed to always sleep like a baby.

“Why don’t you come back to bed for half an hour?” she said softly, pulling the covers back and patting the bed next to her. “Let me wake you up properly.”

“That sounds tempting,” I smiled. “But I have to get up. We’ve got to clean the beer lines, remember?”

We’d recently become the managers of a pub, the Rose and Crown, and today was our regular cleaning day. It was a job that took several hours, so we had to get up early enough to have the lines cleaned ready for our first lunchtime customers.

“How about I clean *your* lines out instead?” Jo suggested with a mischievous grin.

“That sounds even more tempting,” I laughed, then laid back onto the bed next to her and watched as she lifted the silky white nightshirt up and over her head, revealing her gorgeous round, pale breasts with her large pink nipples, puckered and stiff in the cool bedroom air.

I felt the cold too as she tugged down my boxer shorts and took my cock in one hand, rolling the skin back and forth, teasing it to hardness. Then she slid her body over mine, reaching down between her legs to guide me inside her.

Jo kissed me as she began to rock her hips up and down, sliding me in and out of her. I loved it when she got on top of me like this. It was a favourite position of hers. Joanne liked to be in control, both in and out of the bedroom, and I didn’t mind at all.

Enjoying the feeling of her tits crushed against my chest, I kissed her neck and wrapped my arms around her back, beginning to thrust my hips upwards in time to her downward strokes.

“Oh, that feels good,” she moaned softly as we fucked like that for a while.

“I’m going to get on top and fuck you,” I told her, easing us both over so that I was above her. “I need to cum.”

“So soon?” she pouted as I put myself back into her and began to thrust eagerly.

“We don’t have time to fuck all morning,” I informed her. “We’ve got stuff to do.”

I went quiet then, concentrating on pistoning my cock in and out of her until I felt myself on the edge, then I pulled out and stroked myself rapidly until I shot my load onto her small, tidy triangle of thick, black pubic hair. Seeing my cum shoot out onto her pussy or belly was one of my favourite things. It was safe to finish inside her - she was on birth control - I just liked the visual side of cumming onto her. I always had.

“Simon,” Jo said softly when I’d done. “You do know I’m going to have to finish myself off now, right?”

She was saying that because she knew I sometimes got annoyed when she made herself cum after sex. I don’t know why. Sometimes it turned me on, watching her masturbate but sometimes it also got me down and left me feeling grumpy. Maybe the reason was that I’d never been able to make her

orgasm through penetration. Our usual sexual routine included me playing with her clit or going down on her to make her cum, but because I liked to cum on her pussy, going down on her afterwards wasn't a very appetising option. She'd once or twice mentioned how I struggled to make her cum through sex and ever since then I'd occasionally got grumpy when she made herself climax.

Today wasn't one of those occasions though. "Okay," I replied, rolling my eyes. "Have a nice play while I go in the shower."

Jo grinned mischievously and slid a hand between her thighs as I headed to the bathroom. There was a lot to do before we opened today, so I hoped she didn't take too long.

Luckily, she didn't. I'd showered, got dressed and was downstairs preparing for the day ahead and within half an hour, Jo joined me. We managed to get the line clean done, the fridges stocked and the doors open just in time for our first customer, one of the regulars, an old guy called David who lived just down the street.

"Good morning," he said as he dragged his feet across the freshly cleaned floor to the bar.

"It's noon," I observed, looking up at the clock above me. "I'm never sure whether you class midday as morning or afternoon."

"I suppose once it's a minute past noon, it's officially afternoon," Jo commented.

"All I know is I'm thirsty," David smiled, his weathered face creasing even more than it already was.

"Your usual?" I asked, already pulling him a pint of lager because I knew the answer.

Once David was sat down, drinking his much-needed beer and wiping the foam from the grey-moustached top lip, another of the regulars walked into the pub.

"Hey." Joanne waved a hand to her best friend, Kathryn, as the plump blonde walked over towards us.

"Have you heard the news?" Kathryn asked in her annoyingly high voice, glancing at me strangely.

"What news?" Jo replied as she made her friend a coffee, her regular day-time beverage of choice.

"About Frank," Kathryn whispered quietly, but not quietly enough because I heard.

I looked at my wife and saw her face pale. Frank was Joanne's ex-husband. The man she described to me as her biggest mistake. She'd met him when she was just eighteen and he was thirty and she'd fallen head over heels, as teenagers are prone to do. Frank was a wildman, a party animal, drug-taker and all-around bad boy, but by the time she'd realised what a troublemaker he was, she was too caught up in his world and on impulse, she married him within a year of them meeting - her biggest regret. Five years later, Frank was arrested for being involved in a huge diamond robbery in London. He and his gang had almost gotten away with it if I remembered rightly. The entire group had been sentenced to twenty years in prison.

"What about Frank?" Jo said slowly.

"He's out." Kathryn went on, her eyes wide and with an evident tremble in her hands, as she took the hot coffee from Jo.

Jo herself wrung her hands, obviously as stressed about it as her best friend was.

Frank had been imprisoned fifteen years ago or so if my dates were correct.

"He shouldn't be out yet," Jo said slowly, obviously thinking the exact same thing as me. "He got twenty years with no parole."

"I don't know the exact ins and outs," Kathryn replied, "But Sharon called me and told me. He got out two days ago and he's been asking about us."

"She didn't tell him anything, did she?" Jo poured herself a vodka and downed it.

"She says not," Kathryn shook her head and took another drink of her coffee. "But if he's been asking Sharon, he'll have been asking other people too."

"We're four hours away from London," I joined in the conversation, trying to reassure them. Kathryn, Sharon and Joanne had been friends since they were young girls. After the incident, Jo had divorced Frank while he was in prison and because he didn't take the decision very well, she'd decided to move north to Manchester, where she met me. Kathryn followed her, while Sharon stayed in London because she had a young son with another of the gang members, Danny.

Joanne hadn't told me any of this until after we'd got married, several years after Frank's imprisonment. She told me that he was ancient history as

far as she was concerned and she was sure she'd never hear from him, even when he got out. However, she felt it only right to tell me the truth about her past - just in case he did ever get in touch.

"If Frank is looking for us, he'll find us," Jo said, refilling the vodka glass.

"But there's nothing to worry about," I shrugged. "He can't still be pissed off at you for divorcing him. That was fifteen years ago now."

"You don't know Frank," Kathryn said to me, looking down into her coffee.

"Simon's right. He won't be angry. He probably wants closure, knowing Frank," Jo said. "I did nothing but support him right until he got sent down but before that, he was horrible to me. Things were great for the first year but once he showed his true colours, I fell out of love. I only stayed with him as long as I did because I felt some loyalty to him for some reason. When he went to prison, he even told me to go out there and find someone. He knew I wasn't happy and even though he was a bastard, he did love me, I think. He said he wanted me to be happy. He didn't want me to wait for him."

"But you said he was angry when you divorced him," I reminded Jo of what she'd told me.

"Because I didn't tell him right away," Jo replied, her blue eyes watery after downing the second shot. "By then, I was in the process of cutting off contact with him and was already considering moving away for a fresh start."

I wasn't overly worried. I didn't want any conflict with her criminal ex-husband but if he was fresh out of prison - somehow getting out early - the last thing he was going to do was cause trouble and potentially risk getting straight back.

"Anyway, I thought you should know," Kathryn said in her squeaky voice. "Sharon wanted your number to tell you herself but I didn't give it to her."

"Good," Jo nodded. "I hate the thought of anyone back in London having my number. Those people and those days are behind me and I don't ever want to go back there."

Joanne's parents had been drunks and she was as glad to escape them as she was to escape Frank and the rest of her past. She was an only child. Sharon and Kathryn had been the closest thing she'd had to siblings. I'd

never met Sharon - she'd stayed in London and as far as I knew didn't even know precisely where Kathryn and Jo had moved to, even though she and Sharon had stayed in touch. Kathryn however, had been a good friend to her and although I found the obese blonde woman annoying at first - to say the least - I'd warmed to her slowly and recognised her as the warm-hearted and kind woman that she was.

"Do you want me to stick around?" she squeaked. "In case he gets in touch?"

"No, I'm sure I'll be fine," Jo smiled, moving to refill her vodka glass for the third time but then changing her mind and putting it in the sink.

"I'll make sure she's okay," I added, putting my arms around my curvy wife.

"Okay, good," Kathryn said, finishing her coffee. "I have to feed and walk the dogs. I've been off my head with worry since Sharon called me this morning. I completely forgot to take them out for their usual morning walk."

"Go sort your babies out," Jo ushered her friend toward the door. Kathryn wasn't married and didn't have a boyfriend or any close family. Along with me and Jo, her dogs were the only people she had. She treated her pets like her children. "We'll be fine, I'm sure."

"If he does get in touch," Kathryn said as she disappeared out of the door. "Let me know."

"I'm sure he won't," Jo reassured her again. "And if he does, he'll just be looking for closure, not trouble."

How wrong she was.

Chapter 2

It was two days later that it happened. I was serving behind the bar when the doors opened and a huge guy - and I mean huge - walked through. He was tall, his head scraping the upper part of the doorframe even though he ducked, with wide shoulders and a stout frame. I knew immediately it was Frank because I glanced at Jo and saw her visibly pale much like she had when Kathryn had mentioned his name.

“What’s your best whisky?” the giant said, looming over me and making me relieved that we had the wooden bar between us.

“We have a great Macallan,” I replied, feeling on edge but trying not to show it.

Frank looked over my head at the bar display. He was older-looking than I’d anticipated. Jo had told me he was twelve years older than her when they met - which would put him at around fifty now - but he looked older. Perhaps prison had aged him. He was totally bald apart from some grey stubble growing above his ears and around the sides of his large head. His nose was flat - broken, several times most probably - and his eyes were deep-set beneath a heavy brow. A tattoo adorned one cheek, three teardrops beneath his left eye.

“I’ll have two doubles then, please,” the big man replied in a gravelly tone. “One for me and one for my boy here.”

It was only then I noticed he wasn’t alone. Standing beside him was a much younger man, perhaps in his early twenties, with short dark hair and an unpleasant scowl that unfortunately appeared to be his ‘resting’ face.

“Your son?” I asked, making conversation as I poured the two drinks.

“My friend’s son,” the man who had to be Frank replied. “Are you the landlord?”

“Yes,” I nodded, sliding the drinks across the bar. “Simon. Nice to meet you.”

The big man looked at his friend and nodded. “Told you,” he said to the younger fellow as he paid me. As I rang the money in the till, I looked

around, trying to find Jo but she was nowhere to be seen. She must have fled into the backroom when she saw Frank walk in.

“Take a seat,” I waved a hand towards the window seats - the best in the pub. “If you want any more drinks, call me and I’ll bring them over to you.”

“Table service,” Frank nodded, seeming impressed. “I like it. But actually, we were hoping to find someone here. I believe she’s your wife. A lady called Joanne.”

“Yes, Joanne is my wife,” I said, my heart rate suddenly elevating. “I’m not sure where she is right now. She might have gone out to the shops. I’ll have to-”

“I’m here,” Jo said, appearing from the door to the right of the bar. She must have been listening. Then her face changed to one of surprise - fake surprise - as she pretended to see Frank for the first time. “Is that you, Frank?”

“Joanne,” the big man’s slab-like face broke into a wide and surprisingly warm smile. “Wow. You haven’t changed a bit.”

“Oh, I have,” my wife grinned as she walked over and looked him up and down. “I’m older and fatter. I have grey hairs and wrinkles. What happened to your hair?”

“I went bald years ago,” Frank grinned back. “I don’t normally have this-” he rubbed a heavy hand through the stubble around the sides of his head, “But it’s been a busy few days since I got out and I haven’t had time to shave it.”

“I didn’t know you were out.” Jo lied exceptionally smoothly. Then she looked at the younger man. “Oh. My. God. Is this... Bradley?”

“Brad,” the young man corrected her, his expression still dour. “Yes. You recognise me?”

“You were about four years old the last time I saw you, but yes, you have your dad’s face.” Jo seemed genuinely surprised to see the young man.

“Danny died five years ago,” Frank said abruptly. “Cancer. Before he passed, I promised him I’d look after Brad when I got out.”

“Oh no,” Jo’s face dropped. “I didn’t know. I’m sorry, Brad.”

The young man didn’t reply. He just shrugged and took a sip of the whisky, grimacing at the taste.

“He’s nineteen now,” Frank continued. “But yes, doesn’t he look just like his old man?”

“He sure does,” Jo nodded, glancing at me briefly to check I was okay. I didn’t say anything, instead, I just gave her as reassuring a smile as I could muster.

“Can I buy you a drink?” Frank asked Jo. “You too,” he then said, looking across the bar at me.

“I’m fine, but thank you,” I replied and Jo nodded at my polite reply, then leaned on the bar next to the big man.

“It depends on why you’re here.” She looked up at him. Jo was only five-feet tall, something I liked about her. I’d always had a thing for short girls. “What brings you up north, Frank?”

“I came to see you,” Frank replied honestly. “I don’t want any trouble or anything. I just wanted to check you were okay and see your face again. Not just you. There are a few people I’m visiting around the country. Old friends and such. I’ve been away for a long time - fifteen long years, Joanne. There are just a few ghosts I want to lay to rest, you know?”

“Well, I can tell you I’m doing fine, Frank.” Jo reached across the bar and grabbed my hand. “Simon and I got married a couple of years after... you know... and he’s been really good to me. We’ve run a few businesses and recently took this place on and it’s been going great. You don’t need to worry about me, Frank. I’m fine, but thank you.”

“Excellent,” he replied, seemingly satisfied with her answer as he looked around the pub. “I like this place. It’s homely.”

“How did you even find us?” Jo asked.

“I know people,” Frank answered with a mysterious smile and a wink. “There’s no one I can’t find. I knew you’d gotten married too. I guessed that was why you stopped writing.”

“It was just time for me to move on,” Jo shrugged. “You said you wanted me to find happiness and I did. I hope you’re happy for me.”

“I am. Truly.” Frank looked me up and down as he said that and I tried my best to stand as tall as I could and appear unintimidated, even though I felt the exact opposite. “Listen. Are you two free tonight? As I mentioned, I have a few friends to see today while I’m up north, but I’d love to sit down properly later and buy you both a drink. Please say ‘yes’.”

Jo looked at me but I had no idea what she wanted me to say, so I simply shrugged.

“As long as you’re not looking for trouble, Frank,” she replied after a moment’s thought. “Then, yes. A drink would be nice.”

“Fantastic,” the big man said with that wide smile again. “We’ll see you later then.”

“I’m just finishing my drink,” Brad said as Frank tried to usher him towards the door.

“Well, get it drunk, lad. What’s up? Is it too strong for you or something?”

“No,” Brad replied defiantly, the lie being exposed when he spluttered and coughed immediately after downing what was left of the amber-coloured spirit in his glass.

“Just like your dad,” Frank shook his head, giving Jo an amused laugh. “He couldn’t hold his drink either.”

“See you later, Frank,” Jo said, guiding the two men towards and then out of the door, then as soon as it closed behind them, she sagged against it and gave me a drained look.

“Are you okay?” I said, leaving the bar and rushing over to her. As I got close, she stepped forward and into my arms, where she stayed for a moment. I noticed she was breathing heavily, as though she’d been exercising.

“I’m fine,” she said after a few moments, easing herself out of my concerned embrace. “I need to call Kathryn and let her know. If he’s found us, he could find her.”

“Why are you so worried?” I asked, following her back behind the bar. “He did just seem like he wanted to say ‘hello’.”

“I’m not worried,” Jo reassured me. “It was just a shock. Even though I was expecting it after the other day, seeing him again after all these years... it brought back memories.”

“Bad memories?” I guessed.

“Some of them were bad,” she nodded then corrected herself. “Most of them.”

“So why did you agree to have a drink with him tonight?”

“As you said,” Jo replied as she called Kathryn on her phone. “He does just want to catch up, I think. He’s probably got a lot of regrets and wants to make his peace with a few people. It’s best we let him say what he’s got to say. Let him get it out of his system and then he can move on.”

That sounded reasonable, so I went back to serving once Kathryn picked up and Jo began to tell her about what had just happened. A couple

of new customers had entered and were waiting at the bar, so once I'd done with their orders, I turned back to Jo just as she hung up from her friend.

"Well, it wasn't Kathryn that gave him our address via Sharon," she told me. "She's going to ring Sharon and let her know that he's been by."

"Is Kathryn worried about it, at all?" I asked. "She seemed as nervous as you the other day."

"Yes but you know what she's like." Jo pushed her dark curly hair out of her eyes and scratched her forehead, a habit of hers that she did when she was thinking. "I suppose I should explain a few things before she gets here or nothing will make sense later when Frank comes over."

"What things?"

Jo sighed, folding her arms beneath her breasts, pushing them up so they stood out in the tight blue t-shirt she was wearing. "Okay, so going back twenty years, there were the three of us. Me, the eldest, Sharon who was a year younger and Kathryn who was a year younger than her. We were best friends like I told you. Anyway, we got in with Frank, his friend Danny and another guy called Tommy. I ended up with Frank and Sharon ended up with Danny while Kathryn somehow ended up drifting between all the men in the group."

"Drifting with all the men?" I said, not quite understanding what she meant.

"She slept with all of them," Jo replied, rolling her eyes at me for not getting it. "Back in the day, Kathryn was a bit of a tart. Anyway, she dated Tommy for a while but they didn't stay together. To get to the point, the guy Frank was with today - Brad - he's Sharon's son. Danny got Sharon pregnant, which is why they got married. When *they* got married, Frank wanted us to get married and proposed to me. God knows why I said yes, but I did."

"Sharon is Brad's mother?" I said, beginning to put it all together. "This is all very complicated."

"That's how I knew Danny was dead," my wife said quietly. "I pretended I didn't know because I don't want Frank to catch on that Kath is still in touch with Sharon. The less he knows, the better."

"You did a good job of lying to him," I said, not knowing whether I should be happy that my wife was such a convincing liar.

"I guess. Look, I never told you much about this before," Jo's blue eyes peered into mine, "Because I was hoping I wouldn't ever have to. I

hoped I'd never see Frank again, but whatever, at least you're at a little bit clued up as to my past now."

"Sharon should know her boy is up here and hanging around with Frank," I suggested.

"That's exactly what I said to Kathryn and she thought the same, so she's calling Sharon now," Jo agreed. "Then she's coming over so there's one more of us when Frank and Brad come back later."

"Good idea," I nodded thoughtfully. "Anything to keep the conversation away from you is a good thing."

"What do you mean?" Jo looked at me quizzically.

"I don't know," I shrugged, feeling slightly uncomfortable. "Maybe I feel a bit..."

"Threatened?" Jo smiled softly, putting a hand on my arm. "Frank might be this big scary guy but he wouldn't do anything to hurt me - or anyone I care about, Trust me, Simon. You don't need to feel jealous or threatened."

"I never said I felt jealous," I said indignantly but she was right. Jo knew me all too well. She'd read my feelings like she always did. I loved Jo more than anything or anyone else in the whole world and her ex-husband turning up out of the blue had stirred up a bit of envy inside me for some reason.

"It's well over fifteen years since I felt anything for Frank," Jo reminded me. "I loved him once, but he ruined it. I love you now. You're my husband. Okay?"

"Okay," I smiled, accepting her reassurance but something inside me didn't feel right.

I should have trusted my instincts.

Chapter 3

“I don’t know how long they’re going to be here for,” I told Zena, our best barmaid. I’d put her in charge tonight so that Jo and I could officially take the night off, even though we were still in the pub. “Just keep walking over and checking we’re okay for drinks periodically.”

“Got it,” she replied. The dark-skinned Zena looked over at the table in the corner where Frank, Brad, Jo and Kathryn were already sitting, enjoying their first round of drinks and chatting. “That old guy is a bit scary-looking.”

“He is,” I agreed. “He’s an old friend of Jo and Kathryn, so it’s fine, don’t worry.”

Zena nodded and I left her at the bar to join my wife and the others.

“He’s here,” Frank shuffled sideways, inviting me to sit next to him. Then he threw a large, heavy arm across my shoulders. “My ex’s new husband. I hope you’re looking after my Joanne as good as she says you are.”

Him using the words *my Joanne* grated on me but I didn’t show it. “I’m not her *new* husband. We’ve been married for ten years. But yes, of course, I’m looking after her,” I replied. “She means the world to me.”

“I’m glad to hear it.” The big man patted me on the back so hard it almost knocked the wind out of me. “Although to be honest, Joanne doesn’t need anyone looking after her. She could always handle herself, back in the day. She once gave Tommy a black eye because he looked at her funny.”

“I remember that,” Kathryn giggled.

I looked at Jo in amazement. “You hit someone?”

“Right hook,” she nodded, taking a long pull of the beer in her hand. “Tommy was a dickhead to be fair. He deserved it.”

“He really was,” Kathryn nodded.

“I always thought you two would end up together,” Frank said to the curvy blonde.

“Nah,” Kathryn shrugged, her large breasts wobbling through the thin white top she was wearing. “What happened to him anyway?”

“Don’t you know?” Brad said, leaning across the table to tell us before Frank gave him a look which instantly silenced him.

“Tommy’s dead,” Frank said matter-of-factly. “Turns out he was the one that gave the cops the evidence they needed. He made a deal to get out early. He only served a few years, unlike us. Unfortunately, a couple of weeks after he got out, he ended up at the bottom of the river Thames. Whoops.”

My blood ran cold at the way he said ‘whoops’ and I looked at Jo, wondering what her reaction would be.

“Tommy was the grass?” was all she said, seemingly unfazed by Frank’s hint that he’d had something to do with Tommy’s death.

“Yeah.” Frank looked over the top of his lager at my wife who met his gaze coolly. “I’m surprised you don’t know all of this, Joanne. I know that you, Kathryn and Sharon kept in touch all this time. You must have known that Danny was dead.”

“I don’t speak to Sharon,” Jo shook her head. “Kathryn does, but not me.”

“I knew he was dead,” Kathryn spoke up, fiddling nervously with a strand of her blonde hair. “I never told Jo though. She always said she wanted to leave the past behind her, so...”

“I see,” Frank nodded, looking down at the table. “Well, let me fill you in on the rest. As you know now, Tommy and Danny are dead. Charlie never got locked up and has been looking after a few things for me while I’ve been inside. Bill got out last year. He’s the other person I need to catch up with, but he seems to be rather hard to get hold of.”

“Charlie? Bill?” I said, struggling to keep up with all these names.

“There were six of us involved in our little gang.” Frank turned to me, a glint in his eye as he recounted the story. “We did a few robberies. Small-time jobs, you know? But then we planned a big one. A jewellery store in Chelsea. It was all over the news. Took months of planning, didn’t it, Joanne? We took nearly two million pounds worth of stuff and we would have gotten away with it if it wasn’t for Tommy.”

“What did he do?” I felt compelled to ask.

“He never wanted to do the job. He was scared,” Frank continued. “But I talked him into it. Well - I say talked, I mean threatened. Anyway, he

was our electrical guy. He took the alarms out, did a good job. Got his share but I told him - I told everyone - we don't cash any of it in. Not right away. We hide it. Wait until the cops have given up and it's old news. Then, we sell the stuff quietly and carefully."

"But Tommy couldn't wait," Kathryn continued the story while Frank took a drink from his pint of beer. "As Jo said, he was a dickhead."

"He was already a person of interest to the cops. He'd got priors. The cops locked on to him right away and he dropped us all in it, one by one." Frank shook his head, his eyes locked on a spot on the table between us. "We didn't know it at the time. We were all wondering how the cops knew all this stuff they had on us. Well, it was Tommy."

"The only person he didn't drop in it was his best mate, Charlie," Jo added, explaining the final name. "Charlie was the muscle of the group."

"I thought Frank would be the muscle," I smiled at the big man, trying to lift him out of his now-sombre mood.

"I was the brains, I'll have you know." Frank waved a finger at me. "I'm a big bloke. I can handle myself, don't you worry, but Charlie... Charlie's a mad man. Even I wouldn't mess around with Charlie."

"He always scared me," Jo said and Kathryn replied similarly.

"He wouldn't ever hurt you," Frank shook his head. "He was always a bit in love with you, Joanne. No, Charlie's all right. We're still friends. I saw him right before I drove up to Manchester to see you."

"It's all quite a story," I said, taking a drink of the bottle I had in my hand. I wanted to have a drink so as not to appear unsociable but I was taking my time. I needed to keep my wits about me tonight and not get drunk.

"Didn't you notice I said there were six in the gang?" Frank tilted his head as he spoke to me. "Me, Danny, Bill, Tommy and Charlie. Don't you want to know who the sixth was? The other person who didn't get caught."

"Frank," Jo said, reaching across the table and putting her hand over his.

"It was your wife," the big man said, ignoring Jo. "Joanne here was the getaway driver. Like Charlie, Tommy was a bit in love with her too. We all were, I guess. Tommy protected his best friend and the woman he loved, but grassed the rest of us up."

"You protected me too," Jo said to her ex-husband before turning to me with a worried look on her face.

“I did. Danny and Bill did too. We weren’t grasses.” Frank downed the rest of his beer then caught my eye. “Simon. Get your girl to bring us another round over. It’s on me, don’t worry.”

“No,” I refused his offer. “I’ll get the drinks in, Frank. My pleasure.”

I called Zena over and gave her the order and when I turned around, Frank was considering me, his eyes narrowed. “Tell me honestly, Simon. Did you not know any of this?”

“I really didn’t,” I said, switching my eyes between him and Jo who was watching me carefully.

“I tried to keep as much of it from Simon as I could,” my wife said. “It’s not his business. I told him about you and what happened, but the rest of it didn’t really matter. It’s the past and my future was with him. I wanted to move on.”

It felt weird knowing that this man had been married to Jo, but it felt even weirder finding all of these secrets out about her past. Knowing that the other gang members had all fancied her. And that Kathryn - sitting quietly nursing a cocktail at the moment - had slept with them all too.

“I know,” Frank replied to Jo. “I know your intentions were good. You were always a good woman, Joanne. You obviously still are. Simon is a lucky, lucky man.”

Jo was still wearing the tight blue t-shirt from earlier and I saw Frank’s eyes drift down, looking at them through the thin fabric. Her nipples were erect for some reason and poking through slightly. I saw Jo’s eyes follow his downwards and when she realised her nipples were showing, she folded her arms in front of them.

“Were you really the getaway driver?” I asked, gazing over the table and fully expecting her to say, ‘No, of course not. He’s exaggerating.’

But she didn’t. She nodded. “Yes. Much to my shame.”

“Your wife knew how to drive a car better than any of us,” Frank leaned into me, putting his arm around me once more. “Plus it was the best way of keeping her safe. If we’d taken her inside with us, she’d have been in more danger than I was comfortable with.”

My wife had been involved in the infamous Chelsea Diamond Heist, as it had been known in the newspapers. I couldn’t believe it. I just stared at her.

“If you’re wondering what happened to her share of the money,” Frank removed his arm from my shoulders, his tone suddenly becoming colder

and more serious. "We were a couple. I hid it. Somewhere no-one would ever find it. In a safe, buried in an allotment. It should have still been there waiting for me, when I came out."

"Which brings us to why we're here," Brad said, speaking for the first time in ages.

"Shut up, Brad." Frank gave him a look which again silenced the youngster. "When I went to the allotment, it was gone."

"The stash is gone?" Jo said, glancing at me with another worried look on her face.

"Gone," Frank nodded. "The entire safe was gone and the contents with it."

"How did you get the money to afford this place?" Brad asked.

"Brad," Frank said, raising his voice slightly and turning to look at the kid, who visibly shirked away at his tone. "I said 'shut up.' So shut... the fuck... Up."

"We don't own the pub," Jo replied quickly. "We're just leasing it. We don't have your money, Frank and I don't know who does. If that's why-"

"That's part of the reason why," Frank interrupted her. I began to stand up, wanting to sit next to my wife, but Frank put a large hand on my thigh and pushed it down, forcing me to sit again and then he turned to face me. "Joanne is a good liar. She always was. So I'll ask you, Simon. Where's my money?"

"I don't know," I said, trying to keep my nerve. I really didn't know. I hadn't even known about this stash until he'd just mentioned it. "You said you stole two million pounds of stuff. If you divided it evenly amongst you, with you and Jo being a couple, that's four-hundred grand each. If we'd gotten our hands on four-hundred grand, do you think we'd be running a grotty low-rent pub on the outskirts of Manchester?"

Frank's dark eyes bored into mine, then he laughed. "If you're clever enough, that's exactly what you'd do. However, I believe you. If I've got one talent, it's reading people. I bet Joanne can read you like a book, can't she? I taught her that, Simon. I don't think you're a liar. I think you're a nice guy. Too nice a guy for someone like Joanne, but that's a conversation that she and I will have another time."

I was about to ask him what he meant by that but Jo cut me off before I could speak.

“We don’t know anything about the stash or what’s happened to it,” she said firmly. “So if it wasn’t us, who was it?”

“I made the mistake of leaving a few notes behind at our old place,” Frank mused. “Just in case I should forget or something should happen to me. Nothing that had the exact location, but a few clues. Those notes are gone and the only people I could think of who’s clever enough to work out the clues are you and Bill.”

“What about Charlie?” Jo asked. “Or even Lisa. I haven’t asked about Lisa or Sam. Are they okay? Sam must be grown up now.”

“Who’s Sam and Lisa?” I asked but I was ignored.

“I’ve kept in touch with Lisa and Sam the whole time I’ve been inside,” Frank shook his head. “They’re fine, but no - If it’s not you, it’s Bill. He’s the person I suspected from the start. But like I said, when I tried to find him today, he proved rather hard to get hold of.”

“Which is the second reason we’re here,” Brad said.

“If you so much as utter one more syllable when I’m speaking,” Frank roared at the kid, making everyone in the pub turn and look at us until he quietened his tone again. “I will rip your fucking throat out, son of my best friend or not. So, if I was you I would go outside - take your drink and stay there until I tell you to come back in.”

“Second reason?” Jo asked once Brad had slunk outside miserably into the freezing cold December night.

“I need to find Bill,” Frank said grimly. “He’s got my stash. I know it.”

“And what’s that got to do with me?” Jo went on.

“Danny, Tommy, Charlie.” Frank put his hands flat on the table. “They were all hot on you, Joanne. You know that. And Bill was too, maybe more than any of the others. I know where he is but I can’t get past his cronies. He’s got his own little crew now protecting him. They knew I was coming. I couldn’t get within a hundred yards of his little hideout. But you... he’d talk to you, Joanne. I know he would.”

“I’m not letting Jo get involved in this,” I said, as firmly as I dared.

“I’m not asking you,” Frank said, without looking at me. “Your darling wife owes me, Simon. I could have taken her down with me if I’d wanted to. Any of us could. But we didn’t. She owes me.”

“She doesn’t owe you anything,” I said, trying to keep the fear out of my voice. I couldn’t believe I was standing up to this guy, but I was.

“Simon,” Jo reached across the table, grabbing my arm and squeezing it hard. “Don’t. Frank’s right. I owe him. I’m not getting involved in anything. All he wants me to do is talk to Bill.”

“I could do it,” Kathryn said, her squeaky voice so quiet I could barely hear her.

“Bill might have fucked you a few times but he never really liked you,” Frank said so bluntly I winced for her. “No. It has to be Joanne. She’s the only person I can think of that he’d give the time of day to.”

“Okay,” Jo’s shoulders dropped in resignation. “I’ll do it. You’ll have to tell me what to do, what to say and where I can find him.”

“I’ll go over the plan with you tomorrow morning,” Frank nodded.

“Tomorrow morning?” Jo glanced at me but returned her attention to her ex.

“The third reason I’m here is that Brad and I need a place to stay.” The big man finished his beer and signalled for Zena to fetch another round. “This place has spare rooms, doesn’t it? Brad and I checked it out earlier and it’s a big place. You must have a spare bedroom or two.”

I looked at Jo in alarm. There was no way I’d be comfortable with Frank and Brad staying here overnight but before I had the chance to speak my concerns, she nodded.

“If it’s okay with Simon?” she said, turning to me but it wasn’t a question. Her eyes were wide and she nodded slowly, telling me to say ‘yes.’

“As Jo said earlier,” I took a deep swallow from the bottle in my hand, regretting my decision not to get drunk tonight. “As long as you don’t cause any trouble, then I guess it’s okay. We have two guest rooms, you’re right. You can have one, Brad the other.”

“We’ll be as good as gold,” Frank smiled, throwing his arm over my shoulder one more time. “I like Simon. Have I told you that, Joanne? As jealous as I am that he’s fucking my ex-wife, I like him. Now, someone go and tell Brad to come back in and let’s stop talking and get pissed together, eh?”

I got up to bring the youngster back inside, noticing how weak my legs felt as I first stood up, while also regretting what I’d said about paying the beer bill for tonight.

What had we gotten ourselves into?

Chapter 4

By the end of the night, as we were kicking out the final few customers, I reflected on what had surprisingly turned out to be a fun evening. Faced with the reality of the situation, I decided to have a few drinks and try to relax. I managed to push the thoughts of Bill and what Jo had promised to do to the back of my mind and actually found myself enjoying Frank's company once he left the serious stuff behind and we all chilled out a little.

"This is your room, Frank," I said to him, showing him the first guest room while Jo locked up downstairs.

"Nice," the big man said, stepping through the door and looking around. "This will be fine, Simon. Thanks."

"Brad's next door," I told him then turned and told Brad to check his room out, which the young man did. "The bathroom is directly opposite and we have our own kitchen just down the hall. Make yourself at home and help yourself to a cup of tea or coffee in there but please don't take anything from the downstairs kitchen because it messes the stock up."

"Understood," he replied in his gruff voice while sitting on the edge of the bed. "I really appreciate this. I hope you know that."

"Yeah, well, we don't normally let people stay up here for free. We were thinking of making the place into a bed and breakfast at some point," I told him. "But seeing as you're old friends of Jo's, it's all good."

I left Frank as he kicked off his shoes and made himself comfortable and checked on Brad who was already tucked up in bed next door. The youngster had drunk one or two beers too many, complaining that he was drunk and tired, so I wasn't surprised that he was already asleep.

I got myself a drink of water, trying to sober up and avoid a hangover in the morning then went downstairs to see what Jo was doing. I'd expected her to be locked up and done by now but she was talking to Kathryn at the back door.

"Are you sure you're going to be okay?" the curvy blonde asked Jo as I walked up to them.

“We’ll be fine,” Jo reassured her best friend. “If I get any sort of bad vibes from Frank, I’ll call you, okay?”

Kathryn didn’t seem reassured. “Promise me you’ll be careful,” she said, turning to me. “Jo is downplaying things because she’s a bit drunk. I am too if I’m honest, but I’m sobering up a bit now and I’m worried. Frank isn’t a nice man, Simon. No matter what he says.”

“Maybe he’s changed,” Jo said softly. “Prison can change people for the better you know? Plus, he’s older. Perhaps he’s mellowed.”

“Leopards don’t change their spots,” Kathryn shook her head. “Just call me in the morning and let me know you’re okay. And tell me what’s happening with this Bandit Bill thing.”

“Bandit Bill?” I asked, once Kathryn had gone and Jo had locked the door behind her. I turned off the lights and set the alarms and Jo explained the nickname as we went upstairs.

“Bill was the cracker of the group,” my wife explained. I couldn’t help but admire her curvy backside as she walked upstairs in front of me, almost distracting me from what she was saying. “He could pick locks. Crack safes. Failing that, he knew how to blowtorch or saw his way through practically anything. He even knew how to hack certain things like gambling machines. Somehow that all ended up with us calling him Bandit Bill.”

“He sounds like a useful man to know if you’re in the profession Frank was in.”

“He was,” Jo nodded as we walked past Frank and Brad’s rooms. “Are they both settled in okay? Should I check?”

“No,” I put a hand in the small of her back and steered her towards our bedroom at the far end of the building near the upstairs kitchen. “Brad’s already asleep and Frank probably is too. I want to talk to you in bed for a bit.”

“I’m drunk,” Jo shrugged and smiled. “I was hoping you’d want more than talk.”

“Well, maybe that too,” I giggled as we walked into the bedroom and I closed the door behind us. When I turned back around, Jo was already stripped down to her underwear and was getting in bed, so I joined her. “I’m worried about this thing with Bill.”

“Let’s not talk about it now.” Jo sidled up close under the covers, her body warm against mine. “I agreed to it just to get Frank to drop it. I’ll talk

my way out of it tomorrow. I know how to handle Frank. I might not have seen him for fifteen years but he's still the same man."

"I thought you said he'd changed?" I sighed as Jo's hand drifted down my body and rubbed my cock through my boxer shorts.

"In some ways, maybe, but in others, he's still the same Frank and he'll be prone to my charms." Jo's hand pulled my shorts down and began to stroke me to hardness.

"So, tomorrow you're going to tell him you won't do it?" I reached behind her back and undid her bra which she hadn't taken off yet then reached down and hooked a finger in the hem of her panties and eased them down too.

"Yes," Jo promised, rolling her body over mine as she kicked her panties off. She reached down and guided my cock into her then laid her weight on top of me and kissed me before I could speak again.

After a few minutes of her being on top, I rolled us both over and fucked her in the missionary position. "My getaway driver wife," I muttered to myself while thudding into her as hard as I could. I wanted her to cry out. I wanted Frank to hear, almost like I was reminding him that Jo was mine but she wasn't very vocal tonight.

After we'd finished and I'd cum inside her, Jo mumbled that she was tired and needed to go to sleep. "I'll tell you about the getaway driver thing tomorrow," she murmured. "I'm sorry I never told you before."

"It's okay," I replied but she'd already fallen asleep so I closed my eyes and let myself sleep too but for some reason, I woke up after a short while, sweaty and shaking slightly.

"I must have had a nightmare," I said to Jo, rolling over to face her in case I'd woken her up, but she wasn't in bed.

"Jo?" I said quietly into the darkness of the bedroom. "Jo?"

There was no answer, so I slipped out of bed and stepped out of the bedroom, walking down the hallway with a bad feeling in my stomach. Had she gone to Frank's bedroom?

"Simon?" She stepped out of the bathroom right as I reached it. "What are you doing?"

"I came looking for you," I replied. "I woke up and you weren't in bed."

"I needed to pee." Jo smiled. She'd put a t-shirt on to cover her nakedness. "I definitely had too much to drink tonight. Where did you think

I'd gone?"

I followed her back to the bedroom and into bed. "I don't know. I got worried."

"Because Frank is here?" Jo turned her face to look at me, her dark curls falling into her eyes until she pushed them away. "What did you think I was going to do? Slip into his bed for a middle of the night chat and some old-times-sake sex?"

"I don't know," I grumbled as she giggled at me. "You said you were drunk and..."

"Do you really think I'd do that?" Jo's eyes went wide. "Wow, Simon. Even when drunk, I wouldn't do that."

"I know but Frank's your ex-husband and... I dunno."

Jo patted the front of my boxer shorts. "We had sex earlier. You came inside me. Do you think I'd go and-" She touched my cock again through the thin fabric. "Your dick's hard again," she pointed out.

Was it? I reached down with my own hand and to my surprise, it was. I didn't know why.

"Do you like the thought of me cheating on you or something?" Jo asked, pushing herself up onto one elbow to study my face while I answered.

"No," I said, although I wasn't sure. During those few moments when I'd climbed out of bed and walked down the hallway, the image of my wife cheating on me had popped in my head. I'd very briefly imagined myself pushing the guest bedroom door open and catching them at it - the huge Frank on top of Jo, fucking her hard and rough.

"Are you sure?" Jo squinted at me, trying to work out if I was lying or not, her hand squeezing the shape of my erection. "This says otherwise."

"I sometimes wake up with a boner," I shrugged. "All men do. You know that."

"Hmmmmmm." Jo lay back down next to me. "Well, whatever. We should get some sleep. We have to be up early to deal with Frank and Brad in the morning and we'll probably both have hangovers so..."

"True," I replied, relieved at her changing the subject. Was I turned on? My dick said yes, twitching as I pictured the image again. I'd never - ever - had reason to think of Jo with someone else before, so I'd never encountered the weird, conflicting emotion of it being visually arousing

before and I wasn't sure how to deal with it. I pushed the thoughts out of my head and tried to go back to sleep.

I was pretty sure that a lot of men would get excited about the mental image of their wife having sex - even if it was with another man. It wasn't that unusual, was it? Anyway, Jo had said that she'd never do that to me, so I had nothing to worry about. Hopefully, by tomorrow, we'd have sorted things out with her scary ex-husband and they'd be out of our lives again. Things would go back to normal. Wouldn't they?

Chapter 5

“Wake up, sleepyhead.”

I sat up in bed, feeling slightly disoriented but thankfully not too hungover. Jo was standing next to the bed, a hot cup of coffee in her hand. She was wearing just the long dark-green t-shirt she’d worn to the bathroom last night. Her hair was all mussed from sleep, so she hadn’t been up long, by the looks of it.

“Thanks.” I gratefully accepted the hot drink and took a sip. “What time is it?”

“Half-eight,” Jo replied. “Frank’s in the bathroom having a shower. I thought we could have breakfast together when he’s done.”

“What about Brad?” I asked, putting the coffee down for a moment, swinging my legs out of bed to stretch the sleep out of my stiff muscles.

“Frank told me to let him have another hour in bed. He was pretty drunk last night, so it’ll do him some good to sleep it off.”

“Probably true,” I yawned. “So, we’re having breakfast with your former jailbird ex-husband? Kind of weird, but okay.”

“I’m going to try to talk my out of doing this Bill thing,” Jo reminded me.

“I seem to remember you saying something about him being *prone to your charms*,” I nodded with a hopeful smile while putting some clothes on. I didn’t want Frank seeing me in any sort of partial undress. I was slim and didn’t want to have to compare myself to his hulking form.

“And I seem to remember you thinking I’d sneaked into his room in the middle of the night,” Jo smiled back. “I think you owe me an apology for that.”

“I was drunk and paranoid or something. I wasn’t thinking straight. I’m sorry.” I apologised as I picked up the coffee and headed back out into the upstairs hallway.

“Jo?” we heard Frank call from the bathroom, followed by the noise of the shower switching off.

“What’s up?” I replied through the wooden door before she could speak; maybe me asserting myself. “Is everything okay?”

“Sorry, Simon,” Frank’s voice replied. “I can’t find a towel.”

“Shit,” I heard Jo mutter to herself. She went into our bedroom and replied with a large white bath towel. “I forgot. Pass him this.”

“Here you go,” I said, knocking on the door and holding the towel through the gap with an outstretched hand as he opened it.

“Thanks,” he replied, warm steamy air billowing out from the bathroom, but instead of just opening the door a crack, he swung it further open and I saw him standing there for a moment, stark naked, before he took the towel and then shut the door.

I was shocked at what I’d seen. For a man in his fifties, Frank was in good shape. Not muscular, but bulky, solid and fit-looking. And between his legs hung the longest and thickest penis I’d ever seen.

“Jesus Christ,” I mumbled to myself but Jo heard.

“His dick?” She laughed. “Why do you think I stayed with the asshole as long as I did?”

“Really?” I stared at her, aghast. “I never knew you liked big ones.”

“I’m joking.” Jo elbowed me gently in the ribs as she bustled past and down the stairs. “Come on, let’s start breakfast.”

We made some bacon sandwiches, which Jo said was Frank’s favourite back when they were together and when he joined us shortly afterwards, he complimented her on her good memory.

“Are you two as hungover as I am?” he asked as he joined us at the table, filling his coffee cup from the filter machine which Jo had the forethought to fill up for us.

“I remembered to have a large glass of water before bed,” I replied. “Often does the trick.”

“I am a little,” Jo smiled at him. “But not too bad. It was a good night though.”

“It was,” Frank grinned back, tucking into a bacon sandwich. “Mmmm. Delicious.”

We sat in silence for a short while, eating our breakfast until eventually, Jo pushed her plate to one side. “So, about the plan with Bill,” she said, slowly. “I’m not sure it’s a good idea.”

“Why’s that?” Frank replied, sitting back into his chair and settling his gaze on her.

“It’s been a long time, Frank.” Jo laced her fingers and placed her hands in front of her on the table, tapping her thumbs together while trying to think how to word it appropriately. “I don’t want to sound like a bitch,” she said at last. “But you and I - everything that happened - it’s all in the past. As I said last night, I’ve moved on. You should too. Start afresh. Like I did.”

“I want my stash.” Frank didn’t move from where he was leaning back in the chair. “Bill has it. I know he does. I can’t get to him but you can. If it means me giving you your half of the share, then I can do that, Joanne, but I need you to do this for me.”

“Isn’t it dangerous?” I asked. “If you care at all about Jo, you wouldn’t want to put her in danger, would you?”

“Bill wouldn’t hurt Joanne.” Frank still didn’t move. He just turned his dark eyes to me when he spoke, then flicked them back to Jo. “All I want you to do is talk to him for me. Tell him I know he’s got my money and talk him into giving it to me. If you can’t, then I’ll have to deal with it in the old-fashioned way but I know he’ll listen to you, Joanne.”

“Where is he? Explain why you can’t see him yourself,” Jo sighed, apparently giving up. What had happened to her *using her charms* on Frank?

“He’s not far from here. A half-hour away,” Frank replied, the slightest of smiles growing on his face. “Like you, he thought he could escape me but I know too many people that know too many people. Problem is, he’s holed up in a block of flats and I don’t know which one. My contact could only put me in touch with Mack, one of his cronies. When I went, he pulled a gun on me. Must’ve known I was coming or expected me, at least.”

“A gun?” I looked at Jo in shock but she didn’t seem surprised.

“Carry on,” she replied. “What happened then?”

“I told Mack I wanted to see Bill but he denied all knowledge of where he was. He lied. My contact told me that he’s seen Bill doing deals with some of the local hoodlums around here - probably drugs - and that Mack is never far from his side. They’re linked to some sort of money laundering racket too. Someone called Alfie and his girlfriend Beth. They’re all holed up in one of the flats, but as to which one, I’ve got no idea.”

“If he stole your stash then he’ll have been prepared for you to come looking for him,” Jo nodded thoughtfully. “He’ll have made preparations.”

“But he won’t be expecting *you* to turn up, Joanne.” Frank stroked his square jaw. “I understand him taking my money. Everyone else’s was recovered or seized by the law, plus he was Tommy’s friend. He probably knows I had a part to play in Tommy’s death and his way of revenge is taking my loot. But he forgot that technically, half of it is yours, Joanne. That’s how you play it. Use your feminine charms. Bill was madly in love with you. Or lust, depending on how you look at it.”

“But I really don’t want to get involved.” Jo stood up, then stretched, pulling the long t-shirt up, exposing her thighs almost up to her panties - I hoped she was wearing some panties. “Frank, I could get in trouble. It could be dangerous like Simon said. Guns? This sounds bad. Do you really want me to do this? You’d feel awful if anything happened to me.”

I watched Frank and saw his eyes drop, first to her bare thighs, then slowly upwards, lingering on her large breasts which were jutting out through the thin t-shirt as she finished stretching and straightened up the top, pulling it back down. Her nipples were erect again, I noticed. I could clearly see them poking through as she swept up the breakfast dishes and turned away to place them in the sink.

Frank still didn’t reply. His eyes were now on her backside as she started to wash up. Jo turned and looked at him over her shoulders. This was her *using her charms*, I realised.

He stood up and walked over to her. Frank was fully-dressed after his shower, otherwise, I’d have felt uncomfortable with him being so close to my wife who was braless - and possibly totally underwear-less, under her t-shirt.

“I wouldn’t ask this of you if there was any other way,” he said quietly as he stood next to her, looking out of the open window. It was a bright, sunny day outside. I could hear birds singing.

“Fine. I can’t make any promises but I’ll try,” Jo said as she began to wash up.

Shit. That was that. She hadn’t been able to talk her way out of it.

“That’s all I ask,” he replied in his gravelly voice. “I’ll take you there this afternoon and tell you who to see and what to say. If he won’t see you, then I’ll take over. Once this is sorted, one way or the other, I’ll be out of your hair, if that’s what you want, Joanne. I promise.”

“This afternoon?” I asked, feeling alarmed at the suddenness of it all.

With one final glance at Jo's ass, he turned to face me. "Bill knows I'm here. It's best we act fast. That way he doesn't have a chance to move his base of operations. Plus, the quicker we get it over and done with, the better, right?"

"He's right," Jo said over her shoulder. "Let's just get it out of the way."

"I'm coming with you," I said, standing up. "There's no way I'm letting you do this alone."

"We'll all go," Frank nodded. "I'll drive and wait in the car while she goes to talk to Bill."

"Simon, you call Zena and get her to open up and watch the bar this afternoon," Jo said, putting the last washed plate into the drying rack. "I'll go in the shower now."

"I'd best try to wake Brad up," Frank replied and then headed upstairs, leaving Jo and me together for a moment.

"Are you crazy?" I whispered once he was out of earshot. "Did you hear what he said? The guy pulled a gun on him. This is nuts."

"I know." My gorgeous wife puffed out her cheeks and sighed. "I wish I hadn't gotten you mixed up in this but it is what it is. Frank's trouble. Always has been. The best thing is to not even try to resist. Let's just do it. See what Bill has to say, then let Frank sort it out. The guy isn't just going to hand the money over if he's anything like the Bandit Bill I used to know. Then I've done my part and Frank will have to move on."

"What if Frank goes to war on this guy and people get hurt?" I pointed out. "Just by being involved, we're implicating ourselves. This is way over our heads."

"I'm already implicated," Jo reminded me. "At any time, Frank or Bill could drop me in it about being the getaway driver. I don't know if I could still be in trouble, but I don't want to take the risk."

"It was fifteen years ago," I scratched my head. "The authorities got the people responsible for it, as far as they're concerned. They've got nothing on you, even if Frank snitched on you all these years later. It'd just be hearsay."

"Maybe." Jo glanced up the stairs. "But I've told him I'll do it now. If I back out..."

"I know. Fuck." I shook my head as I cursed, scarcely able to believe what a mess we were in.

“I’m going in the shower,” Jo said, walking up the stairs. “Call Zena and sort the pub out.”

I watched her until she disappeared out of sight, my mind working overtime about what was going to happen next, then I called Zena and made the necessary arrangements.

We’d get through this. Jo would hopefully talk Bill into either giving Frank his money or making some sort of reparations with him. She had to. I knew Jo had no intention of being caught up in a gang war or any kind of grudge battle between two old criminals. She’d apologised for dragging me into this and I knew she wouldn’t want us being pulled any deeper into it.

I had to have faith in her. Hopefully, she’d fix this. For us.

Chapter 6

“We’re here,” Frank announced, pulling over onto a grass verge in front of a row of houses.

“I thought you said he was holed up in a block of flats,” Jo asked from the back seat where she was sitting next to me.

“He is,” Frank replied, looking over his shoulder. “I don’t want to park up right outside and warn him that we’re here. The flats are just a couple of minutes walk around the corner.”

“Over there,” Brad wound down the window and pointed further up the road. I could see the flats rising up over the houses in the distance. It wasn’t far.

“So, I’m going to flat number 5 in the blue block,” Jo recited what Frank had told us on the way here.

“Yes. Knock on the door and a guy should answer with short blond hair and a scar on his chin. That’s Mack,” Frank repeated what he’d told us already, to make sure we knew what we were doing. “Ask to see Bill and tell him you’re an old friend. Ask Mack to tell him that it’s you. He’ll see you. I have no doubt about that.”

“And then, what?” Jo asked. “If Mack tells me what flat he’s in, do I just come back to the car and tell you? Mission accomplished. Or do you want me to talk to him even if I get the flat number?”

“He won’t give you the flat number,” Frank shook his head. “He’ll get Bill to come to you. Unless Bill’s getting sloppy in his old age, which I doubt. Tell him I want my money. Remind him that half of it is yours but he’ll know that you’re really coming on my behalf. He’s not stupid. First, me turning up, then you a day later, he’ll know the two are linked. See what you can do, Joanne.”

“Are you going to wait here?” I asked, opening the car door and stepping out into the bright but cold December sunshine.

“Yes. Brad will walk to the end of the road and keep an eye on your backs but I’ll keep out of sight here.” Frank tapped a finger on his phone

which was resting on the dashboard. "I've given you both my number. Call me if you need to. I'll give you an hour and if you're not back, I'll come looking for you but it shouldn't take that long."

"Why would you need to come looking for us?" I asked nervously as Jo got out of the car and joined me on the pavement.

"Stop worrying." She looped an arm through mine and peered through the open front car window at Frank. "I've got this. See you in a bit with your money."

"I don't doubt it," the big man grinned as he watched us leave, walking up the road towards the rundown-looking flats rising high in the distance.

"I'm nervous," I said as we turned a corner in the road, well out of earshot of Frank and Brad. "Are we really doing this?"

"Just let me deal with things, okay?" Jo took my hand and squeezed it. "It's been a long time but back in the day, I was pretty good at dealing with thugs and small-time scum like this. Practically all of Frank's friends were wannabe gangsters and I'm imagining these guys are just the same. Just follow my lead and we'll be fine."

The flats weren't too far, a five-minute walk at the most, in fact, it took us longer to actually find flat number 5 in the blue block (the numbers on the doors were blue coloured, which took us a while to work out) than it did to walk here from where Frank had parked the car.

Jo knocked once, then twice when no one answered right away. "The lights are on," she said, peering through the dirty front window of the ground floor flat. "Someone must be in, surely."

"Hello?" I heard a raspy male voice call through the door without opening it and I hissed for Jo to come over.

"Hi," she said confidently through the dilapidated wood door. "I'm a friend of Bill's."

"I don't know any Bill," the voice replied. "I think you've got the wrong flat."

"Flat 5, blue block," Jo winked at me, trying to reassure me. "I'm looking for a man named Mack. Is that you?"

The man didn't answer at first. Then the handle turned and the door cracked open and a villainous-looking blonde man with a scar splitting his chin looked challengingly at us through the narrow gap.

"What do you want?" he grunted, looking first at me, rather dismissively, then at Jo, his eyes sweeping up and down her body

appreciatively. She was wearing a pair of tight black jeans and brown leather jacket which fitted her so snugly it didn't quite fasten up properly over her breasts.

"I'm an old friend of Bill's," Jo reiterated. "I have a problem and I need Bill's help."

"Is it to do with Frank?" Mack asked, not wasting any words.

"Yes. Frank *is* the problem," Jo nodded. "He's a problem for Bill too, that's why I want to talk about it. A problem shared is a problem halved, so the saying goes."

"I never heard of any saying," Mack shrugged. "I'll call him."

Then he shut the door in our faces abruptly, leaving Jo and I waiting for a few minutes until finally, he reopened it.

"What's your name?" he asked Jo, his eyes leering at the gap in her jacket where the buttons didn't quite fasten.

"Joanne," my wife replied. "Tell him it's Joanne. He'll know who I am."

"She says she's called Joanne," we heard Mack talking through the gap in the door when he disappeared out of sight once more. "Yes. Brunette. Good-looking. Big tits."

Jo rolled her eyes when she heard him say that, glancing at me and shaking her head, then she pushed the door further open. "Can you fucking hurry up? I don't have all day to waste. Tell Bill I need to see him. Now."

"She says she needs to see you now," Mack spoke down the phone he had pressed to his ear, stopping Jo from opening the door any further by putting one booted foot against it. Then he listened to what his boss had to say before finally moving his foot.

"Sorted?" Jo said as he hung up.

"Yeah," the tough-looking blonde man grunted. "Come in and wait. Bill will join us in a few minutes."

"Cool," Jo smiled at him and walked past but when I tried to follow, Mack put a tattooed hand on my chest.

"You can wait outside," he replied. "I don't know who the fuck you are."

"He's my husband," Jo said, pausing and looking back at me. "But if he has to wait outside, that's cool."

"No," I shook my head, even as Mack took a step forward and pushed me back out of the door. "Jo, don't go in alone. Tell Bill to let me in too."

“It’s cool,” Jo winked at me. “Trust me. I’ve got this. I just need to speak to Bill to see how we’re going to deal with Frank. I won’t be long.”

“No fucking way,” I said, getting angry but Mack shoved me backwards again, almost knocking me over and gave me a threatening look.

“Back off man,” he said in a scarily calm tone. “She’s safe. We’re not going to hurt her, okay? If she’s the Joanne that Bill told me stories about, she can handle herself. She doesn’t need you to protect her.”

“No, I don’t,” Jo replied, giving me an urgent look which told me to calm down. “I’ll be okay.”

“Do we have a problem?” a nasal voice said from behind me, making me turn around slowly. Standing on the path was a tall man with close-cropped black hair and a short but thick beard.

“Bandit Bill,” Jo said, smiling as she recognised him. “You haven’t changed a bit.”

“My dear Joanne,” the man smiled, walking past me as though I didn’t even exist. “You’ve changed... filled out, shall we say?”

“He’s here now,” Mack said to me, backing away but leaving me standing a few feet from the door where he’d last pushed me. “Go wait in your car or wherever you came from. She’s in good hands, I promise.”

“Is your friend worried about your welfare?” Bill turned away from admiring Jo to appraise me instead.

“He’s my husband, Simon,” Jo introduced me.

“Husband?” Bill stroked his bearded chin. “Interesting. Well, I’ll tell you what, Simon, take out your phone and take a photograph of Mack and me with Joanne. Then, if anything happens to her, you’ve got the evidence that you need to show to the police. You’ll have our faces on camera. Does that make you feel better?”

“I don’t need to do that,” I said, licking my lips and choosing my words carefully. The tall-wiry man didn’t look particularly frightening but he had an aura about him which felt off. I didn’t like him at all. “Just let me come in with Jo. I won’t say a word. I’ll just sit there while she deals with the Frank situation.”

“Take the photograph,” Bill said, lowering his strangely-nasal voice. “It wasn’t a suggestion, Simon. Take the photo and fuck off for a while.”

“Just do it,” Jo said from where she was standing, right beside Bill.

“Fine. Whatever,” I said, pulling my phone from my pocket as Bill and Mack stood either side of Jo, the three of them smiling ironically for the

camera. I took the picture, then put the phone back in my pocket. “Happy now?”

“It’s not about me being happy.” Bill was still smiling weirdly at me. “It’s about you, Simon. Now leave us. Joanne and I have a problem we need to work out between us. It’s best that you stay out of it.”

I was about to reply when Mack laughed and shut the door firmly in my face. I stood there for a couple of minutes, bristling with anger but also filled with anxiety until I heard another voice, this time a young woman’s, shout through the door.

“Fuck off from in front of the door,” she snapped. “Mack says if you don’t go back to your car or at least just get out of our sight, he’s going to come out there and move you himself. And that won’t be fun, let me tell you.”

I didn’t reply. I just bunched my fists and gritted my teeth in frustration then finally, I paced away, walking back towards where Frank and Brad were parked. I didn’t intend on going all the way back to the car, even close-by as it was. I was going to find a wall to sit on while waiting, but the December sky clouded over and a cold, fine drizzle began to fall from the sky, so I kept on walking until I got to the black BMW that we’d driven here in.

“They didn’t let you in, huh?” Frank said, winding the window down as I tapped on the glass.

“Nope. Is she going to be okay?” I asked as he unlocked the back door so I could get in, out of the rain.

“Yeah, Bill won’t hurt her.” Frank turned in the driver’s seat to look at me, shivering with a mixture of the cold and wet weather along with my still-bubbling anger and nervousness for Jo’s safety. “Tell me what happened.”

I told him how Mack had tried to turn us away, then called Bill when she said she was an old friend. I recited everything that had happened and been said almost word-for-word, including how Bill had looked her up and down when he’d mentioned her ‘filling out.’

“Well, he’s not wrong,” Frank chuckled. “When we first started dating, Joanne was as skinny as a rake. She had a pair of tits on her still, but she was very slender. First thing I noticed about her when I saw her yesterday after fifteen years was how curvy she is now. She’s got an ass. She never had an ass before. And her tits? All I’m going to say is you’re a lucky man,

Simon, getting to play with those huge titties. They look like they've gone up a few cup sizes over the years."

"She does have a nice figure for an older woman," Brad added, drawing an amused look from Frank.

"Are her tits still as firm?" Frank asked me with a raised eyebrow. "Sorry. I shouldn't ask. It's just... you know, some women in their thirties, their bodies look great until the clothes come off and then you realise it's all gone south."

"No, you shouldn't ask," I replied tersely. "I know you two were married once, but she's my wife now and we're doing a favour for you. You should have a bit of respect."

"I'm sorry, I'm sorry." Frank waved his hands in surrender. "I shouldn't have asked, as I said. Come on though, tell us. Man to man. I won't tell her you said anything. Does she still have a nice hairy pussy? I know girls shave them these days but I always liked a nice hairy pussy. Makes a woman a woman, you know?"

I didn't answer. I just shook my head as he and Brad both started laughing at my discomfort. I stared out of the window, trying to ignore them while watching for a sign of Jo and keeping an eye on my phone for her call.

The two men didn't tease me any further as we waited, instead just discussing between the two of them what we should do for lunch after Brad's stomach growled loudly in the car.

"It's been nearly forty minutes," I said later, after checking my watch. I was feeling increasingly anxious and wanted to head back to the flat to see what was going on.

"I'm sure she's fine," Frank turned again to look at me. "If she's not back in another twenty minutes maybe I'll send Brad with you to the flat."

Right then, my phone finally rang.

"Jo?" I said, answering it quickly. "Are you okay?"

"I'm fine," she replied, just as quick. She probably knew how nervous I must be. "Tell Frank it's sorted. I'm on my way back to the car."

I told Frank she was fine and got out of the car, jogging towards the flats and meeting her halfway.

"Are you really okay?" I said, relieved to see that she looked exactly how I'd left her. I don't know what I'd expected. For some reason, I'd

imagined her coming out of Mack's flat with a black eye or a cut lip, or worse. Me and my stupid imagination.

"Of course I am," she said, hugging me tightly. "I'm a lot tougher than you know. Bill was an absolute gentleman but I'll tell you all about it when we get back to the car. It'll save me repeating it to Frank if I tell you both at once."

To my slight surprise, Frank looked just as relieved as I did when we got back, both getting in the backseat, out of the persistent cold drizzle.

"Well?" the big man asked, his eyes on Jo as she grinned at him.

"All sorted," Jo shrugged. "As you said, Bill was a sucker for my charms. It was almost too easy."

"And?" Frank grunted impatiently.

"Bill's got your money, you were right," Jo explained. "But he hasn't spent it. Well, not much of it. He moved it. Hidden it."

"And is he going to give it back?" Frank seemed genuinely surprised, his hand rubbing the top of his bald head. "Did you remind him that half of it is technically yours?"

"Yes, I did. He wants a meeting to discuss it with you," Jo revealed. "He says he'll give the money back if you help him with something."

"I'm okay for a meeting," Frank nodded. "What thing does he want help with?"

"I don't know," Jo shrugged. "He wouldn't tell me. Says he wants to discuss it with you personally. So, I've arranged a meeting."

"You have?" I said, butting in because I had an awful feeling what she was going to say next. And I was right.

"Yes," Jo replied, putting a hand on my knee and squeezing hard to warn me not to interrupt further. "You're meeting him at the pub. Tonight."

Chapter 7

“I can’t believe you invited these men here,” I glared at Jo as Bill walked into the pub that evening. With him was the man we’d met earlier; Mack, and two more people, a young man with ginger hair and a certain swagger about him and a gorgeous girl with long hair, dyed electric-blue.

“I did what I had to do,” Jo apologised. “I’m sorry but I just wanted to get this over and done with. Let them meet up and sort their shit out and then we can get on with our lives, Simon.”

I was standing next to Jo behind the bar, watching Bill and his three companions sit down next to Frank and Brad, who were already sitting down waiting for them at the table in the corner, the same place we’d sat last night.

“You could be putting the pub at risk. Our business. Everything,” I said, shaking my head at Jo’s reckless decision. I was fuming with her but had tried not to show it earlier in front of Frank. Embarrassing my wife wouldn’t help the situation at all, but now, a few hours later we were finally away from her ex-husband and I couldn’t help but express my annoyance.

“Stop being so overdramatic,” Jo said, folding her arms under her breasts while keeping her eyes on the five people sitting in the corner.

“I’m not being overdramatic,” I insisted. “What if a fight starts? It could ruin our reputation. What if the police get involved and find out we’ve been letting ex-cons have their *business* meetings in our pub?”

“Frank and Bill have too much respect for me to cause us any problems like that,” Jo said, looking at me briefly before returning her attention to them.

“Right,” I said, still simmering. “Whatever.”

“Simon, if I’d known you were so much of a fucking pussy, I’d never have married you.” Jo shot me an ‘if-looks-could-kill’ glare and then turned on her heel and walked through the door behind the bar into the backrooms.

“Shit,” I cursed, realising I’d been too hard on her but even so... pussy? I wasn’t a pussy, at all. I just wasn’t used to dealing with scummy

people like she was. Working behind a bar; running a pub, you came into contact with problematic people and I could deal with that, but these weren't just revellers who'd had a few pints too many. These were serious criminals. People who'd robbed and stolen and killed. Jo had spent time with these sorts of people before. I hadn't. Surely she should understand why I wasn't as comfortable around them as she was?

"Are you Joanne's husband?" the young ginger-haired man said as he approached the bar.

"Simon," I nodded as I introduced myself.

"I'm Alfie," the freckle-faced youngster grinned at me, laughter lines growing at the corners of his eyes. Now he was closer, I realised he wasn't quite as young as he first appeared, maybe in his late twenties. "Me and Beth, we work for Bill. He sent us over for drinks."

Beth must be the stunning blue-haired woman sitting next to Frank and laughing at everything he said. "Beth's your girlfriend?" I asked.

"That's right. So don't you go getting ideas of hitting on her," Alfie grinned at me again, his green eyes twinkling and then he laughed out loud. I wasn't sure what he found so amusing so I took his drinks order and turned away, feeling slightly unsettled and hoping that he'd go back to the table but he didn't. He waited for me to pour the drinks, then called Mack over to help him carry them to the table.

"Hi, Simon," Mack said, biting his top lip as though to stifle a laugh. "Where's your wife? Is she hiding from us, away in the back somewhere?"

"She's got a few things to do," I lied. "I told her I'd be fine on my own for a bit."

"You sure?" Mack and Alfie looked at each other, exchanging another grin and then carried the drinks; a selection of beers and whisky, back to the table on the trays I passed to them.

What was so funny? Whatever it was, it was irritating me but I sucked in a deep breath and told myself to chill. I had to let the two factions have their meeting, thrash out whatever deal they were working on and then kick them out at the end of the night, all without a fight occurring. Once they were done, hopefully, that would be it and life could get back to normal.

Then another guy walked in, someone I hadn't seen before. He was smartly dressed, tall and handsome, with dark hair and pale eyes and from his demeanour, I could somehow tell he was one of Frank or Bill's friends before he even walked over the table to join them.

I watched him talk to Frank for a moment but before he sat down, he looked across at me, nodded and then walked over.

“It seems that I’m late and I missed the first round of drinks,” he smiled disarmingly. “Can I get a soda and lime, please?”

“Driving?” I questioned, returning the smile.

“Yes, but it’s not stopping some of them over there,” he nodded towards the friends behind him. “But I’m not stupid, so yes, I’ll take a soda and lime, if that’s okay? Where’s Joanne?”

“She’s just in the back doing a couple of little jobs while I look after the bar.” I poured him the drink and he paid for it, something that Alfie and Mack hadn’t done. I hoped they were paying the tab at the end of the night and not expecting me to pay it again like I’d done last night, much to my regret as it came to well over a hundred pounds by the time we’d done.

“As long as she’s okay,” the man replied with a gentle nod. “Thanks for the drink. My name’s Charlie, by the way. I’ll see you in a bit.”

Charlie. I remembered the conversation last night.

“The only person Tommy didn’t drop in it was his best mate, Charlie. Charlie was the muscle of the group. He always scared me,” Jo had said.

“Charlie’s a madman. Even I wouldn’t mess with him,” Frank had said. *“He was always a bit in love with you, Joanne. He’d never hurt you. No, Charlie’s all right. We’re still friends. I saw him right before I drove up to Manchester to see you.”*

But Charlie didn’t seem like their description. He’d didn’t come across as scary or a ‘madman.’ He seemed normal. Considerate, charming, friendly. He was tall but slim - certainly not what you’d describe as ‘muscle.’ But maybe that’s how you became successful as a criminal. By hiding in plain sight and not looking like the type of person you really were.

Bill came over to the bar next, rubbing his fingers through his short black beard. “Where’s your lovely wife? Sorry... I forgot your name.”

“Simon,” I reminded him. “I told your friend, Alfie, she’s in the back doing a few jobs that need doing. There’s more to running a pub than just serving on the bar.”

“Ah, I see,” he nodded. “She’s good, is your Joanne. Anyhow, when you’re ready, will you bring over another round of drinks. Same as last time.”

Then he turned and walked to the table, saying something I couldn’t hear and the entire group all laughed out loud while glancing over at me.

All of them apart from Charlie. The good-looking *madman* was using a straw to stir the slice of lime around in what remained of his drink while staring down at the table, deep in thought by the looks of it.

I felt like walking over to them and asking what it was they found so funny, but right then, Jo finally decided to make an appearance.

"I'm sorry," she said, joining me behind the bar and taking my hand in hers. "I didn't mean to be horrid to you. I'm just a bit on edge."

"Me too," I shrugged and smiled at her even though I was still angry with her for calling me a pussy. "It's understandable. They seem to be behaving themselves though, so don't worry."

Jo looked great. She'd made herself look presentable, straightening her usually curly dark brown hair and changing into a tight, black, button-up blouse that showed off her cleavage with the top few buttons undone. It was what she'd normally wear when we went out, not when we were working but I guessed she'd done it to make herself feel better after our mini-argument.

"Is that...?" she asked, suddenly noticing the new arrival. "Shit. That's Charlie. What's *he* doing here?"

"I don't know," I shrugged. "He arrived after the others. Maybe Frank called him as a backup, being outnumbered and all that. You and Frank described him as some sort of nutcase but he seemed nice when he came over for a drink."

"Don't be fooled," my wife squeezed my hand, before letting it go. "There's a lot beneath the surface with Charlie."

"That's what I assumed," I nodded, looking once again at the dark-haired Charlie. He was sitting very still, clearly not in the same frame of mind as the rest of the group who were all laughing and joking together, any tensions between Frank and Bill obviously gone.

"So, nobody has said anything to you about... anything weird or...?" Jo stumbled over her words, most unlike her.

"No, they've been pretty good really." I shook my head as she walked around to the other side of the bar, watching them the whole time. "They were having a laugh at my expense earlier, I think. Maybe they saw us have that little spat earlier, I don't know. I don't care. Whatever it is they think is funny, they're keeping it to themselves, so it's fine. Let them have their fun."

Jo's eyebrows raised as I said that and her eyes lowered to the floor, then she quickly looked back up at me and smiled. What was wrong with her?

"I'm going to go over and join in the conversation if you don't mind?" She chewed her bottom lip for a moment. "I want to make it clear that once they're done, I want them out of our lives."

"Well, be nice about it," I told her. "And remind them that someone's got to pay for the drinks tonight. I'm not forking out again after last night."

Jo nodded, her eyes downcast again as she walked over to the table. I watched as both Frank and Bill made room for her, but she chose her ex-husband to sit next to. Bill pouted comically and something was said which again made the whole group laugh - apart from Charlie - and again they all looked my way before they'd finished laughing. They had definitely seen us argue earlier. That's what it was.

It couldn't be anything else? Could it?

Chapter 8

As the night wore on, Frank came over and reassured me that he'd pick up the bar bill for tonight, then as he walked away, he gave me a strange wink. I had no idea why, but as time ticked by, getting ever closer to closing time, I felt more and more uneasy.

"I need to talk to you when everyone has gone," Jo said, finally returning from the table after spending a couple of hours with them. She swayed as she lifted the latch and joined me behind the bar.

"How many have you had?" I asked her, smiling at her comical stagger.

"A couple too many, it would seem," she replied, holding onto the bar for a moment to gather her balance. "I didn't think I'd drunk that much, but maybe I did."

"You might still have some alcohol in your system from last night," I suggested. "Go grab yourself a coffee to sober up. I'm okay here."

"I will. I need to ring Kathryn too. I forgot earlier and she's been texting me all day, wondering how it all went earlier."

"Go do that," I told her and she did, wobbling through the back door and out of the bar just as Bill's group stood up from the table, apparently ready to leave because they shook hands with Frank, Brad and Charlie as they got up. The black-bearded man waved towards me, laughing again at whatever it was he found funny before leading Alfie, Beth and Mack out of the pub.

I sighed in relief. It looked like it had gone well. Frank, Charlie and Brad had their heads together as soon as the others left, discussing something, their faces all seriousness now, before Frank pushed himself - somewhat unsteadily - to his feet and walked over to the bar.

"Thank you for tonight." He offered me his hand for some reason. I shook it. "You're a nice guy, Simon. A bit too nice, but I like you."

"Um, thanks," I said hesitantly. Frank was clearly slightly the worse for wear and that made me feel uncomfortable. "I hope the meeting went

okay. Is Bill giving you your money back?”

“There’s a bit more to it than that, but the meeting went well, yes.”

Brad walked over, sighing loudly as he leaned on the bar. “Frank, I think I’m going to bed. I can’t drink as much as the rest of you can.”

“Yes,” the big man agreed. “Me too. Fifteen years in the nick have made me soft. Simon, I’ll sort payment out with you in the morning when I’m a bit more *with it*.”

Without waiting for an answer, the two men walked through the back door towards the upstairs of the pub. They hadn’t even asked if they could stay a second night, although I’d assumed it was happening as they also hadn’t mentioned otherwise.

“Are you okay?”

I turned to see Charlie, the last of the group, approach the bar, his second or third lime and soda in hand.

“I’m fine,” I said, looking around the bar at the last few customers who were still hanging around. “I just need to get the stragglers out so I can lock up. You can give me a hand if you want?”

“Sure,” Charlie smiled again, all charm and no signs of the madman that Frank and Jo had warned me of. He followed me around the pub, asking the reluctant-to-go-home drinkers to finish their beers and leave and within just a few minutes, the pub was empty and I set about locking the doors and shutting down the bar.

“Has Joanne talked to you at all?” Charlie asked. “I saw her come over but then she seemed to go straight into the back.”

“She did say that she wanted to talk,” I nodded, removing the nozzles from the beer pumps which I had to turn off next. “But she’d overestimated her ability to drink - like usual - so I sent her to get a coffee and sober up.”

“Ah.” Charlie walked away, then returned with several empty glasses that he’d collected from the tables.

“Thanks,” I smiled gratefully, taking them from him and loading up the glasswasher for the last cycle. I needed Charlie to leave because the last job was cashing up the till and I didn’t fancy doing that with an acknowledged criminal watching.

“Frank and Bill have done a deal,” Charlie said, sitting on a barstool, not making any move to leave just yet. “Bill’s got one last job. A big one. If Frank helps him, which Frank is all too eager to do considering the potential money involved, then Bill will tell him where the money is.”

“I’m surprised Frank went for that,” I replied, not wanting to be too interested. “Surely, the money’s his and he shouldn’t have to appease Bill to get it.”

“You don’t know Frank,” Charlie sighed, his long fingers sweeping along the bar and seeing it was sticky. “Pass me a cloth. I’ll wipe the bar down for you.”

Why was he being so helpful? I soaked a cloth in the sink and tossed it over to him along with some bar cleaner. “You don’t have to help. You can get off home if you want, Charlie.”

“I wanted to talk to you,” he said, rubbing the wooden bar top with the cloth.

“Look, as long as they’re not getting Jo involved, then it’s not my business what Frank and Bill get up to,” I said, starting to feel slightly uneasy at Charlie’s continued presence.

“All done,” Charlie said, tossing the dirty cloth into the sink from where he was standing several feet away and then handing me back the bottle of bar cleaner. “Simon, I know it’s not for me to tell you this, but someone needs to and I have a feeling that Joanne isn’t going to, despite what she says.”

“Tell me what?” I said, the feeling of unease growing in the pit of my stomach.

“I told Joanne to tell you before you found out some other way but unless she’s making the world’s biggest coffee, she’s clearly chickened out.”

“She was drunk,” I defended my wife, although I was wondering why she hadn’t at least asked me if I wanted any help closing up. “She’s probably laid down and passed out or something.”

“You seem like a nice guy.” Charlie didn’t argue with my reasoning. “You shouldn’t be getting involved with Frank or Bill or any of these guys. Even me, although I’m different, in a lot of ways to them.”

“What are you trying to say?” I asked, my impatience at odds with the gnawing feeling in my gut. “Whatever it is you want to say, just say it.”

“You need to ask Joanne how she got around Bill so easily this afternoon,” Charlie said, folding his arms and staring at me over the bar as I met his gaze. “You might want to have a think about why they were all laughing at you this evening.”

My heart thudded in my chest. What was he implying? I wanted to say something but I couldn't. For some reason, my throat grew tight and no words came out so I just shook my head at him.

"How much do you know about Joanne?" Charlie continued, his pale blue eyes boring into mine. "About before she met you. About her and Frank and Danny. You know they had a threesome? And a foursome? Frank, Joanne, Danny and Sharon. You know all this stuff, yeah? Do you know how Bill wanted to fuck her? How he tried it on time and time again, not just because he enjoyed pissing Frank off but because he was crazy about her? Frank thought it was funny. He knew Joanne would never cheat on him - she was madly in love and totally devoted to him, plus she daren't. She knew Frank would kill her if she ever cheated. Frank used Joanne as his trophy wife, in a way. He deliberately showed her off - to me, to Bill, to Tommy. He'd make her wear skimpy outfits, he loved us lusting after her. It was his way of letting us know that he was the boss. He'd encourage Joanne to flirt with us, lead us on, then he'd warn us at the last minute not to get any ideas. Mind games. It was all mind games. The only man who ever got to fuck her was Danny and that was only because Frank wanted to fuck Sharon."

"I didn't know that," I said, as he finally stopped talking. "Well, I knew that Bill and Tommy had a crush on her or whatever. They told me about that."

"And me. I don't mind admitting it," Charlie smiled - that disarming smile again. "She's still beautiful, all these years later. I mean that as a compliment, Simon. Anyway, I digress. Look, all I'm saying is you need to ask her what happened with Bill this afternoon and why they were all laughing every time they spoke to you. You need to know. You deserve better than that."

"Are you suggesting she...?" I couldn't bring myself to say the words. Jo wouldn't have done anything sexual with Bill, surely? The man practically oozed sleaziness.

"I'm not suggesting anything," Charlie finally headed towards the exit. "Bill was bragging about it all evening. I won't go into detail because it's not my place to, but you should know what happened, okay? Talk to her, Simon. I'm sure she did what she did because there was no other way."

"You mean they forced her?" I asked, my heart sinking through the floor.

“No, no, no,” Charlie shook his head vehemently. “Don’t let her tell you that. That’s not Bill’s style at all. She did what she had to do to get Bill to talk. Look, I’ve said enough. Let me out, then go talk to your wife.”

I walked slowly towards the exit door where he was standing. I felt dazed and confused. This was some sort of trick. A lie, to unsettle me. Charlie himself had admitted to loving Joanne. Perhaps he was jealous. Jealous and spiteful.

I opened the door for him and Charlie walked out, but before I could say goodbye and close it behind him, he turned one last time. A black car was outside waiting for him, the engine running and a driver in a pulled-up hoodie at the steering wheel.

“And Simon,” he said. “Don’t leave Frank and Joanne on their own. Frank wants to fuck her and he’ll do everything he can to get in her panties one more time before he heads off to this job. He won’t let Bill get one over on him like that. Did you feel Joanne get out of bed last night? Sometime during the middle of the night?”

“I did,” I tried to swallow but I couldn’t. My throat was so tight.

“Talk to her,” Charlie said, then walked to the car and got in the passenger seat. I saw him and the hooded figure exchange words and then the car sped away down the street.

I closed the door and locked it, feeling like my entire world had fallen apart.

I needed to talk to Jo. Right now. Where was she? Where was Frank?
Fuck.

Chapter 9

I quickly cashed up the till, not even counting it up properly. I just stuffed the cash into money bags and locked it securely in the cellar safe, then turned the lights off, set the alarm and headed into the backroom nervously.

Jo wasn't in the downstairs kitchen, the storeroom or the office so she had to have gone upstairs. Again, I turned all the lights off and walked up the stairs to the living area, my heart pounding heavily in my chest again at what might be going on.

As it turned out, nothing was going on at all. I got myself a drink of water from the kitchen and finding it deserted, I looked in the living room. That was also empty and in darkness, so I headed to our bedroom.

Jo was on the bed, still fully-dressed and fast asleep. A half-drunk cup of coffee was on the bedside table, I noted, as I looked around for any sign that Frank might have been in here with her.

What was I thinking? I was being paranoid again. Nothing was going on. Charlie had a thing for Jo. Frank had teased his friends, knowing how much they all fancied her, and Charlie probably resented Jo still for her part in that. He was trying to put ideas in my head. Trying to make me paranoid. Trying to split Jo and me up but he wasn't going to succeed. My opinion was that Charlie was this spiteful asshole of a guy who, with his handsome looks, thought he could have any woman he wanted - but he'd never been able to have Jo and that rankled him. That was all it was. I had to trust Jo. He'd tried to make me feel like I didn't know my wife, but I did.

I slipped out of the bedroom, being careful not to wake her and tiptoed down the hallway to Frank's room. The door was closed, so I put an ear against it, listening for movement inside. Nothing. I knelt down and peered under the gap below the door. The room beyond was dark, so I stood up and very carefully opened the door. Frank was in bed, his huge form mostly covered up by the sheets. I couldn't tell at first if he was sleeping, but he let out a loud snore so I slowly closed the door again.

Why had I been so worried? I went to the bathroom, brushed my teeth and took myself to bed. I wasn't that tired but I felt a powerful urge to hold Jo in my arms. Everything that Charlie had said; all the doubts that he'd put in my head, I knew they'd go away when I felt the warmth of my amazing wife against me.

Jo was still asleep on top of the covers, so I shook her awake gently.

"Jo," I said softly. "Get undressed and in bed. I'm here now."

"What?" she said, opening her pretty blue eyes, disoriented for a second. "Oh yeah. Shit. I'm sorry. I felt dizzy and came for a nap. What time is it?"

"Almost one in the morning," I replied. "It's okay. Charlie, of all people, helped me lock up after everyone else had gone. Frank and Brad decided to stay over again. They're already asleep."

"Charlie helped you?" Jo sat up, still looking tired and slightly confused. "I hope he didn't cause any bother."

"No. We had an interesting chat," I said as Jo got up and unbuttoned her shirt. "He doesn't seem like the ruthless, crazy person you made him out to be. I think he's still got a thing for you. Even all these years later."

Jo took the top off, her large breasts coming into sight as I realised she hadn't been wearing a bra underneath. Her dark pink nipples stiffened as they met the cool air. Then she stripped off her jeans and climbed beneath the bedsheets in just her panties.

"I told you, he's good at pretending to be something he's not but I doubt he still has the hots for me. He hasn't seen me for a long time," Jo said as she lay down. "Charlie's good-looking. He's probably got a wife back home. Maybe a mistress too."

"Maybe," I undressed and got into bed alongside Jo, putting my arms around her and drawing her against my chest. I loved this woman so much. Should I tell her what he'd said? Should I ask her about Bill, like he'd told me to?

"Don't go getting any ideas," Jo murmured quietly. "I'm too tired and drunk for any of *that* tonight. Just cuddle me and go to sleep."

"Okay," I replied. I wasn't tired but I could probably sleep if I closed my eyes and relaxed.

It took me a while. Jo's breathing changed as she fell asleep almost immediately but it took me at least an hour before I managed to drift off. My mind was full of uninvited images; of Jo and Bill having sex in some

tiny, run-down flat while Mack, Alfie and Beth watched and egged them on. Another mental image, of Frank fucking Jo doggy-style on the spare bed while I was asleep last night. For some reason, my cock got hard at the thoughts, just like it had last night, but I resisted the temptation to jerk off. The warmth of Jo, sleeping in my arms was too wonderful and helped me to fall asleep eventually.

I woke, this time woken as Jo prised herself gently from my arms. I didn't open my eyes right away. I released her, feeling a brief cold draught wash across me as she got out of bed, before putting the covers gently over me again. I heard her tread softly around the bed, then the sound of our bedroom door opening and closing as she left the room.

She was probably just going to the bathroom again. I listened for the sound of the bathroom light switch, or some other noise that would indicate that the bathroom was where she'd gone but heard nothing.

I couldn't be bothered to get out of bed. I was too sleepy, too warm and comfortable. I laid there, waiting for Jo to come back but after a few minutes, when she still wasn't back, I opened my eyes and sat up, stopping myself from falling asleep.

The red digits of the alarm clock on the bedside shone in the darkness.
3.50 AM.

I waited a couple more minutes. Still, Jo didn't come back. I tried to estimate how long she'd been gone since she first got out of bed. Ten minutes? Fifteen?

I waited a little longer until the clock ticked to 4.00 AM.

I swung my legs out of bed, telling myself I was being paranoid. Jo would be in the bathroom, just taking an extraordinarily long time, like women sometimes did.

It was cold. I had the heating set to go off at one in the morning and come back on at six for an hour before we usually got up. I grabbed my dressing gown from the hook on the back of the bedroom door and wrapped it around myself, then walked out onto the landing, stopping almost immediately when I heard something.

I wasn't sure what it was. It sounded like a quiet cough. Muffled, like someone clearing their throat into their hand. I wasn't sure but it sounded like it had come from the direction of Frank's room.

I could see from where I was, standing outside our bedroom in the darkness, that the bathroom door was open and the light was off. Jo wasn't

in there. That paranoid feeling returned. Where was she?

My eyes adjusted better to the dark as I quietly padded down the upstairs hallway towards Frank's room, listening out for any more sounds. As I approached it, I heard something - this time recognisable as Jo's voice, coming from the ajar door to Frank's bedroom.

The door wasn't open very far but the gap was enough for me to carefully peer through. The hallway was dark, there was barely any light on the landing - but the curtains in Frank's room were thin enough to let some of the murky street light shine through from outside.

It still took me a second to work out the shapes in front of me. My view was restricted through the narrow gap between the door and frame, so I had to move from side to side to take in the full view of the bed but I quickly managed to work out that Frank was laid on the bed, on his back, the covers pulled back. Then I realised that the dark shape blocking my view of his lower half was Jo. She had her back towards me, I managed to figure that out, then when I saw that the top part of the shape - her head - was bobbing up and down, I realised what was going on.

Shit. She was sucking his cock.

I heard that weird coughing sound again.

"Stop pushing my head down," Jo whispered, barely loud enough for me to hear. "You're making me gag on it."

"Shut up," I heard Frank reply, just as quietly. "You used to be able to deep throat it all when you were younger."

"That was when I was young," Jo hissed back at him. "I'm not used to it now. Simon's only got a small one."

"I know. You told me last night. Now shut up and suck it. I'm close."

I staggered away from the door, feeling suddenly nauseous like I'd been punched in the stomach. My beautiful Jo, my wonderful wife, was not only sucking her ex-husband's cock but hearing her talk like that about me too... I felt like my heart had been ripped out.

I couldn't breathe. I stood up straight, sucking in a deep gulp of air, trying to clear my whirling mind and desperately attempting to contain the sudden storm of emotions that were flooding through me.

"Oh, fuck," I heard Frank say, then he groaned. "Go on. Swallow it all, Joanne. Fuck, yeah. That's a good girl. You always were the best at sucking dick."

I daren't step back to the door to look through, as much as I wanted to. Jo could walk out at any second and catch me there, watching and listening. I retraced my steps back to our bed and got under the covers, pulling them up and over my head, trying to pretend the world didn't exist. Pretending that what I'd seen hadn't really happened. Trying to convince myself that this was a bad dream.

I should have burst into the room. I should have grabbed her by her dark hair and pulled her off him. I should have... done... something. But I didn't.

If she was sucking Frank's dick, maybe she'd done more with him. Maybe she'd fucked him and was just finishing him off with her mouth. Perhaps she'd sucked him last night too. Charlie had inferred as much. And if she'd done that - what *had* she done with Bill earlier?

I'd never felt emotional pain like it. I'd heard the expression heartache, but now I felt it - physically, like a twisting of my insides, from my stomach right through my chest. Jo. My Jo. How could you do this to me?

I heard the bathroom door close and the soft click of the pull switch that worked the light. Was it Frank or Jo? Then I heard the light switch again a couple of minutes later, followed by soft footsteps and then our door opening and closing.

Again, a blast of cold air, smaller this time as Jo slid into bed next to me - very gently lifting the covers - before quickly going still next to me. Like she hadn't moved at all.

I felt like I should turn over and face her. I felt like I should demand to know the truth. She'd cheated on me. Was this even the first time? Even before Frank and Bill, had there been others?

My entire life was a lie.

Then why did my rock-hard cock feel like it was going to explode?

I felt dirty, disgusted with myself. I'd gotten aroused at the sight - as hard to distinguish as it was - of Jo sucking Frank. Especially because I knew how impressive his dick was. I'd never made Jo gag, even when I'd thrust right into her mouth in the throes of my orgasm.

I felt betrayed by Jo and disgusted with myself. Exploited by Frank. Humiliated by Bill. I was hurt and I was angry. But I didn't say or do anything. I needed time to think. If I confronted Jo about it - whether that be now or in the morning - while Frank was still here, I was opening a massive

can of worms. One that could explode right in my face in the worst possible way.

If this was the end for Jo and I, what happened with the business? Everything we'd built together during the last fifteen years together - gone. Just like that.

No, I needed time to think. If this wasn't all down to Jo, if she'd been coerced somehow, if this was her way of getting Frank and Bill out of our lives because we were in some sort of danger, then perhaps - *perhaps* - I could find a way of forgiving her. We could move past it together, somehow.

She at least deserved a chance to explain, I decided. But not yet. Not while Frank was around. Once he'd gone; once he'd moved on, I'd tell her what I'd seen tonight and what Charlie had told me. And I'd see what she had to say for herself.

But for now, despite my erection screaming at me to empty my balls, I closed my eyes tight and tried to go to sleep.

Chapter 10

“Good morning,” Jo said as I walked into the kitchen the following morning. She’d gotten up before me and was sitting at the table with Frank. Brad was nowhere to be seen.

“Morning,” I said, sitting at the table opposite her big ex-husband while she finished cooking.

“I’ve made a cooked breakfast,” she said, leaving the cooker to put three plates on the table. “Bacon, eggs, toast, the full works.”

“Not making any for Brad?” I asked, assuming the youngster was in bed nursing a hangover again.

“I’ve sent him out on an errand,” Frank said. “We’ve got plans and a few things to put in place today.”

“I heard about your plans,” I said, forcing a fake smile at my cheating wife as she loaded up my plate with gorgeous-smelling bacon and eggs. “One last job, eh?”

Frank gazed at me, his expression unreadable. “Something like that,” he said after a moment.

“Charlie told me,” I explained. “He stayed behind last night after everyone else had gone and helped me lock up.”

“You told me last night,” Jo said, sitting next to me. I slid my chair a few inches away from her, not wanting her to touch me. I was still livid at what she’d done but now wasn’t the time to say anything. “What else did he tell you?” she asked.

I glanced at Jo, playing it cool. “Not much. I think he just genuinely wanted to help out. No one told me what the outcome of the meeting was, so I asked him. He said Frank had done a deal with Bill for one more job and then Frank will get his stash back.”

“That’s right,” Frank said around a mouthful of bacon. “Sorry we didn’t tell you last night but once the job’s done, we’ll be out of your hair, Simon.”

“Once the job’s done?” I asked, feeling alarmed at the prospect of Frank sticking around any longer than was necessary. “I thought you’d be going home today. Jo did what you asked and sorted things with Bill.”

“I said he could stay a few more days when he asked me this morning,” Jo replied, not meeting my gaze when I looked sideways at her.

“And you didn’t think to ask me first?” My anger was starting to get the better of me.

“I’m sorry,” Jo said quickly, still not making eye contact. “I didn’t think you’d mind.”

Is it so you can suck his big dick some more? I kept my thoughts to myself as an awkward silence settled over the breakfast table.

“If it’s a problem, we can find somewhere else to stay?” Frank said in a pissed-off sounding voice after he’d finished eating.

“No, it’s not a problem, Frank,” Jo said quickly, finally looking at me with an alarmed look on her face. “You can stay here as long as it takes. Simon. We need to talk. Now.”

“Yes, we probably do,” I said, managing to keep my annoyance in check this time.

“Thank you for the breakfast, Joanne,” Frank placed both of his large hands on the table and pushed himself to his feet. “I’m going to meet Charlie now and sort out the details of you know what. Our last job.”

He said those last three words with some vitriol in his voice which was clearly aimed at me. I felt suddenly worried that I’d gotten on the wrong side of him but I hadn’t actually said anything bad to Frank. My anger had all been directed towards Jo, who watched her ex-husband walk out of the door before rounding on me.

“What the fuck are you playing at?” she shouted. “Do you want to get us all killed or something?”

“Killed?” I scoffed. “Stop exaggerating, Jo. I’ve not done or said anything to warrant Frank being mad. If he is, it’s his problem.”

“*His* problem is *our* problem, Simon.” Jo stood up, collecting the breakfast pots and I noticed her hands were shaking. “We’re caught up with Frank for the time being whether we like it or not. Now you’ve told him you know about the job with Bill, you know too much for him to let us get out of it. Why the hell did you have to say anything?”

“It would have been nice to at least be asked if I’m happy letting your criminal ex-husband continue to stay in our house,” I hissed at her. “If you

don't tell me what's going on, how do you expect me to do or say the right thing?"

"You need to just trust me," Jo turned her back on me, filling the sink with hot water. "I know Frank. I know how to deal with everything. You don't. Just let me sort it at all, okay?"

Oh yeah, you know how to deal with everything. You knew how to deal with Bill. Suck his dick or something, that's how you deal with Bill. Keep Frank happy by sucking his cock too. That's how you deal with Frank. And you think I should trust you?

Again, I kept my thoughts to myself. Now wasn't the time for the inevitable, massive, potentially marriage-ending row that would follow those words.

"Frank and I tried to keep you out of last night's meeting deliberately. We didn't tell you anything because we were trying to protect you," Jo went on. "The less you know the safer you are. We were trying to keep you not involved, as much as possible, to protect you. But Charlie fucked that up."

He's not the one who's fucked things up, I thought but still kept silent, letting Jo talk.

"I just hope Frank doesn't go crazy on his ass when he meets him this morning," my wife said as she finished washing up. "You've really put the cat amongst the pigeons, Simon."

Before I had a chance to say anything else, she shot me a glare and walked out of the kitchen, leaving me to ponder on what she'd said.

What the hell was I meant to do? I'd just been told that my wife had cheated on me with some dodgy gangster from her past just to appease him and then I'd caught her sucking her ex-husband's dick, leading me to wonder just what she had done with Bill as well as opening the possibility that she'd done this before with someone else. I'd been hoping that Frank would go home today, leaving me alone with Jo so I could bring all of this up in an adult conversation to discuss what it all meant and where we went from here. But now Frank wasn't going home, so the agony was going to be prolonged and the situation was probably going to get worse.

So, for now, I had to find a way to make sure she didn't cheat on me again until the time came when we could talk safely. I couldn't leave her and Frank alone and somehow I had to make sure she didn't do anything with him in the middle of the night.

I sat there with my head in my hands, wondering what I should do. I had to figure out what I wanted first. Did I want my marriage to end? No, I didn't. Not just because of the mess that a divorce would cause - the business was jointly owned between us - but because as much as Jo had hurt me, I still loved her. Some marriages ended when one partner cheated, in fact, most of them did. But I put that down to the two people not loving each other enough to work through it. I loved Jo and although she wasn't doing much to prove it right now, I was sure she loved me too. Even if she'd had full sex with Bill, if it was just a bad decision made for the right reason, perhaps I could get over it. If the blow job with Frank was just a drunken one-off or if she had a valid reason for doing it, then I could forgive that too.

So, if I could get over Jo betraying me as she had, how did I stop her from doing it again? I couldn't keep an eye on her at all times. I had to be able to trust her, which I meant I had to tell her that I knew. We needed to have that conversation, as difficult as it might be, but now that Frank wasn't going away just yet like I'd hoped, I couldn't even take that first step towards fixing things. My thoughts had come full-circle.

"Why the fuck did you have to come here, Frank?" I said out loud to the empty kitchen, then stood up and went to find Jo. I wasn't ready to confront her and tell her what I knew but I did need to at least apologise to her for fucking things up, as she saw it.

"Don't talk to me," she said when she saw me walk into the living room. She was sitting on the sofa, watching TV.

"I came to say sorry." I sat opposite her. "I didn't mean to screw everything up. This... this is hard for me. I feel out of my depth and uncomfortable and I'm sorry."

I watched her body shape soften, her shoulders relaxing and some of the tension in her neck and upper body visibly easing. "Everything's messed up," she said, turning to face me. "I've messed up but you have to give me the time to get us out of this. Just trust me, okay?"

How could I trust her? Did *trusting her* involve Jo fucking her way out of the situation? Was that what she was referring to when she said she'd messed up?

"How long do you think Frank will be sticking around?" I asked with a sigh.

“He discussed it with me this morning. The job they’ve got planned - it’s best you don’t know the details - is for next week. Once it’s done, they’re gone.”

I scrubbed a hand through my short hair. I was facing at least a week of Frank being around. A week of having to constantly monitor Jo and not give them any time together. A week. It felt like a long time, but I could probably do it. A week of discomfort and awkwardness was worth it to save my marriage. I loved Jo, more than anything else in the world. I could forgive her almost anything, she meant that much to me.

If I could minimise the amount of time Jo spent with Frank and I looked after her and didn’t let her anywhere near Bill again, or Charlie, or any of Frank’s other cronies, we might just be okay.

Might.

Chapter 11

I was behind the bar that evening when Frank came back. Jo was having a coffee in the back during her break but I didn't have to worry about him going in the back to be alone with her because he walked right up to the bar and stared me in the eye.

"Charlie says he told you more than just about the deal with Bill," he said. "Pour me a whisky. And have one for yourself. I'll pay for it. We need to talk."

My heart thudded in my chest as he turned and strode away, sitting down in the corner which had become his regular spot.

"Zena," I called over to the pretty dark-skinned barmaid who had just turned up and was having a drink at the bar before her shift was due to start in half an hour. "Would you mind hopping on the bar a bit early? I'll pay you double time for the extra."

"Sure," the pretty girl smiled at me, then I saw her face drop as she noticed Frank in the corner. "Oh no. I was hoping they'd have gone away by now."

"Me too," I said quietly. "I have to sort a few things out with him and he wants to do it now, rather than wait. I'm sorry."

"It's not a problem," Zena smiled but her dark eyes still held some concern. "Are you *sure* everything is okay, Simon?"

"Yeah," I lied. Zena was aware by now of who Frank was; Jo's ex-husband and that he'd spent time in prison. She didn't know all the details but she knew that he was trouble and that he'd been staying with us the last two nights. "It's not ideal but I've got it in hand."

"If you're sure," she said, joining me behind the bar. "If you need any help with anything, my family is kind of useful with things like that... you know, dealing with men like him."

"They are?" I asked, then gave myself a shake. What was I thinking? I couldn't involve Zena or her family, whoever they might be. "Don't worry.

It's all in hand. Frank is just staying here while he sorts his affairs out, then he's heading home - back down south - next week."

I left Zena at the bar and took the two whiskies over to where Frank was sitting and looking out of the window, patiently waiting for me.

"I got us both a double," I told him, sitting opposite and sliding one of the glasses towards him. "Islay. Single malt. It's a good one."

Frank lifted the glass and tasted the amber liquor while looking at me over the rim. "It is good," he said. "Thank you. Now I need you to tell me exactly what Charlie told you last night. Word for word, if you can remember."

"I can't remember word for word," I shrugged. "It was late. I was tired."

"Try," Frank suggested in a low and slightly threatening tone.

"Okay," I said, trying to control my breathing so as not to give away my nerves. "He said something like 'Bill's got one last job. A big one.' He said if you help him then Bill will tell you where your stash is."

Frank didn't say anything. He just nodded, watching me and listening while sipping the whisky.

"Then I said that as long as you're not getting Jo involved, then it's not my business what you get up to."

"I'm not talking about that side of what he said," Frank leaned towards me. "I'm talking about the other stuff. What did he say about Jo? Specifically about Jo, Bill and me."

I shook my head as if I didn't know what he was talking about. "I don't remember, Frank. As I said, it was late and-"

"Don't lie to me, Simon," Frank sat back in his chair, shaking his head. "Lying to me isn't the best idea. Do you remember what I said about me being good at reading people? Don't lie. Just tell me what he said. He's already told me, but I want to make sure he's telling me the truth."

Shit. Charlie had told Frank what he'd said to me about Jo and Bill? Why would he do that? *What the fuck?*

My mind raced. *Fuck. Fuck, fuck, fuck.* What was the best option here? One more look at Frank, his dark eyes glittering beneath those heavy brows made my mind up for me. I should just tell him the truth and see what he had to say for himself.

"He asked me how much I knew about my wife," I said, letting out a deep breath that I hadn't realised I'd been holding in. "He told me that you

had a threesome once with Danny and Jo. And a foursome too, with Sharon. He said that you used Jo to piss the other guys off, him, Bill and Tommy. You know how much they desired her and you used to use Jo to tease them and wind them up.”

“Drink your whisky.” Frank pointed to the untouched glass in front of me. “What else?”

This was the difficult part. I took a drink and waited until the sting of the whisky had passed and then cleared my throat.

“Charlie suggested that Jo did something sexual with Bill yesterday, while she was in his flat. He said that was why everyone was smirking and laughing at me all night.”

There it was. I’d said it. The first part of it, at least.

Frank closed his eyes and shook his head. “Oh, crap,” he said after a moment. “I was hoping he was fooling around earlier when he said he’d told you. So, do you believe him?”

“I don’t know,” I shrugged honestly. “I was going to ask Jo about it once you’d gone. Which was why I was a bit upset this morning when you said you were staying a while longer. I love Jo. If she’s really... *done something* with Bill - for whatever reason - then I wanted to talk about it and try to sort things out.”

“Okay,” Frank nodded. “That’s admirable. It makes sense for a nice guy like you. And what else did Charlie say, Simon? Did he say something about me and Joanne?”

Fuck. This was awkward but there was no point in lying. I’d come this far. I was standing my ground pretty well, I thought.

“He told me not to leave you and Jo alone,” I said, maintaining eye contact with the big man, trying to appear calm and unflustered despite my heart rate rocketing. “Charlie said that you won’t leave until you’ve had sex with her. He even hinted that something might have gone on during the night - the first night you stayed over.”

I didn’t mention last night. He’d only asked what Charlie told me. I had no idea how he’d react if he knew I’d seen Jo sucking his cock.

“Good,” Frank said, finishing off the whisky then waved for Zena to come over. “Hello gorgeous,” he grinned at her, his eyes roaming the young woman’s slim body as he passed her a twenty-pound note. “Can you bring us two more double whiskies over, please? Islay malt, I think it was.”

Zena looked at me and I nodded, once I'd polished off the drink as Frank asked me to. "It's okay," I told her, so she went and brought us the fresh drinks.

"So you were going to wait until I'd gone, then talk to Joanne about it," the big man squinted at me as though sizing me up. "But you weren't going to say anything to me or Bill? Are you scared of us?"

"You have a certain reputation," I replied, trying to hold his gaze but feeling my resolve starting to crumble at his direct response. "I just don't want any trouble. Jo has asked me to trust her when it comes to you and Bill and I'm trying to. I don't like it, but with the greatest of respect, Frank, Jo is my wife and what happens between her and me is none of your business."

"Right," Frank said, a small smile creeping across his lined face. "So you're just going to let me stay here for another week, under your roof, after Charlie told you that I want to fuck your wife?"

"I trust Jo," I replied. Frank had told me not to lie.

"Even though she let Bill fuck her yesterday?"

"That's what Bill is telling everyone, I'm sure," I shrugged and took a big swig of the whisky. *He fucked her? He actually fucked her?* "I'll let Jo tell me the truth when she's ready. I'm sure that whatever she did or didn't do, she had her reasons."

"Oh, he fucked her alright," Frank took a drink too. "She admitted it to me. I never asked her to, but she told me, once she was drunk. I'm not surprised. Bill is a *very* good negotiator. I know Joanne. She's a good woman. She wouldn't have done it if there were any other way. Don't hate her for it, Simon. She loves you. I can see that in her eyes. It was just a fuck. One fuck. It means nothing."

So she really had fucked Bill. For some reason, I felt my cock twitch in my pants at the thought. What was wrong with me? What kind of man got any sort of enjoyment from his wife having to give up her body for information?

"Well, I'll let Jo tell me when she's ready," I repeated, running out of words to say.

"I do want to fuck her," Frank said next, catching me off guard with his directness. "Charlie wasn't lying. If you trust Joanne and you're confident that she won't cheat, you won't mind me trying, right?"

"Try all you like, I do trust her," I said, feeling defeated but trying not to show it.

I didn't trust Jo. I couldn't anymore. She'd already let Frank cum in her mouth last night.

Frank didn't reply. He just nodded and smiled, then took another sip of his whisky.

I needed to stand up for myself. I needed to be a man. I took a deep breath.

"Frank, can I ask you what I've done to earn your disrespect? I let you stay at my home. I've been nothing but friendly and civil to you. But then you say something like that to me. Why?"

I held my breath, waiting for his expected explosive response.

It didn't come. "I'm not disrespecting you," he said quietly. "I'm sorry if you see it that way. I like you. You seem like a nice guy. But I want Joanne. She used to be mine, Simon. I loved her, no matter what Charlie told you. I was heartbroken when she divorced me. I'm over that now. I know *you* make her happy and that makes *me* happy. But I still fancy her and I do want to fuck her. Bill's fucked her and he's laughing at me, not just you. I don't like being laughed at."

"I'm her husband, Frank," I said, shaking my head in disbelief at what he was saying.

"I know. Look, you should see me telling you this as the opposite of disrespect," Frank said with a shake of his head. "I'm telling you I think you deserve my honesty. I actually respect you."

"That makes no sense," I shook my head at him.

"Look at you. You've done everything right in life," Frank said, taking another sip from his glass. "You've never broken the law. I bet you went to school, college, university. Did it all the right way. That's great. I wish I could go back and undo everything I did wrong but I can't. I am what I am. I only know one way to live. I only know how to do one thing well and that's how to steal. I'm too old to change, Simon. If I could swap places with you, I would."

I didn't know what to say, so I just joined him in finishing off the whiskies in front of us.

"I want to fuck Joanne," Frank said with an inappropriately sincere smile. "And I know she wants to fuck me too. You can either let it happen or you can try to stop it and fail. It's just sex, Simon. It means nothing, just like the sex with Bill didn't mean anything. Soon, I'll be gone. Out of your

lives forever and you can do that thing you mentioned - talking to her. Sorting it out. Fixing it and moving on.”

I stared at him, barely able to believe his arrogance. As I wondered what to do or say to that, Jo appeared at my side. I’d been so preoccupied I hadn’t seen her approach.

“Is everything okay?” she asked, anxiety evident on her face as she looked from me to Frank, to the two empty whisky glasses on the table.

“You two need to talk,” Frank said. “Why don’t we all go into the back and discuss things?”

“What have you done now?” Jo fixed an iron stare on me as I stood up.

“He hasn’t done anything,” Frank replied as I got up and walked numbly towards the door behind the bar. “Charlie told him everything last night. And I mean everything.”

“Oh, fuck,” Jo caught up with me and stepped in front of me just as I was about to walk through into the back room. “Simon. You have to let me explain. Please.”

“This should be fun,” I heard Frank say, as I pushed past her and walked into the living room, where I slumped on the sofa.

Then Frank sat opposite, despite neither me nor Jo inviting him to. I looked up at Jo where she was standing in the middle of the room, staring at me. Her face was pale and she had a stricken expression on her face like she was about to cry. She sat down next to me and took my hand, squeezing it gently.

Then she began to explain.

Chapter 12

I looked at my gorgeous wife as she tried to find the right words. Jo's dark curly hair was resting on her shoulders as she looked down into her lap in thought. She was wearing a white t-shirt that hugged her breasts just as tightly as the light blue jeans hugged her legs.

"So how much do you know?" she said eventually in a quiet tone.

"Charlie said you did something with Bill," I muttered, not knowing how to feel. "He didn't say what, but Frank tells me you had sex with him."

"I was going to tell you myself," Jo said, her voice breaking. "I was trying to find the right time. Bill wouldn't tell me anything unless I gave him a blow job and then he changed his mind and said he wanted to fuck me and I got scared and just did it. I regretted it the moment it was over. I'm so sorry, Simon."

"You're sorry?" I stared at her, knowing there were tears in my eyes. "You cheated on me, Jo, and you think you can just make it right by saying 'sorry'?"

"I don't expect you to forgive me," Jo said. She was still holding my hand. "Just let me explain. I didn't want to do it but it was the only way. I thought I'd be able to keep it from you but Bill and his fucking evil friends decided to tell everyone."

"You were going to keep it from me?" I shook my head. "Really? That doesn't make what you did any better."

"I sacrificed my dignity," Jo said, squeezing my hand. "I didn't want to do it but I had to. It was the only way. I thought I could just 'take one for the team', get Frank and company out of my life and move on. I didn't know it would all come out and that you'd be humiliated and hurt like this. If I'd known, I wouldn't have done it."

"You should have told Frank that he wouldn't tell you," I replied, wiping the tears out of my eyes with the hand that Jo wasn't desperately clutching onto. "You should have let Frank do things the hard way, whatever that meant."

“That might have gotten us implicated in things,” Jo tried to explain, but her words trailed off. “What else did Charlie tell you?”

My gaze was on the floor in front of my feet but out of the corner of my eye, I saw Jo look at Frank and the big man nodded at her.

“That Frank wants to fuck you,” I replied, all my dignity gone. “Frank’s admitted it. He says he’s going to fuck you whether I like it or not.”

“I’m not going to fuck Frank,” Jo said, putting a finger underneath my chin and lifting my face to look at her.

“Charlie suggested you did something with him already.” I looked into her blue eyes. They were as wet as mine. A streak of black mascara trailed down one cheek. “The first night that Frank stayed over. After we made love. You got up in the middle of the night. I woke up and found you in the bathroom. What were you doing? Spitting out his cum?”

Jo blinked several times, her mouth opening and closing but not saying anything.

“I think that’s pretty much exactly what she was doing,” Frank said.

Jo rounded on him. “Shut up, Frank. Simon deserves better than this. You’re not helping by standing there, gloating.”

“He does deserve better,” Frank shrugged innocently as though he’d done nothing wrong. “That’s why I thought he should know the truth after Charlie only gave him a few hints. The poor guy’s probably been in agony wondering what the truth was.”

Frank was right about that but I didn’t say anything. I just stared down at my feet, wondering where to go from here.

“If you think you’re going to get to fuck me, you’re wrong,” Jo continued, pointing an angry finger at Frank. “I sucked your dick to keep the peace. That’s all it was.”

“You said you’d missed it,” Frank raised an eyebrow at her. “How did you phrase it? ‘I’ve missed sucking a big fat cock?’ Something like that.”

“Did you say that?” I asked her quietly.

“We’ll talk about it in a while,” Jo replied softly, squeezing my hand again. “When Frank has fucked off for a bit so we can talk.”

“Fine. I’ll fuck off then.” Frank stood up, brushing down his jeans while glaring at Jo. “You let Bandit-fucking-Bill screw you. How could you let that skinny toad have you and then not expect me to have you, Jo? You

know me. I'm not letting Bill think he's got one over on me. You're going to fuck me and that's that."

"Then you'll have to force me," Jo glared back at him. "And I don't think you'll do that."

Frank's face turned bright red and his eyes seemed to bulge with anger. "I think it's best I go for a walk," he said, then turned and stormed out of the room.

"I think you've pissed him off," I chuckled out of pure despair.

"I don't care," Jo replied. "Simon, I'm so sorry. Please don't leave me. Please. I love you. I fucked up. I've fucked everything up. Please. I'm so sorry."

She broke down now, tears streaming down her face and her shoulders shaking as she sobbed, so I sat up and pulled her into my arms, letting her cry against my chest. I held her there for a while, working out what to say in my head,

"Tell me exactly what happened with Bill," I said later after her sobs had subsided.

"He wouldn't tell me anything," Jo said, her voice still quivering. "He just kept going on about my tits and how he'd always wanted to get in touch with me. He said he regretted never fucking me and all dirty shit like that. I just wanted to talk about Frank's stash but then he suddenly said he'd tell me if I sucked his dick."

"So you did?"

"Mack was there. The other two as well, Alfie and Beth. It was humiliating but I thought, 'fuck it, if I do this, he'll tell me and it'll all be done. It's only a blow job'."

"But it wasn't only a blow job?"

"No," Jo whimpered. "He stopped me and said he'd changed his mind. He said he wanted to see my tits and again I thought, 'It's only my tits,' so I took my top off and showed him. I just pulled them out of my bra, but then he wanted to feel them and suck them. The whole while, Mack and Alfie were watching. Beth had walked out of the room. I guess she didn't like what was happening."

"Then he wanted more? He wanted to fuck you?" I asked, even though I wasn't sure I wanted to know.

"He put a hand down the front of my jeans and I didn't stop him," Jo sniffled. "I'm sorry, Simon. I don't know why I didn't stop him. I think I

was horny and just desperate to get this over and done with, so I let him. Then one thing led to another. He said if I let him fuck me, he'd tell me everything about the stash."

"Fuck," I said, exhaling loudly. For some reason, my cock was rock hard. What was wrong with me?

"I was horny. I'm sorry," Jo repeated. "I shouldn't have done it, but I did."

"Tell me," I said, despite knowing how uncomfortable she felt right then.

"He pulled my jeans down and bent me over the back of his sofa," Jo closed her eyes as she recalled it to me. "It wasn't anything special, the sex. He just did it to me from behind, really fast and hard."

"Did he...?" I wanted to ask if he'd finished inside her but I couldn't say it. Jo looked at me, wondering what I was going to ask.

"Did he... what?"

"Did he cum?" I managed to say.

"He pulled out," she nodded, her cheeks reddening. "It went on my butt. He didn't cum inside me."

"Okay," I nodded, relieved about that one thing at least.

"I felt dirty as soon as he'd finished," Jo reflected. "I cleaned myself up and demanded that he tell me about the stash and to be fair, he did. He said that he'd gone through Frank's notes and worked out where it was. He'd taken the safe, cracked it and had hidden the contents after taking a little bit to set himself up with what he's doing now. Money laundering, drugs, selling guns."

"Then you called me," I said, finishing the story for her. "I had no idea. You hid it from me so well."

"I was hoping that I could just forget it happened," Jo scrubbed at her eyes again, smearing the mascara even worse around her eyes. "I didn't think he'd tell anyone."

"And you did all of this to get rid of Frank?"

"I don't know why I did it," Jo shrugged. "I made a stupid, stupid mistake. I don't know how I'll ever make it up to you, but I promise, I will."

"And what about Frank?" I asked. "Why did you suck his cock? That was before the thing with Bill. What's your excuse for that?"

Jo let go of my hand. She'd been squeezing it that hard it actually ached.

"I really did get up to go to the bathroom but as I came out, Frank was waiting outside. He was totally naked. He does that - he sleeps naked," she explained, her blue eyes downcast. "He asked me to wait while he went for a pee, then he asked me to come into his bedroom. Just to talk. He said he hadn't had a chance to talk to me properly."

"You must have known he didn't want to talk," I said, not knowing whether or not to believe any of what she was telling me.

"I did," Jo nodded, "But I was drunk. Frank and I have got history, you know that. I don't know why but I said 'okay' and we went into his room. We did just talk, for a few minutes but he kept looking at my boobs through my t-shirt and was complimenting my body and things like that and then I made a stupid joke about his dick, saying it was still huge but teasing him about his age and if he could still get it up."

I closed my eyes and an involuntary image formed in my mind as she told me the rest.

"He said I could suck it and find out for myself," Jo went on. "I didn't want to but..."

I opened my eyes as she went quiet. "But... what? Did he make you do it?"

"Simon," Jo said, looking up at me, a new expression - a look of resolve - on her face and a determination in her eyes. "I've lied to you more in the past couple of days than I have in fifteen years of us being together. I need to stop lying to you."

"Well?" I asked, nodding in appreciation at what she's said. "Did he make you suck his dick?"

"No," Jo shook her head. "I was going to lie, but no, he didn't. I was drunk and being so close to Frank and his big one... I got horny. I won't make any excuses, Simon. If you hate me, then I accept that. If you want to kick me out, then I'll have to accept your decision, but no, he didn't make me do it."

"So, tell me what you did," I said, finding it increasingly difficult to keep asking these questions because my pulse was racing and a hurricane of different emotions was blowing through my mind and my heart.

"I said something like, 'If I suck your dick, will you behave yourself while you're staying here,' and he said he would." Jo's eyes were damp as

she gazed into mine. “But really I just wanted to suck it again. I know he’s an asshole and when we were married there were times where I truly hated him and I meant what I said when I said I fell out of love with him. I did. I hated him towards the end for what he’d done to us and what he’d dragged me into, but I’d be lying if I said he wasn’t the best lover I’ve ever had.”

Wow. That stung.

I didn’t reply. For some reason, all I could do was smile at her. I felt so embarrassed. I felt so stupid.

“So you really did miss his cock like he said,” I asked when I eventually found my voice.

Jo simply nodded. “I sucked it last night too. I snuck out of bed again in the middle of the night. I don’t know why. I woke up and just did it on impulse.”

I leaned back on the sofa, looked at the ceiling and then closed my eyes. “But you didn’t fuck him and now he wants to fuck you, so what are you going to do about that?”

“I have no idea,” Jo sighed. “Simon, do you hate me?”

“I don’t know,” I shrugged, then changed my mind. “No. I don’t hate you. I’m hurt and I feel betrayed and humiliated but I don’t hate you. I don’t know what I feel.”

“I love you,” Jo said after a moment. “Please don’t say you want to split up. Please.”

“If I split up with you, you’ll probably go running straight to Frank,” I said bitterly, not wanting to open my eyes and look at my wife. “That’s the last thing I want. He’s not having you.”

“That’s...” Jo paused, making me finally open my eyes and turn my head to look at her. She looked so sad, she seemed smaller. Like she’d shrunk into herself. I’d never seen Jo look so defeated. Her shoulders were bunched, her hands were wrapped around her knees in front of her as she huddled on the sofa. Her blue eyes had sprung tears again, leaving tracks of smoky makeup running down her cheeks. “That’s... good, I think. Isn’t it?”

“I need time to think.” I sat up. “I don’t want to lose you, Jo, but I need time to think about where we go from here. Until Frank’s gone, I can’t decide anything.”

“I understand,” Jo managed a small smile.

Then the door burst open.

“What’s up, guys?” Kathryn said, bouncing into the room, obviously not knowing anything was going on. Then she saw Jo and the state she was in. “Oh, shit. What’s happened?”

“You’d best sit down,” I told the curvy blonde who had rushed to Jo’s side and was trying to comfort her best friend. “I’ll go make us all a cup of tea.”

Chapter 13

“I thought he’d gone,” Kathryn said, a short while later. “When I walked through the bar and there was no sign of him or Brad and their car wasn’t outside, I thought they’d left.”

“You weren’t to know,” Jo said, patting her friend’s hand. While I’d been making three cups of much-needed tea, Jo had told Kathryn everything. If I’d been there, I might have stopped her - I was embarrassed enough already without Kathryn knowing I’d been cheated on, but it was too late now. I couldn’t begrudge Jo telling her one best friend the truth anyway.

“I think you’d be really harsh to judge Jo on these past couple of days,” Kathryn said to me as I passed her one of the steaming-hot teas. “I know it’s bad that she’s slept with Bill and you’re feeling hurt, but this is a bad situation and you two falling out will only make it worse.”

I sat down and had a sip of my own tea. “I know. I agree. I’m not going to make any knee-jerk reactions if that’s what you’re worried about.”

“Simon needs time to think and that’s okay,” Jo said, looking slightly happier than she had done before.

“I bet Bill was crap anyway, wasn’t he?” Kathryn asked Jo. “I know it’s a long time ago since I slept with him, but he had a small dick and thought just banging away at my pussy for hours on end was fun. I didn’t. I only went with him a couple of times for that reason.”

“He wasn’t very good but now’s not the right time to discuss that,” Jo replied. “It’s not really appropriate.”

“So you don’t need to worry,” Kathryn said, ignoring half of what Jo had just said and turning to me. “Bill was crap and he’s got a small dick. I’m sure you’re much better than him.”

“I’m not exactly well-endowed either,” I said bitterly. “But I hope I’m better than him, of course.”

“Oh, I didn’t know that...” Kathryn trailed off, fiddling with a strand of her blonde hair and then going awkwardly silent.

“Simon. Don’t start beating yourself up,” Jo shuffled along the sofa towards where I was sitting at the other end. I’d put some space between us when I sat down, unsure of how I felt. “You always do this when things don’t go right. This isn’t your fault. It’s nothing to do with the size of your dick or what you’re like in bed. The thing with Bill was a bad decision on my part and Frank and me... we’ve got history. That’s all it is. Don’t self-destruct. Please.”

We sat in silence for a little while, then I told the girls I needed some space. They both looked at me, apparently not knowing what to say but neither of them stopped me from getting up and leaving. I went out to the bar, checking Zena was okay and then had a look around, both inside and outside, for any sign of Frank but he was nowhere to be found. Brad was still out too.

I went for a short walk around the street to clear my head. It was early December and people had Christmas lights in the windows but I didn’t get any festive cheer from seeing them. I walked for a while, thinking about the past fifteen years with Jo. They’d been the best years of my life. I’d had girlfriends before her, but never anything serious. Being with Jo was all I knew. I wasn’t ready to give it up yet.

Soon, I realised how far away I was from the pub and as a soft, cold rain began to fall, I turned around and headed back. I had some ideas in my mind; some ways I could perhaps make things work with Jo. We needed to be more honest with each other. She needed to re-earn my trust but I also needed to be ready for her, when she had. If I’d been a better husband - somehow - she wouldn’t have wanted to sleep with Bill or suck Frank’s dick on impulse in the middle of the night. She needed to tell me - honestly - what that *somehow* entailed.

My phone rang as I was almost home and I pulled it out of my pocket - trying to shield it from the rain - to see who it was. It was Jo, of course.

“Where are you?” she asked with worry in her voice. “Are you okay?”

“I’m fine,” I replied. “I didn’t mean to worry you. I just went for a walk to clear my head.”

“Zena told me. She said she saw you go out, so I presumed you’d done just that but when you still weren’t back after two hours, I started worrying.”

“I promise I’m okay,” I reassured her. “I’m just walking down the street now. I won’t be long.”

“I love you,” she said hesitantly.

“I love you too,” I said back, feeling much calmer than I did earlier. I hung up the phone and stopped, looking at the pub at the far end of the street. The pub itself hadn’t been home for long, but home was wherever Jo was. I couldn’t leave her. I knew that now. I wasn’t ready to quit on the one thing in life that I truly wanted. I wasn’t a quitter. I headed home.

“Frank came back an hour ago,” Zena told me as I walked into the pub just as they were clearing up at the end of the night. I hadn’t realised how late it was. “He was with Brad. They didn’t say anything. They had a drink at the bar for a while, then when I turned around they’d gone.”

“Gone? Where?”

“I asked David, the old guy at the bar,” Zena pointed to our one last remaining customer who looked like he was about to fall asleep on his stool. “David says he thinks they finished their drinks then went into the back, so I gave it five minutes and then checked on Jo for you.”

I’d left Frank and Jo alone. *Shit*. What an idiot I was.

“And was she okay?” I asked. “She called me a few minutes ago and didn’t say anything.”

“Yes,” she was on her own, eating some supper and watching TV. I told her about Frank coming back and she seemed surprised because she hadn’t seen him.”

“Strange,” I murmured. “Okay. I’ll go in and check. Maybe they went straight to bed. Do you need any help closing up?”

“No, I’ll be okay,” Zena smiled. She was so pretty, with her mocha-coloured skin and long eyelashes. “I’ve only got David to navigate out of the bar, then I can close down and lock up.”

“Great. Just call me if you need me,” I told her, grateful for her help, then I headed through the door behind the bar and into the backrooms.

It was quiet. The lights were all off downstairs, so I headed upstairs, walking straight past the guest bedrooms and into the living area to find Jo waiting for me on the sofa.

“Hey,” I said with a smile.

“You’re back!” Jo stood up and rushed over to me, throwing herself into my arms.

“I told you I wouldn’t be long,” I said, easing her away from me so I could look at her. “Don’t think I’ve forgiven you because I haven’t but I

don't want to split up either. I just think we need to talk about how we really feel about each other and discuss where we go from here."

"Me too," Jo smiled. She looked happy and sad at the same time. I knew how she felt.

"Zena told me she saw Frank and Brad come back." I stripped off my wet coat and hung it on a radiator to dry. "She says you haven't seen them."

"Yeah," Jo nodded. "After she told me, I went looking for them and heard talking in Frank's room, so I think he must have gone straight to bed. He's probably still mad at me, so I thought it best to leave him to it."

"What time did Kathryn leave?" I asked, sitting down and putting my aching feet up - I'd walked a long way - on the coffee table, wiggling my extremely cold toes to try and work some warmth into them.

"An hour or so ago," Jo didn't join me on the sofa. "She listened to me and gave me some good advice. She's a good friend. Do you want a warm drink before bed to warm you up a bit? You look half-frozen."

"Yes, please." I rubbed my eyes. They felt sore. It had been a long, emotional day and I was tired, so when Jo came back with a steaming-hot mug of coffee, I suggested we take it to bed where we could talk. Jo thought it was a good idea, so we switched the TV and lights off and headed to our bedroom.

"I'll just go check downstairs first," I said as I placed my coffee on the bedside table. "Make sure Zena's locked up okay."

"Good idea," Jo said, hovering at the edge of the bed for some reason. I wondered if she felt hesitant about taking her clothes off in front of me. Were things really that bad?

I headed downstairs to find the bar in darkness. The infrared sensors pipped to acknowledge my presence, so I quickly walked back upstairs before I tripped the alarm but as I reached the top of the stairs, I heard something. Something that sounded like a moan. A female moan, coming from Frank's bedroom.

Are you kidding me? I thought to myself. Could Jo really have gone straight into Frank's bedroom the moment I'd gone downstairs? I'd literally been down there thirty seconds. It was impossible, I realized, but then I heard it again. A low whimper, followed by a series of sounds that were undoubtedly someone having sex.

I walked past and looked through the open door of our bedroom to see Jo laying in bed, sipping at her hot coffee. She didn't see me, so I stepped

quietly back to Frank's room. Who was he having sex with? Then I had a thought. Maybe he was watching porn on a phone or laptop?

It didn't sound like porn though. It sounded real.

If Frank had brought some woman back with him, it was a bit rude of him to not tell us. Sure, we'd let him stay but we hadn't given him the okay to let a stranger into our house without asking. I turned, walking over to Brad's room and listened at the door. It was completely silent. Brad must be asleep, tired from whatever errands Frank had him run all day.

I had to know what was going on, so I stepped back up to Frank's door and knocked gently. "Frank?" I called through the door. "I'm just checking you're okay."

"Sure," I heard him call back, somewhat breathless-sounding. "Come in."

Come in? Okay then.

I opened the door but didn't walk too far into the bedroom. Instead, I just poked my head around the door and then stopped in shock as I saw Kathryn scrambling to cover herself with the covers.

"Oh shit," I said, averting my eyes but I'd seen everything. She was naked. I'd never seen Kathryn naked before. Her breasts were huge, wobbling as she tried to wrestle the sheets from Frank's grasp while he giggled as he resisted before finally letting her have them. Below her curvy belly was a completely shaved pussy, which surprised me. With Kathryn not having a boyfriend for a while, I'd assumed she'd be more natural down there but it looked totally smooth. I also saw cum glistening on her thighs.

Once I'd given her a moment to regain her modesty, I looked back to see that Frank was still naked, making no attempt to cover his softening penis.

"I'm really sorry," I apologised. "I had no idea. Jo said Kathryn had gone home."

"I was about to go," Kathryn said, her eyes wild and her face bright red.

"I was at the bar with Brad having a drink when Kathryn bumped into us," Frank explained with a broad grin. "She agreed to have a drink with us and one thing led to another. You know how it is."

"I really should go," Kathryn squeaked in her high-pitched voice. "Simon, could you give me a minute to get dressed?"

“Sure,” I replied with an involuntary chuckle at what had just happened. This changed everything. If Frank was happy fucking Kathryn, he might leave Jo alone. “When you’re ready, let me know. I’ll have to let you out because the alarms are set.”

“Is it that late?” she asked. “I didn’t realise.”

“Time flies when you’re having fun,” Frank laughed.

I waited outside for her, then when she reappeared from his bedroom, apologising profusely, I took her downstairs, turning off the alarm long enough for her to go.

“I’m really sorry,” she apologised again as she left. “I didn’t mean for you to see that. I was going to tell you and Jo tomorrow and...”

“Don’t worry about it,” I said quietly, then reiterated my idea to her. “It might even help Jo’s situation if you know what I mean.”

“Well, that thought was in my mind too.” Kathryn tried to smile but it was obviously forced, then I watched her walk to her car before turning and closing the door, locking up and resetting the alarm again.

This was good. This was great. If Frank was into Kathryn, then it fixed the problem temporarily. If I could just keep him away from Jo until he’d gone away, things would get better. Wounds would heal. Jo and I would be okay.

Chapter 14

Now I had to go upstairs and tell Jo what had just happened. There was no point in keeping it from her. Kathryn would only tell her anyway.

I wasn't sure how Jo would react but I certainly wasn't expecting her to be jealous.

"How could she do that to me?" Jo said after I'd told her. I was sitting in bed next to her and I turned to look at my wife, not expecting the expression of outrage that was on her face right then.

"What do you mean?" I asked, genuinely confused.

"She's supposed to be my best friend. Why would she sleep with him? He's my ex-husband."

"Exactly," I reminded her. "He's your *ex*-husband. I said to her on the way out that maybe this is a good thing. If Frank is into Kathryn, he might leave you alone."

"No. That's not the way Frank's mind works." Jo was wearing a t-shirt in bed like she always did, this time a black one. She folded her arms, pushing her breasts upwards. "Frank might have fucked Kathryn, but he's not into her. He's trying to make me jealous. That's why he let you walk in and catch them."

"Well, it sounds like his plan is working," I grumbled, feeling mildly annoyed.

"Frank feels like Bill had got one over on him because I let him fuck me, so now he's getting his own back by fucking Kathryn," Jo said, as though talking to herself. "Also, I bet Kath thinks she's got one over on me."

"I'm sure Kathryn doesn't think that at all," I said, shocked that Jo would say that of her best friend.

"Oh, you don't know her as well as you think you do," Jo shook her head, staring at the wall. "When we were young, she always used to try to get with boys I liked. I don't know why. It's like she saw it as a competition

or something. She tried to get with Frank before I did but back then, he only had eyes for me.”

“And Sharon,” I added, trying to lessen Frank in Jo’s eyes. I didn’t like the way she was looking back at things. “Charlie told me that he only let Danny sleep with you because he wanted to fuck Sharon.”

“That might be true,” Jo looked at me. “But in truth, I liked Danny and fancied him so I didn’t care about the reason really. The threesome and foursome we had were fun. I don’t regret doing them.”

“You said you wish you’d never met Frank,” I reminded her. “You said he was your biggest regret.”

“In some ways, he is,” Jo nodded. “But we did have some good times. Not enough to outweigh the bad, but I do have some good memories.”

“You had some good sex, you mean?”

“I’m sorry for what I said about him being the best lover I ever had.” Jo pulled a sad face. “I didn’t mean to hurt your feelings.”

“It’s true though, isn’t it?” I shrugged, feeling suddenly negative again.

“He’s a big guy,” Jo’s eyes were full of sympathy. “Big in stature, big down there. You know. He’s good at sex. But I love sex with you too. It’s just different. You make me feel loved.”

But not satisfied? I almost vocalised the thought but didn’t.

“Did you enjoy sucking his dick last night?” I asked. “Was that true, that you’d missed sucking a big one because mine is small?”

“Stop it,” Jo said, grabbing my hand and squeezing it. “Stop putting yourself down.”

“Just tell me. I want to know,” I replied. I did. For some reason, I needed to know.

“Fine. Yes, I enjoyed it,” Jo narrowed her eyes at me. “Is that what you want to hear? Are you happy now? I thought you wanted us to fix things. You clearly don’t. You just want to rub my nose in what I’ve done.”

“No, I don’t,” I said quietly. “I’m just trying to understand.”

“You might be small but I love your cock,” Jo said, sliding her hand under the covers and grabbing my dick through my boxer shorts. “I love this, right here... Woah. You’re hard.”

“I know. Maybe I’m frustrated or something,” I said, pulling her hand away in shame. I shouldn’t be hard while talking about this stuff.

“The other night when you almost caught me,” Jo said, pushing her hand back and this time sliding it inside my shorts and taking hold of my

erection properly. “You were hard then too. You suspected that I’d been to Frank’s room, didn’t you? Somehow you knew.”

“Maybe I did. I don’t know,” I shrugged, trying to pull her hand away again but she resisted, beginning to stroke me slowly.

“Do you get turned on?” Jo asked softly. “Thinking of me and Frank. Does it turn you on? It’s okay if it does. I won’t think you’re weird or anything.”

“I don’t know,” I said, remembering what I’d promised to myself earlier while out walking, that we had to be honest with each other. “Maybe it does. Yes, I guess so. But that doesn’t mean I want you to do anything with him. Don’t go getting any ideas.”

“So if I went to his room now and sucked his dick again,” Jo’s hand was pumping my dick back and forth, “You wouldn’t be turned on by it?”

“I might be,” I confessed, “But that’s no reason to go and do it. That’d be wrong.”

Jo pushed the covers back and tugged my shorts down. My cock was so hard it almost hurt, laying flat against my tummy. I wasn’t very big. I knew that. I’d measured it at somewhere between four inches and five but Jo had never complained and that had given me encouragement. She’d always enjoyed the sex we had, even if she’d never orgasmed from penetration.

“So you don’t want me to do this to Frank anymore?” she asked, moving down and taking me in her mouth.

“You’ve already done it twice,” I said, moaning in pleasure as she began to work her tongue around my shaft. “I just wouldn’t want you to do anything more than suck him.”

Jo took her mouth from around my cock. “You’re right,” she smiled at me, that mischievous grin of hers. “I have sucked him off twice already. So one more time wouldn’t make a difference, would it?”

“I guess not,” I said, pushing her head back towards my cock. “It’s just, maybe...”

“Maybe... what?” Jo said, holding my dick but not sucking it even though I urged her to with my hand.

“How do I know you’re not going to do more?”

“I promise, I’ll only give him a blowjob,” Jo reassured me. “He hasn’t even seen me naked yet. I refused to take my shirt off the first night, then

the second night I wouldn't let him turn the lights on, even though he was begging me to. He's desperate to see my boobs now they're bigger."

"He asked me if you still had a hairy pussy yesterday," I told her. "While you were with Bill. I didn't tell him though."

"Did he now?" Jo's blue eyes twinkled at the thought. "Poor Frank. He really wants me, doesn't he?"

"But he can't have you," I reminded her.

"No, he can't," she agreed. "I could let him see my boobs, I suppose. But that's all."

"Okay," I moaned. Her hand was still pumping my cock slowly up and down the whole time, teasing me. "Maybe it's a good idea to give him a blow job every night if it keeps him happy."

"Do you want me to?" Jo asked. "Then I could come back and suck yours."

"But how do I know you won't fuck him?" I repeated the question. "He might even try and force himself on you."

"He wouldn't do that," Jo shook her head. "What if you come with me?"

"And watch?" I asked.

"No!" Jo looked at me with surprise on her face. "I don't think Frank would like that. I meant you could stand outside and listen. If he tries anything, I could say something - like a code word - and you could knock on the door or something. Frank would have to stop then."

"Or you could leave the door open a crack," I suggested. "Maybe put the bedside lamp on. Then I can keep an eye on things."

"You just want to watch." Jo cocked her head to one side, appraising me. "Don't you?"

"No," I lied, then yet again, decided to be honest. "Maybe. I'd just feel better, that's all."

"I can do that," Jo let go of my cock and swung her legs out of bed. "Frank will let me put the light on - I know that. He wanted to watch me suck it the last two nights but as I said, I wouldn't let him put the light on."

"Okay then," I said, pulling my boxer shorts up as she stood up and pulled down her t-shirt. "So, I suppose..."

"Are you sure about this?" Jo asked. "I was only joking when I suggested it, but if you really want me to do this - if you think it's a good idea - I will. But only if you're sure."

“If it keeps him happy until he goes away,” I said. “Perhaps it’s a good idea? I’m not sure, but if you want to do it, do it now, before I change my mind.”

“Okay.” Jo watched me as she walked to the bedroom door, studying me, perhaps trying to work out if I was being genuine or if I was going to change my mind and tell her to stop. Perhaps she was trying to figure out if this was some sort of test. “I’ll leave the door open a little. Give me five minutes or so and then come and see what we’re doing.”

She hung around for a few seconds, still waiting for me to stop her but I didn’t. Then she left, leaving our bedroom door open behind her. I got up and walked to the door before remembering. *Five Minutes*. I had to wait.

I stood in the empty bedroom doorway, looking out onto the darkened hallway and trying to listen for voices. After a moment, I caught a word or two, Frank talking.

“I knew you’d come.” I barely made out those four words but then the rest was too muffled. I crept a little closer. It wasn’t five minutes yet, but Jo wouldn’t know.

“...told me about Kathryn and...” I heard Jo say quietly before the conversation again became indecipherable.

“She was a good fuck,” I heard Frank say, clearly this time. “Getting her to stay quiet was hard but then I thought it might be good if you heard, seeing as you hadn’t come to check on me.”

“Simon heard,” Jo said. “That’s why he knocked on your door. He was shocked when it turned out to be Kath that you were fucking.”

“Well, it worked. It got you here,” Frank said in his low gravelly voice. I was only a few feet away now. I could see that their bedroom door was open but no light was coming out of the bedroom yet.

“Are you going to be able to get it up again, old man?” I heard Jo ask.

“Get your mouth around it and find out,” Frank replied.

“Would it help if I took my top off?”

“Depends if you’re going to let me have the light on this time?” I could hear the excitement in Frank’s voice.

There was no more talking for a moment. All I heard was the rustling of material and the bed creaking slightly, then a click and a bright beam shone out from the gap in the doorway, throwing a streak of light across the hallway carpet.

“Fucking hell,” I heard Frank mutter. “You had nice tits when you were young but they’re a lot bigger now. What cup size are they?”

“I’m a 36E,” Jo answered. I stepped closer, risking my first glance through the gap in the door. Frank was sitting up in bed, the covers still covering his bottom half. My wife was kneeling up, straddling the lower half of his legs. All she was wearing was a pair of black panties. Frank’s eyes were locked onto her breasts. From the angle I was watching, I could only see the side of one breast as she shuffled up the bed, sitting almost on his lap, so that her tits were right in his face. “No touching,” she said.

“Fuck that,” Frank chuckled and reached up with both hands, squeezing them, then he lowered his head and took one nipple in his mouth, sucking on it hungrily.

“Frank,” hissed Jo. “I said ‘no touching’.” She didn’t make any attempt to push him away though. She seemed quite happy to let him play with her tits. “Anyway, has it got you hard yet?”

“Maybe,” he replied, letting go of her tits and sliding his hands down her sides to the waistband of her panties. “Taking these off will definitely get me hard.”

“No.” This time, Jo did stop him. She reached down and slapped his hands away before he could pull them down. “Be happy that you’ve got to see my tits, Frank. Now get your dick out. I want to make you cum.”

She moved back, swinging one leg from him so she was kneeling by his side, then threw back the sheets to reveal his large cock, which was semi-hard, by the looks of it. It was thick, with a prominent vein running down from his large, purple mushroom tip to the tight curls of his greying pubic hair. Then she took hold of it in one hand, her fingers barely reaching all the way around and lowered her head.

Frank reached down and pulled her curly hair out of the way so he could watch as she took it into her mouth and began to slowly suck up and down his length, teasing him to hardness.

After a few minutes, his head tipped back and his hand tangled itself in her hair, pushing her head further down and making her gag like he had done last night.

“Frank,” she mumbled around his dick. “I keep telling you to stop doing that.”

My cock felt like it was going to explode, it was that erect. I slid a hand into my boxer shorts, unable to resist touching myself as I watched my

wife give her ex-husband an exquisite blow job.

“No, Frank,” I heard Jo say as she came up for a breath. With one hand, she swiped away his hand from her backside.

“I just want to finger you a little,” the big guy said. “Come on, Jo.”

“Not tonight,” she glared at him. “If you want to cum in my mouth again, keep your hands to yourself.”

“Maybe another time?” he asked.

“Maybe,” Jo said. I felt my dick twitch in my hand and had to let go before I came. *Maybe?* Had she just said he could finger her one night in the future?

“I don’t know why you don’t just let me fuck you, Joanne.” Frank’s face was contorted with pleasure as she began to work his dick with her tongue and mouth again. He couldn’t be far away from cumming. “You know you want my dick. You said yourself, Simon can’t make you cum. He’s too small. Why not just fuck me. I won’t tell him if you don’t want me to.”

Jo said nothing. She just kept sucking him, her head bobbing up and down onto his dick until eventually, I saw Frank tremble and then heard him groan as he pushed Jo’s head right down onto his length. She gagged again but he held her there, obviously emptying his balls right into her throat. Eventually, he let go and sagged back onto the bed with a sigh.

“I’ll only fuck you if Simon says I can,” Jo replied, wiping her mouth. She’d swallowed his cum. “Right now, he doesn’t want me to do anything more than this.”

She glanced towards the door, knowing I was watching. I hoped Frank didn’t notice.

“He’s okay with you sucking me off?” Frank asked, pulling the covers over him while studying Jo as she found her discarded t-shirt and pulled it over her head.

“Yes,” she replied. “You should say thank you to him tomorrow.”

“Hmph,” he replied, watching her walk towards the door. “I’m not going to thank him for stealing my wife. Can I ask something of you, Jo?”

Jo was almost at the door. I didn’t want her opening it and Frank seeing me, so I stepped around the corner, out of the line of sight.

“Go ahead,” I heard my wife say. I could see her shadow on the hallway floor.

“The first night I stayed, I heard you and Simon having sex. I got so jealous. I never get jealous of anyone but I did that night. If you won’t have sex with me, please don’t have sex with him again. Wait until I’ve gone home.”

“I’ll talk to Simon about it,” Jo said, after a long pause. “In the morning. Right now, I’m going back to bed where I’m going to wake him up and suck his cock just like I sucked yours.”

“Jo. Don’t fuck him,” Frank said, his tone lowered. “If you have any respect for me at all, you won’t.”

“Night, Frank,” Jo said as I backed away towards our bedroom, scarcely able to believe the demands he was making. Not allowing me to fuck my wife? I wasn’t having that.

I ducked into our bedroom, sitting on the bed and waiting for Jo. I heard her visit the bathroom - the familiar click of the pull switch going on and off and then she reappeared with a huge grin on her face.

“I did it,” she whispered. “Did you watch?”

“Yes,” I said, my heart beating hard in my chest. I was incredibly aroused. I’d never been this turned on in my entire life.

“Kiss me,” she said as she took her t-shirt off and climbed into bed alongside me.

I kissed her and tasted the salty twang of Frank’s cum on her lips. Her hand found my boxer shorts and pulled them down, then her hand wrapped around my cock and to my absolute horror, the worst possible thing that could happen happened.

I came.

Chapter 15

“Are you kidding me?” Jo said, feeling the sticky cum as she stroked me. “Have you cum?”

“Shit,” I cursed. “I’m sorry. Shit. I can’t believe I just came.”

“I guess you weren’t kidding about all this turning you on,” Jo giggled then sighed. “I really wanted you to fuck me too. I’m really fucking horny.”

“Make yourself cum?” I suggested. “I don’t mind. Or I could go down on you if you like?”

“That sounds like a good idea,” Jo moaned and I realised her hands were already down her panties, touching her clit.

I threw the covers back, helping her take her panties off and then I positioned myself between her thighs, watching her fingers work her swollen clit for a moment before burying my face into her pussy. She moved her hand so that I could use my hand to part her pubic hair and her small, pink labia, giving my tongue better access to her clit.

“You’re so wet,” I noted.

“Shut up and make me cum,” she sighed, pushing my head down much as Frank had hers earlier.

I licked at her clit, swirling my tongue around it, then clamped my lips over it and sucked it gently, making her groan loudly.

I hope Frank hears, I thought.

Just a couple of minutes later, Jo’s hips bucked up, pushing my head back and she came, her thighs clamping around me tightly as her orgasm rocked through her body. She moaned sexily - again, loudly enough for Frank to hear, if he was still awake - before finally relaxing and pulling at me to come back up the bed and cuddle her.

“I love you,” she whispered into my ear as I wrapped my arms around her. “Thank you for being so understanding.”

She sounded tired. I wasn’t sure that my being *understanding* was anything she should be thanking me for. What she’d just done - what I’d *let* her do - was wrong. Now that I’d cum, it felt wrong, but I’d worry about all

of that in the morning. Right now, I had my wonderful wife in my arms after I'd just made her orgasm and she'd told me she loved me. That was good and better than I could have expected just a few hours earlier when I was walking the streets and wondering where my future lay. Feeling content, I fell asleep.

I woke the following morning to the smell of bacon wafting into the bedroom. I looked around to see that Jo had left me in bed and the delicious aromas I could smell were probably her cooking breakfast again.

I slipped into some clothes and made my way into the kitchen to find Frank already there before me again. He looked up from where he was sitting at the table with a cup of coffee in hand.

"Morning," he said cheerfully, as though the disagreements we'd had yesterday had never happened.

"Hi," I said briefly before walking over to Jo who was at the cooker, turning over several slices of sizzling bacon. "Good morning," I said to my lovely wife, wrapping my arms around her waist from behind and kissing her on the back of the head.

"Sit down," she told me. "I've made us all breakfast." Then she turned to Frank. "Is Brad joining us?"

"I'm letting him have an hour in bed," the big man replied. "He worked hard yesterday, so he's earned it. Besides I thought, the three of us should talk."

I wasn't going to be the first one to bring up the events of last night and as we sat and ate in increasingly awkward silence, it seemed that Jo didn't want to be the one starting the inevitable conversation either.

"Okay. Well, I guess I'm going to say my bit then," Frank said, finishing his breakfast and pushing the plate to one side. "Firstly, I'm going to be around for a few more days, then after the job, I'm leaving. I'm not telling you - either of you - any details about the job. That way, afterwards if the cops come sniffing around, you can't be implicated in any way. That's my priority. To protect you two."

I looked at Jo but she seemed to be avoiding my gaze. "Thank you, Frank," I said. "We appreciate that."

"Secondly, because I'm only going to be around for a short while, I want us to get on and have as much fun together as we can while I'm here," he continued. "I don't want things to be difficult or anything but there are a few things I want."

Here we go. We were getting around the situation with him and Jo.

“No one wants things to be difficult,” I agreed. Why wasn’t Jo saying anything?

“I think you know what I want, Simon,” the big man said. I noticed he’d shaved his head at some point; the grey fuzz around the sides of his head was gone so now he was totally bald and looked all the more menacing for it.

“You want to sleep with Jo,” I replied. “But she doesn’t want to.”

“Joanne says different,” Frank replied with a smile. “But she won’t do it because of you. Unless you give her permission.”

“Which I’m not going to do,” I folded my arms in front of myself defensively.

“But you’re happy for her to suck my dick anytime I want?” he asked, his dark eyes boring into mine. He leaned forward over the table. “After she made me cum last night, I heard you have sex. Or I thought that’s what I heard, but Joanne said it didn’t happen because you came before it even started.”

“You told him that?” I stared at Jo, incredulously but she still wasn’t looking at me.

“She did,” Frank nodded. “We’ve had a bit of a chat about it this morning before you came down just now. Simon, the thing is: I’m not used to not getting my own way. I don’t like it. It makes me angry. And I’m not nice to be around when I’m angry. So, if you want us to all get on while I’m here, you need to compromise.”

“Come on, Frank,” I shook my head at him. “Really? I’m letting you live here, rent-free. We’re feeding you, letting you have your clandestine meetings here. I’ve let Jo suck your fucking dick three times. I think we’ve compromised plenty.”

Frank sat back, puffing his chest out and clenching his fist on the tabletop. Then he took a deep breath and seemed to gather himself. “Joanne told me you watched her suck my dick last night and it really turned you on. It made you prematurely ejaculate, you were that turned on from it. So, imagine how horny you’d get from watching me fuck her.”

I felt my pulse quicken when I first saw him getting angry but as he calmed down, I calmed down. However, the thought of what he’d just said: me watching Frank fuck Jo, made my pulse quicken again, but for a different reason.

“Is that what you want?” I asked Jo, who finally turned to look at me, an uncomfortable look on her face. “Did you really tell him this morning that you want to fuck him but you won’t because of me? I thought you just didn’t want to.”

“I’m sorry,” she apologised. “Frank asked me for the truth and I told him... so, yes... but I meant what I said: if you don’t want me to do it, I won’t.”

“There’s more,” Frank said, reaching down and picking up a carrier bag from the floor by his feet. “Yesterday when I went out, I called into a sex shop nearby and bought something. I want you to wear it, Simon.”

He took a small plain cardboard box out of the bag and put it on the table, then slid it over to me.

“What is it?” I asked, not liking what was happening.

“Have a look,” the huge ex-con replied.

I opened the box with shaking fingers and pulled out a strange contraption made of steel. It was weirdly shaped, like a small cage of sorts and a tiny padlock around what seemed to be an opening on one side.

“I have no idea what this is,” I said, turning it over in my hands.

“It’s a penis cage,” Frank told me. “A male chastity device.”

I looked down at it and then understood. The cage was phallus-shaped, only small. I just hadn’t put two and two together. “You’re kidding me, right?” I said, looking from Frank to Jo but she just looked away again when our eyes met.

“If I can’t fuck Joanne, then you can’t either,” Frank shrugged, like what he was saying was normal. “If you wear it, I’ll be happy. There won’t be any trouble. If you won’t, then Joanne is going to have sex with me, whether you want me to or not. Aren’t you, Joanne?”

“Is that right, Joanne?” I asked my wife. She turned, her brown curly hair swinging around her shoulders.

“Just let me have sex with him,” Jo said, her blue eyes gazing at me pleadingly. “It’s just sex. It’s for a few days. It’s not like I haven’t had sex with him before.”

“Yes but that was over fifteen years ago!” I pointed out, unable to hear what was coming out of my wife’s mouth.

“You can watch,” Frank offered. “I don’t mind if it means getting what I want.”

I ignored him for now. "What's changed, Jo?" I asked. "Why do you suddenly want to do this? Has he threatened you or something?"

"No," Jo shrugged. "If I'm honest, giving him blowjobs again, feeling his size and everything... it got me horny last night. Frank tried to pull my panties down. He said he wanted me and I almost gave in. I don't want to give in and end up cheating on you, Simon. I'd rather you say it's okay. Just let me get this out of my system. Like Frank says, in a few days he'll be gone. It'll be just me and you again."

"Absolutely no way," I sat back in my chair defiantly. "I'd rather wear the cock cage thing."

"So be it." Frank reached across the table - making me jump back at first because I didn't know what he was doing - and picked up the cock ring. Then he passed it to Jo. "Put in on him. Now."

"What?" Jo and I said, almost in unison.

"Put it on him. Now."

"Really?" I laughed in exasperation. Did he think I was going to put it on in front of him? Did he really even think I was going to wear it?

"Put it on," he said, in a threatening tone. He stood up and walked around the table towards me. I got out of my chair and backed up.

"Frank!" Jo shouted. "Stop it. Simon, just wear the fucking thing, for God's sake."

"I want you to put it on him," Frank stopped, a few feet away from me. I'd backed away almost to the wall, feeling alarmed at his sudden aggression.

"Okay, okay," Jo said, walking up to her ex-husband and placing a hand on his cheek. "Calm down, Frank. I don't want to have to call the police."

"Then put the cock cage on your husband, Joanne."

Jo turned to me. "Let me put it on. I've read about these things. They're not that bad. It's only for a few days."

"No," I refused. "I can't even believe you're asking this of me."

"Then let me and Frank sleep together," she said gently. She was standing right in front of me now, her brilliant blue eyes searching my face. "After all this is done if you want to split up, I understand. I'll have to accept it but we are where we are, right now, and we just have to be brutally honest with each other. I can't stop thinking about making love to Frank again. I don't love him. I love you and I want to be with you. I don't want

to split up. But I do want to just know what it's like to have sex with him again. Even if it's just one more time."

"Put the cock cage on me," I said, shaking my head. "Because I'm not letting him have my wife."

"I told you," Jo said, turning to Frank. "Simon's stubborn. I knew he wouldn't say 'yes'."

"So put it on him," Frank shrugged. He'd walked closer, just a few feet away again; his sheer size looming over me put me on edge.

Jo took a hold of the waistband of my jeans and popped the button.

"What are you doing?" I hissed at her. "Not in front of Frank."

"I need to see it go on," Frank told me. "And see Jo lock it. Then she'll give me the key."

Jo pulled down my jeans and boxer shorts in one movement. I reached down to stop her but I was so in shock at what was happening this morning that I was too slow.

"Okay, so it goes on like this," Jo said to herself, kneeling and opening the cage.

"You are small, aren't you?" Frank laughed at me. I felt my cheeks burning with shame as Jo took a hold of my dick between her fingers and inserted it into the steel device. "Joanne, have you really been satisfied these last fifteen years with *that*?"

"Shut up, Frank," Jo defended me. "He might be small but he knows how to use it."

I heard the padlock snap shut, then Jo turned and passed a small silver key to Frank, who put it in his back pocket and sniggered at me. "Is it comfortable?" he asked.

It felt cold and the steel metal ring that held it on felt a little too snug around the base of my cock and balls but it wasn't uncomfortable as such. I looked down and saw that it had a little room for growth in the shaft section of the cage but it wasn't big enough to accommodate an erection, I didn't think.

"There we go," Jo said, pulling the cage gently, testing if it was secured.

I pulled my shorts and jeans up and stormed out of the kitchen, feeling ashamed and embarrassed but it was what it was. I wasn't going to let Frank fuck my wife.

Chapter 16

“Simon! Simon!” Jo called after me, leaving Frank alone in the kitchen and following me up the stairs.

“Is everything okay?” Brad said as I pushed past him at the top of the stairs, almost bowling him over.

“Yes, everything’s fine,” Jo said to the youngster behind me as I made my way into the bedroom. “Frank’s in the kitchen. There’s some bacon and eggs waiting for you.”

I sat on the edge of the bed, not quite knowing what I’d intended to do once I’d come upstairs. I’d just wanted to escape Frank and Jo and to regather my thoughts.

“Simon, I’m sorry,” Jo said, out of breath as she caught up to me. “I think you’ve misunderstood.”

“Misunderstood what?” I said, yet again incredulous at the change in my wife’s behaviour.

“Everything that just happened downstairs,” Jo said, standing in front of me with a look of sympathy on her face. “It wasn’t real. It was a roleplaying type of thing.”

“Roleplay?” I snorted. “Jo, you’ve made me wear a fucking chastity device. You made me show Frank my dick. Do you even realise how embarrassed I am right now?”

“I got it all wrong.” Jo bent down and tried to take my hand but I pushed her away. “Simon, please don’t... Hear me out.”

“Say what you’ve got to say,” I snapped at her. “Then leave me alone.”

“I knew you wouldn’t let me have sex with him, so when he showed me the cock cage this morning, I thought it was a good idea.” Jo reached for my hand again and this time I let her take it. I had no strength left to resist a second time.

“How is it a good idea?” I asked, humouring her, although I didn’t know why I should.

“Frank isn’t going to give up trying to bed me,” Jo said, playing with a strand of her dark curly hair. “You and I both know that. I thought that if you wear the cage, it gives us a way out. It gives Frank a reason to not try to get in my panties.”

“But why humiliate me like that?” I asked, trying to understand and failing. “Why show him my dick? You know I’m not big, like him.”

“He wouldn’t have believed you were wearing it otherwise.” Jo sat next to me. She was wearing a baggy black t-shirt and her legs were bare. I hoped she was wearing panties and that Frank hadn’t tried anything on with her in the kitchen before I’d got out of bed.

“So what were you talking about with the roleplay thing?” I asked, admiring her shapely thighs before I realised she was deliberately showing them off by crossing them. She was trying to distract me; trying to *use her charms* on me, as she liked to put it.

“I don’t know,” she said with a faint shrug. “Last night, when we talked, you got turned on by watching me suck Frank. That’s kind of kinky and it turns me on that you like me doing sexual things like that. I like the thought of you being sort of submissive to me and Frank, so I thought it might be fun for me to tease him a little. I thought you’d enjoy that too and this whole sexual denial thing, it’s a sort of submissive thing as well so-” she paused, trying to find the right words amidst the ramble of words that were gushing from her now, “-maybe I got it all wrong. I didn’t expect you to hate it. I really thought - after last night - that it’d turn you on as much as it does me.”

“Wait,” I said. “Slow down. That’s a lot to digest. You want me to be... *submissive*? To you and Frank?”

“The thought of it turns me on,” Jo nodded. “I’m sorry. Did I get it wrong? It’s just that when you confessed to me giving him a blow job, I thought... I don’t know. You enjoyed watching, didn’t you? You were so turned on, you came instantly, the moment I touched your dick.”

“Yes, I enjoyed it,” I nodded reluctantly. “But that doesn’t mean I want to be humiliated and to be made to wear a chastity device. Come on, Jo. Did you really think I’d get off on that?”

“I got it wrong,” Jo replied, taking my hand and placing it on her bare thigh. “How many times do I have to say that? So, anyway, all of that back there in the kitchen? I was playing along with Frank’s game. I thought you’d get off on it. I’m sorry. I didn’t mean it seriously.”

“So you don’t want to sleep with Frank?” I asked, enjoying the feeling of her warm, smooth thigh beneath my hand but refusing to be placated by her *charms*. “You didn’t mean it when you said that?”

“I...um-” Jo hesitated before answering, her face twisted with indecision. “I’d be lying if I said the thought of sleeping with him doesn’t turn me on. You’ve seen the size of his penis, Simon. But I admit, I got it wrong. If you enjoyed watching me suck him, I assumed the thought of me wanting to have sex with him would turn you on too.”

“I did enjoy watching you,” I nodded. “It makes me feel weird to admit it, but I did.”

“And did you get excited by him seeing my breasts?” Jo asked tentatively. “And seeing him feel them and suck them?”

“Yes,” I nodded glumly, feeling utterly defeated because my cock was hardening at this conversation. What was wrong with me?

“What if I’d let him take my panties off? What if I’d let him see my pussy? Or if I let him make me cum, say with his fingers or tongue?”

“Jo, stop,” I pleaded with her because my hardening cock was pressing against the metal cage and felt slightly uncomfortable. “Yeah, it does but please stop.”

“I will in a minute. I’m not saying I’m going to do it,” Jo asked slowly, “But does the thought of me having sex with him turn you on too? If everything else does, then that must too.”

“I said stop!” I repeated. “Yes, it turns me on. Whatever. Just stop because it’s hurting now.”

“What is?” Jo asked, confused. Then her eyes widened as she saw me trying to adjust the penis cage through my trousers. “Oh. You’re hard, aren’t you? I wasn’t thinking.”

“This is why I can’t wear this thing,” I complained. “It’s hard enough to cope with the emotional and mental aspect of everything that’s happening between us without it being physically painful too.”

“It is a lot to get your head around,” Jo nodded, taking hold of my hand and sliding it up and down her thigh subtly. “And your heart too, I imagine. But it’s only for a few days. Until Frank goes home.”

It didn’t hurt that much. My penis probably wasn’t big enough to strain against the confines of the cage, but it did feel uncomfortable to the point of hurting slightly.

“I suppose if it makes Frank feel better and keeps him from wanting sex.” I managed to adjust the penis cage so that it felt slightly more comfortable. “Maybe I can live with it for a few days.”

“You can pee through it still and shower with it on,” Jo said. “Of course, you could always let Frank have me and then he’ll let you take it off.”

“Do you really want to?” I asked her, my mind beginning to clear now that the initial rush of emotions had subsided and we were talking objectively like adults. “Have sex with him, I mean?”

“I feel like a real bitch for saying it,” Jo looked down at her feet. “And it feels weird saying to my husband that I get horny thinking about having sex with another man, especially my ex-husband, but yes. If you were okay with it, I’d do it. But if you’re not, I won’t and don’t worry, I don’t begrudge you for saying no. It’s perfectly understandable. We’re married. I’m yours. Of course, you don’t want another man sleeping with me.”

“You’re not a bitch,” I reassured her. “You’re just being honest and I appreciate that.”

“Are you scared?” Jo asked. “Or worried about me doing it?”

“I trust you,” I replied. “But if you’re asking if I’m scared or worried, I guess it depends what you mean. I suppose I’m scared that if you did it, you might regain your old feelings for him. Or perhaps you’d never want sex with me ever again. Maybe you’ll want to go back to Frank for the amazing sex.”

“Or perhaps I’d just have a good time, get him out of my system and be even hornier for you in bed?” Jo countered.

“Either way, we can’t stay up here all day,” I sighed, looking at my watch. “We need to get organised for opening time.”

“Are we okay?” Jo asked as I stood up. “I’m worried, Simon. I feel like I’m fucking everything up and that every time I do something, I get it wrong. I don’t want to lose you.”

“We just need to keep talking,” I shrugged. “Communicating. Being honest with each other. Maybe we’ll work it all out somehow. Right now, I’m going in the shower. I stink.”

“I do too,” Jo grinned. “Sweat and bacon. Not a good smell.”

“Why don’t you join me?” I suggested with a grin as I walked off in the direction of the bathroom.

“There’s not much you can do with the penis cage on though,” Jo reminded me but still followed me nonetheless.

“I don’t have a cage on my tongue,” I pointed out, closing the bathroom door behind her and turning the shower on.

Several minutes later, we were both in the shower, the hot water cascading down Jo’s naked body as I knelt between her legs, my tongue flicking over her clit. Her dark pubic hairs were soaked and matted to her skin as I parted her pussy lips, finding the pink between with my tongue and making Jo moan with pleasure.

Her fingers were tangled in my hair and she pulled my head against her hard as she came, my tongue twirling around her clit as she strained against me for a moment, her legs shaking, before finally releasing me.

“I love going down on you,” I said, standing up and kissing her under the hot water.

“I can taste myself on you,” she said, pushing me away and giggling. “I wish I could return the favour but I guess you’ll have to wait a few more days until Frank’s gone home. Then, I promise, I’ll make it all up to you with the best blowjob and the most mind-blowing sex you’ve ever had.”

“I’ll hold you to that.”

We lovingly washed each other, constantly kissing and I felt reconnected to her. We were going through a very strange and stressful time and yet at no point did I ever feel totally disconnected in a way that I couldn’t recover from. Intimate moments like this made everything feel better and the way she smiled and giggled; the way she kissed me and held me; it was real. Jo and I had something amazing. Despite everything that had happened recently, we still had it.

Chapter 17

Frank was with Brad talking downstairs and shortly after we opened up, the two men went out - 'on business' - as Frank put it.

"We won't be back until late," he told Jo, barely giving me a second glance. "When I'm back, we should probably finish the conversation we were having this morning."

Jo glanced at me but her blue eyes were calm. Knowing my wife, she already had a plan for what to say and do when Frank came back.

"Okay, Frank," she said, watching him and Brad walk out of the door. "See you later."

"That's going to be fun," I muttered quietly to her as we started serving our first customers of the day.

"I'll handle it differently this time." Jo smiled. "Now I know how you feel about it all."

The afternoon and evening went smoothly. Apart from the cool steel against my cock sometimes reminding me that I was wearing a penis cage, it felt like a normal day. I managed to forget all our woes for a little while, but then Frank came back.

"Had an okay day?" he asked, walking up to the bar just as Jo and Zena were chasing out the last few customers.

"It's been a good day, yeah," I nodded, preoccupied with putting the dirty glasses into the glasswasher amongst the other jobs that needed doing at closing time. "You?"

Brad said 'hello' but then went immediately into the back rooms like he usually did, leaving just the hulking form of Frank standing alone at the bar. "It's been... productive," the big man nodded, rubbing a large hand over his bald head. "I know it's after serving time, but I don't suppose I could get a whisky. Get one for yourself too. On me."

"Go on then," I replied with a cautious smile, remembering what he'd said to Jo earlier about us concluding *that* conversation tonight. "What does 'productive' mean? Good, I hope?"

“Yes,” he said, pulling up a barstool and parking his huge frame on it. “Let’s just say all our plans are in place. As I said before, the less you and Joanne know, the better.”

“Hi, Frank,” said Kathryn, walking over with Jo and Zena. It looked like they’d managed to clear the bar of the last few straggler customers.

“Kath,” the big man said with a smile. “How’s it going?”

Kathryn had been in tonight, spending most of it at the bar chatting to Jo while enjoying a few drinks. To my relief, Jo had kept the latest events - namely, me wearing a male chastity device - to herself this time. When she first arrived, she apologised to me, yet again, for letting me catch her in bed with him, but I’d told her not to worry about it and she hadn’t brought the subject up again since.

“It’s going good,” the curvy blonde replied in her best attempt at a seductive tone. It didn’t work; her voice was too high-pitched. “I wondered if you might want some company tonight?”

“Not tonight,” Frank took a sip of the whisky I’d poured him, then smiled at her. “I’ve done a bit of heavy lifting tonight and my back’s killing me.”

“Oh.” Kathryn’s face dropped but then she instantly recovered, regaining her carefree demeanour. “Never mind. In that case, I’ll head home. See you all tomorrow.”

“Thank goodness for that,” Frank said quietly as Jo’s plump best friend left.

“What?” I chuckled. “It looks like you were having a good time when I walked in on you.”

“I was,” Frank laughed too. “But one night with Kathryn is enough for me. She’s good fun in bed but her voice goes right through me. If she didn’t talk all the way through sex and then in-between, she’d be fine.”

“But you’ve always liked dirty talk in bed,” Jo said with a mock-serious expression, causing Zena to look at Jo in surprise.

“Not when it’s so high-pitched it makes your ears bleed,” Frank joked, also noticing Zena paying attention to the conversation. “Now, if it was this beautiful young lady offering me some company tonight, I’m sure my bad back would suddenly magically feel better.”

“Zena’s young enough to be your daughter,” Jo scolded her ex-husband, wiggling a finger at him. “Leave her alone.”

“I can take care of myself,” the dark-skinned Zena replied, shaking her head at Frank. “Also, he’s old enough to be my granddad. Not just my dad.”

“Ouch,” chuckled Frank ruefully. “That hurt. I guess I’ll just have to rely on... um... same thing as last night for company tonight.”

Shit. What was he doing? Saying things like that in front of Zena? The barmaid was my most trusted member of staff for a reason. She was intelligent and savvy. I didn’t want her knowing about Jo and Frank.

“Zena is staff,” my wife replied quietly after a moment, shooting Frank a sharp look before turning to the mocha-skinned girl. “I think you should get yourself off home now, Zena. It’s getting late. Thanks for the help tonight.”

“You’re welcome,” Zena replied, frowning first at Jo, then Frank and then settling her eyes on me. “Goodnight, Simon,” she said with a concerned look on her face.

Once she’d gone and I’d locked the door behind her, Jo rounded on Frank. “What are you thinking?” She scowled at him. “We don’t want all the staff knowing what’s going on with you and me. Be careful what you say in the future.”

Frank raised his hands innocently. “Sorry. I’m just excited to get you in bed. I’m presuming that now Simon knows, we don’t have to hide it? You don’t have to get up in the middle of the night. We can all just go to bed together and fuck.”

“You’re not having sex with me, Frank,” Jo reminded him as we finished up downstairs, before turning off the lights and heading into the backrooms. “Any more games like tonight and you won’t even be getting a blow job.”

“No need to be like that,” the big man replied as we walked upstairs. Jo simply gave him a withering look and he was quiet after that. We relaxed for a little while in the living room, watching some TV and winding down after a busy day before Jo eventually picked up the remote and switched the TV off.

“I’m going to bed,” she announced, standing up and yawning. She stretched her arms above her head as she did, pulling her black t-shirt tight across her breasts.

“Okay,” I said, also standing up but then I paused as Frank did the same.

“Your bedroom or mine?” he asked Jo, locking his fingers and cracking his knuckles.

I felt incredibly awkward and out-of-place right then. My cock twitched for some reason, making me aware of the steel cage that it was trapped in.

“Our bedroom?” suggested Jo. “If that’s okay with Simon.”

“Is this really how we’re doing this?” I asked once I found my voice. I was aware that I sounded unsure but this really was happening, no matter how surreal it felt. “It feels a bit weird.”

“It is kind of strange,” Jo agreed. “But there’s no point in me sneaking off in the middle of the night, as Frank says, or you having to hide outside the door. We’re all consenting adults. We can do this.”

“Come on then,” Frank said in his gravelly voice. “Stop overthinking things and let’s just go to bed.”

With that, he left the living room. Jo looked at me, her blue eyes holding mine for a moment as though she was about to say something, but she didn’t. She turned and followed Frank out of the door, pausing in the darkness outside and looking over her shoulder at me until I followed too.

Frank was already undressing in our bedroom as we entered. I thought he’d stop at his boxer shorts but he didn’t. He pulled them down and kicked them off, then he lay down on the bed, his impressive penis already semi-hard.

“Do you want to sit down?” Jo suggested to me, pointing to the chair by the dressing table. I nodded, unable to talk because my heart was thudding in my chest again. This felt unreal, knowing what was about to happen. My wife was going to suck her ex-husband’s cock while I watched from just a few feet away.

As I sat down, Jo was taking her jeans off while Frank watched.

“Take the top off,” he said. “And the bra. I love your big tits.”

Jo lifted the shirt up and over her head, then reached behind her back and unclasped her black bra, letting her large, heavy breasts fall free. As she stepped towards the bed, she hesitated by the lamp. “Can I turn the light off?” she asked.

“No,” Frank said and Jo’s hand - which had been reaching for the lamp - stopped. “Take your panties off too.”

Jo was now only wearing a small pair of lace-edged black panties. She turned to look at me, as though asking me if she should or not but I

pretended to not read the unasked question, and instead, I looked at Frank.

He was on the bed, his legs apart and one hand around his thick penis, stroking himself to hardness. It felt wrong, watching another man jerk off but I couldn't help but stare at his cock. His balls were large and covered in greying pubic hair. His shaft was thick and veiny and the tip of his cock was purple and shiny as he proudly played with his erection.

"I'm just sucking you off, Frank," Jo reminded him as she joined him on the bed. "You can take them off to look at my pussy, but don't try anything, okay?"

Frank clapped his hands together as Jo lay alongside him, then pushed himself up onto his knees. I watched as he hooked a finger of each hand inside the waistband of Jo's panties at her hips and slowly, he pulled them down.

As Jo's neatly-trimmed bush of dark pubic hair came into view, he paused, taking in the sight of what he'd wanted to see for so long, before sliding them down her thighs and then off her ankles.

"Happy now?" Jo said, parting her thighs slightly. From where I was sitting, I could see her slit, her pink labia protruding through her pubes, which were more sparse further down.

Frank was stroking his cock with one hand while the other eased my wife's thighs apart for a better look. "Nice," he nodded, his eyes locked to her pussy. "It looks just how I remember it when you were young."

Jo sat up and took Frank's free hand, pulling him down onto the bed, then she knelt over him but before she took his cock into her mouth, she looked at me. "Are you okay, Simon?"

I nodded, unable to speak again. The atmosphere in the room was intense.

Jo took him in her mouth, one of her hands jerking up and down his shaft while her lips and tongue worked the tip. Frank sighed in appreciation, looking over at me.

"Your wife's blowjobs are so good," he murmured. "Are you getting horny, watching her suck a real dick?"

I was. I could feel my erection pressing against the metal bars of the cage. It wasn't painful, just uncomfortable.

"Yes, I guess," I managed to say, shuffling in my seat

"I bet her pussy looks fantastic from where you're sitting," Frank commented, aware that Jo's ass was pointing towards me as she continued

to suck his dick.

“It does,” I replied, adjusting myself in my shorts and wishing I could relieve myself by stroking it while watching the scene in front of me.

“I’ve got an idea,” Jo said, lifting her head from Frank’s cock for a moment. “If it’s okay with Simon, I could put my pussy in your face while sucking you?”

“We could 69,” Frank murmured to me in his low voice. “Would you like to see that, Simon?”

“I don’t know about the actual 69 thing but if you want to move into that position, I guess that’s okay?” I replied. My thinking was that I’d be able to see Jo’s mouth work Frank’s dick better if her body wasn’t in the way - as nice as her curvy backside was to look at.

“No touching,” Jo warned Frank as she turned around, straddling his face while keeping her pussy a few inches away. She flashed a wicked smile at me before lowering her head to take his impressive erection in her mouth again.

I watched as she massaged his large balls with her hand while her mouth slid up and down his veiny shaft, making Frank moan in pleasure as she increased the tempo, then slowed down again, teasing him.

I was that distracted - focused on watching Jo give him head that I never noticed Frank’s hands on Jo’s ass.

“Excuse me,” Jo said, muffled around his cock. “What are you doing?”

Frank seemed to be pulling her butt cheeks apart. “You said I couldn’t touch but I’m not touching your pussy.”

“You’re trying to spread my pussy or open me up or something,” Jo said, his dick dropping out of her mouth.

“I just want to have a better look,” he chuckled, then moved his hands again. “Oh, yeah. I can see it now. That hole looks tight, almost like a virgin’s.”

“What’s he doing?” I asked.

“Come and have a look,” Frank invited, so I stood up and walked to his end of the bed. The big man had his thumbs inside Jo’s labia, spreading them and looking at the deeper pink parts of her pink slit. As I watched, he pushed a finger into her pussy, sliding it in slowly right up to the knuckle. Then he withdrew it and slid a second in alongside it.

“Frank!” Jo objected, looking over her shoulder. “I said no touching.”

The big man was slowly finger-fucking her now, while I watched. “Just let me lick her, Simon. Let me make her cum.”

“Can he?” Jo asked. “I am kind of horny.”

I didn’t say anything. I felt completely out-of-place again, like a spare part. It was weird, having my wife and her ex-husband naked on our marital bed, getting each other off.

“I’ll take your silence as a ‘yes’,” Frank shrugged when I didn’t reply, then lifted his head and buried his face into Jo’s pussy. My wife replied by pushing back against him, sitting on his face so he could work his tongue into her. Then she resumed sucking his cock with even more gusto than before.

This wasn’t happening. It had to be a dream. I walked back to the chair in a daze and sat down, watching until they’d finished. Jo came first, somehow managing to keep Frank’s cock in her mouth as she climaxed, moaning around it and her entire body shuddering as she came. When she’d regathered herself, she stroked his thick shaft fast, pumping him into her mouth until Frank’s thighs clenched and he shoved his hips upwards aggressively.

Jo’s eyes widened slightly but she kept her lips locked around his cock, which I could see pulsing until eventually, he sagged back onto the bed and Jo released his softening penis.

“How much cum?” she asked, wiping her mouth with the back of her hand. “I could hardly swallow it, there was that much.”

“Sorry, babe,” Frank laughed. “I was horny from licking your pussy. What can I say?”

“Are you coming to bed now?” Jo said, swivelling her legs off the edge of the bed and looking at me.

“I’ve got another request,” Frank said, pushing himself up onto his elbows. “I know it’s a lot to ask, but this is a big bed. Would it be too much if I slept in here with you? I’m tired and I can’t be bothered to move.”

“For fuck’s sake,” Jo rolled her eyes at her ex-husband. “Simon, can Frank sleep in bed with us?”

“I just want to remember what it’s like to hold you in my arms,” the big man asked. “If I’m not allowed to fuck you, surely that’s the next best thing.”

“Whatever,” I said, feeling incredibly aroused by the whole thing still. It wasn’t fair. Jo had orgasmed and Frank had cum, but I was still nursing

an erection which I couldn't relieve myself of. "If we can all fit. You're not a small man, Frank."

Frank got up, his soft cock swinging around between his legs like a pendulum. He pulled the covers back as Jo pulled her t-shirt back on over her head. "Put your shorts back on," she told her ex-husband. I don't want your sticky dick dribbling all over the sheets."

Frank laughed but complied, slipping his shorts back on before climbing underneath the covers. Jo got in next, laying in the middle and I stripped down to my boxer shorts and got under the covers next to her on the opposite side to Frank.

"Turn the light off," she told me, so I reached over and flipped the switch, plunging the room into darkness.

"Well, isn't this cosy?" Frank murmured. "Now, I'm sleepy so I'll say good night."

He reached an arm across Jo, his hand briefly brushing against my chest, then he pulled her towards him, spooning his huge body around her. I could see Jo's eyes looking at me in the darkness, her back nestled against Frank. I smiled at her.

"Good night," she said and closed her eyes.

I tried, in vain, to sleep.

Chapter 18

“Frank, no.” I was woken from sleep by Jo whispering. I didn’t open my eyes. I just lay there, listening.

“Oh, come on.” Frank was whispering too, his voice barely audible. I figured he was whispering directly into Jo’s ear if the two of them were still spooning.

I felt Jo’s leg move, brushing across my calf. The bed creaked and bounced slightly as someone’s weight shifted on the mattress, probably Frank’s.

“Stop. You’ll wake Simon.” Jo whispered again.

“He’s out for the count,” Frank countered. “He was snoring his head off a second ago.”

“Well, he’s not now,” Jo said quietly. “Shush. Stop. Go to sleep, Frank.”

I risked a look, barely opening my eyes just a fraction. As they adjusted to the dark I saw that Jo was still facing me, Frank behind her. The covers were pulled down slightly to reveal his shoulders and I could see that Jo still had her t-shirt on but the way his arm was bent, I suspected he was cupping her breast through the material.

“Just let me put the tip in,” I heard Frank whisper. “That’s not actually sex, is it? Just the tip.”

His form moved, his weight shifting again. I could make out that Jo’s eyes were closed as he adjusted his position.

“Oh, Frank. Don’t,” I heard Jo say with a soft moan.

“Fuck,” he continued. “That feels so good.”

“Okay now stop,” Jo said, wriggling slightly in his grasp.

“Just a bit more,” Frank whispered. “God, you’re soaking wet.”

Jo groaned. “Oh, God,” she sighed. “Stop.”

“I just wanted to be inside you,” he said, his voice still hushed. “There we go. All the way in. You’re so tight.”

“What do you expect?” Jo whispered back. “My pussy is used to Simon’s. It hasn’t had one as big as yours for years.”

“I wish he’d let me fuck you,” Frank sighed. “It feels so good.”

The bed moved again, a very slow but subtle motion. He was sliding in and out of her, very slowly and gently, so as not to wake me up.

“You are fucking me,” Jo hissed. “Now stop before you wake him up.”

“This isn’t fucking,” Frank giggled. “You know how I fuck.”

“Yes, I do,” Jo said with a certain tone in her voice; one of longing. “I’ll talk to him tomorrow but he’s my husband, Frank. I cheated on him once by sucking your dick without telling him. I’m not going to do it again and sleep with you behind his back.”

“I’ll talk to him too. I need you, Joanne. I need to fuck you properly.”

“Okay. Now stop,” Jo told him and Frank stopped moving his hips although I thought he was still inside her.

“I’ll settle for a kiss then,” the big man said softly.

I watched as Jo turned, slowly and deliberately so as not to wake me and kissed him on the lips. As she did, the covers pulled back to reveal that her t-shirt was lifted up and Frank’s hand was cupping her breast. They kissed for quite a while before eventually, Jo pulled away.

I felt a huge wave of jealousy sear through me. For some reason, their kissing felt wrong. More wrong than them having sex. Kissing was special; it was intimate. I pushed the emotion down, knowing how ridiculous it was.

“There you go. Now stop, Frank, you’re getting me really horny.”

“Good,” her ex-husband whispered in the dark.

“Go to sleep.” Jo shuffled away from him slightly, moving her body closer to me and I closed my eyes before she could see me looking. She entwined one of her legs between mine and I could tell from the way Frank moved that she’d put some space between them. He wasn’t in her now. Jo’s arm snaked out around me, stroking the skin on my upper arm.

A few minutes later, I heard a soft snore escape from Frank and knowing that he’d gone to sleep, I allowed myself to relax and drift off too, even though my mind was reeling from the knowledge that he’d just been inside her. His huge cock had been inside my wife’s pussy. At least she’d had the decency to stop him.

For once, I was the first one to wake that following morning. I rubbed my eyes and sat up, looking at the two sleeping figures next to me. Jo and Frank were back to back, my wife facing me while Frank faced the

bedroom wall. I hoped they hadn't done anything else during the night, but if they had, I'm sure they'd have woken me up.

I slipped out of bed quietly, not wanting to wake them and wrapping a dressing gown around myself, I tiptoed to the kitchen to make a coffee. I needed some alone time to think. I sat at the kitchen table and sipped at the hot drink, contemplating the events of last night.

My dick was aching as I re-imagined the sight of Jo sliding her lips around the end of Frank's penis. The way she'd held his balls as she worked her way up and down his shaft. The look on her face as he'd shot his load down her throat.

I remember how he'd opened her pussy with his fingers and enjoyed the sight of her sticky, wet slit. How Jo had moaned when he shoved two fingers in and out of her and how she'd orgasmed on his tongue when he licked her pussy.

He'd fucked her last night too. Not properly - more of a gentle insertion and a few slow pumps of his cock in and out, but still, technically, he'd fucked her. He'd been inside her - the main thing he'd wanted this past week or so but now I knew it'd just make him want her more.

What was I to do?

"What are you doing down here all on your own?" Jo asked, startling me.

She was standing in the doorway in just her t-shirt, her dark curly hair all messed up from sleep. I looked at her, enjoying how cute she always looked in the morning and the way her curves showed through the t-shirt.

"I just thought I'd let you have a little extra sleep," I shrugged.

"You looked like you were deep in thought just then." Jo walked over and put a hand on my shoulder. "You're not angry about last night?"

"Last night?" I said, looking up at her. Did she know that I'd awoken while they were having sex?

"You know," Jo licked her lips. "Me letting Frank go down on me."

She didn't know. "I didn't expect that to happen but no, I'm not angry."

"Good." She reached down and took the coffee from me, placing it on the table. Then she took my hand and pulled me to a standing position. "Come back to bed, just for a little while."

"Why?" I asked, letting her lead me back towards the bedroom.

“Because you deserve a treat.” She grinned at me then she shook Frank’s shoulder as we walked back into the bedroom. “Frank. Wake up.”

“Hey,” he said, rolling onto his back and stretching, his long arms reaching almost to either edge of the bed. “Good morning.”

Jo climbed back into bed, still pulling me behind her. Once I was back in bed too, the three of us all sitting up, she turned to her ex-husband. “I granted your request last night,” she said to him slowly. “So now I have a request to make.”

“I’ve only just woken up,” the big man grunted. “But okay. What is it?”

“Unlock Simon from his cage,” Jo replied. “Just for a while. He can put it back on later.”

“Why?” Frank blinked and rubbed his hands over the top of his bald head, still coming around from sleep.

“He deserves a treat,” Jo shrugged. “Don’t you think?”

“What sort of treat?” Frank asked cautiously. “No sex, remember.”

I saw Jo raise an eyebrow at that and I knew why, but I didn’t want to give away the fact that I knew, so I didn’t question it.

“I want to give my husband a blow job,” Jo said levelly. “Pass me the key. Please.”

Frank swung his large legs out of bed, his eyes scanning the floor for his trousers. When he found them, he walked over and bent down, going through the pockets until he found it.

“Here you go.” He tossed it over and Jo caught it in one hand then he walked back over and sat on the edge of the bed.

“Why don’t you go in the shower while I sort him out?” Jo pointed towards the bedroom door.

“If you think I’m leaving you alone so you can fuck him, you’re wrong.” Frank shook his head with a wry smile. “I wasn’t born yesterday.”

“I’m not going to fuck him,” Jo corrected him. “I just didn’t think you’d enjoy watching me suck his cock, seeing as how you’re so jealous.”

“I can handle it.” Frank didn’t move. “I’m not leaving you alone with Simon unless he has the cock ring on.”

“Fine,” Jo rolled her eyes. “Simon. Take your shorts down. Let me get that contraption off you for a while.”

What? She was going to give me head while Frank was here? I did need to cum though. My cock was still aching. Could I do it though, with

another man watching?

Reluctantly, I lifted my behind off the bed and took my shorts down. Jo leaned over me, fiddling with the lock and key, then after a moment, she worked the device loose and pulled it from my small but painfully-stiff penis.

“It’s literally half the size of yours,” Jo said to her ex-husband, “But I love it anyway.”

Then she dropped her head down and wrapped her lips around it. The warmth of her mouth enveloping me was pure bliss. I put my hand on the back of her head as I’d seen Frank do, and pushed her right down, hoping she’d gag on it like she had done with him but she didn’t. She could take my length right into her mouth with ease.

I looked sideways, feeling a sense of triumph over Frank for once. I was getting my cock sucked and he wasn’t right now. I’d heard her mention a few times how he was envious of me being Jo’s husband and the thought that he was jealous of me right now was satisfying. As my eyes found Frank though, I saw that instead, he seemed to be rather enjoying watching. He had his own erect dick in his hand and was stroking it casually while watching us.

“At least you get sucked deep,” he said to me with a dirty smile. “She gags on mine when I push her head right down. That’s one advantage of having a little cock, I guess.”

I knew he was trying to subtly belittle me because he was jealous, so I didn’t rise to the bait. Instead, I just relaxed, enjoying the feeling of Jo’s tongue swirling around the head of my cock until just a moment or two later, I came. Jo kept her head there as I wriggled on the bed, the sensation feeling extra-intense for some reason until eventually she swallowed my cum and then looked over at Frank.

“Thanks,” she said to her ex. “I just think he deserved that, after last night.”

“I suppose so,” the big man was still stroking his cock. “Do I get to cum too?”

“Are you going to take long?” Jo asked. “We’ve got a pub to open in a couple of hours.”

“Depends how good you suck it,” Frank shrugged. “I’d come faster if you let me fuck you.”

“I’d better suck it good then.” Jo laid on her front next to him, wrapping her hand around his dick and slowly tugging it up and down while looking at it admiringly. “Unless Simon says I can have sex with it?”

I was tempted to let them fuck. She’d already had it inside her last night. But now wasn’t the right time. “Just suck it and Frank? Hurry up. Like Jo says, we’ve got things to do.”

Jo sighed and pouted for a moment, then wrapped her lips around him and began to suck him hungrily. Frank closed his eyes and after a few minutes, began to buck his hips, thrusting into her mouth.

Without the testosterone flooding my bloodstream now that I’d ejaculated, it wasn’t quite as enjoyable to watch, so I was relieved when he said he was going to cum. However, rather than empty his balls into her mouth, he instead pulled out, pushing her head away.

“On your tits,” he said. “Like we used to.”

Jo rolled over and before I had a chance to object, she tugged her t-shirt right up underneath her chin, exposing her full nakedness to him. Frank quickly knelt up, holding his cock in his hand and squeezing it until it was hovering over her large breasts which pooled out because she was on her back.

“Push them together,” Frank said in a strained voice and again Jo complied, using her hands to lift them so that her large erect nipples pointed straight up at the ceiling. Then he groaned loudly and jet after jet of thick, white cum leapt from the mushroom-like head of his dick, some landing on Jo’s chin but most of the sticky white spunk landing across her breasts.

“Yuck,” Jo moaned when he’d finished squeezing the last few drops out onto her chest. “I guess I had better go in the shower first. Frank, why do you always cum so much?”

“More than Simon?” the big man asked as he relaxed back on the bed.

“A lot more,” Jo said, removing her t-shirt and using it to wipe the cum from her chin and breasts. “Maybe it’s to do with your size. I don’t know but it’s gross.”

“Listen, Simon,” Frank addressed me as I pulled my boxer shorts back up and wrapped the robe around me, preparing to go downstairs while Jo showered. I needed some time on my own again. As unexpected as last night was, I certainly hadn’t expected this. “You don’t need to wear the cock ring until later. The pub keeps you busy and judging by how small and soft your cock went after cumming just now, I think it’s safe to trust you

until tonight. I'll make sure you put it on before bed, that way you don't have to walk around with it all day."

"Great," I said, annoyed that the big man thought he was doing me a favour by *letting me not wear a chastity device*. If Frank detected the sarcasm in my voice, he didn't mention it. I waited until Jo had gone in the shower, listening for the lock on the door to click and then went downstairs to start getting the bar ready and for some precious time to ponder on what had just happened this morning, as well as last night.

Chapter 19

“Two more nights,” Frank said that evening. “That’s all you’re stuck with me for.”

“Oh. How come?” Jo asked him. We were sitting around the corner table at the end of the night, me, Jo, Frank, Brad and Kathryn. It was our official night off, so we’d decided to have a drink and to relax for a few hours. Zena had run the bar for the night and was finishing up while we finished our last round of drinks.

“We put the last few plans in place today,” Frank explained. “I won’t tell you too much but the job is going to go ahead the day after tomorrow, all being well.”

“I’m worried,” Jo said. “Is it dangerous?”

“The less you know, the better,” Frank repeated. “I know I keep saying that but it’s true. Trust me though. It’s planned to perfection. Nothing can or will go wrong, will it Brad?”

The dark-haired, dark young man smiled for once. “Without giving anything away, I’m impressed with the setup. I think Frank’s right. The plan is perfect.”

“Okay, well that’s all we want to know,” I said before Jo asked any more questions.

“Then you’ll be going home after that?” Kathryn asked in her squeaky voice. Jo’s best friend had been her usual bubbly self tonight, seeming not to have taken Frank’s rejection last night to heart at all.

“I’m afraid so,” Frank nodded. “As soon as we’re done, we’ll be heading away from the area so as not to arouse any suspicions. We’ll pack our things before setting off to the job and immediately afterwards we’ll be on the road.”

“If tomorrow’s your last night with Jo and Simon, we should have a party,” Kathryn suggested. “You could invite Charlie, Bill and the rest of the crew.”

“We don’t want to attract any undue attention.” Frank frowned but Brad seemed to like the idea.

“Oh, come on, Frank,” the young man said. “We could use a few drinks and a bit of fun. It’ll ease the nerves.”

“We could... close the pub for a night?” Frank suggested, looking at Jo and me.

“I’m not sure that’s financially viable,” I shook my head, not liking the idea of having all these troublemakers getting drunk and running wild in the pub.

“We still have plenty of money left over.” Frank tapped his fingers on the table. “We could pay you whatever you’ll lose out on in bar takings.”

“That’s a good idea,” Kathryn said, nudging me. “Isn’t it, Simon? If you’re not losing anything, it’d be nice to give Frank and Brad a good send-off.”

“A send-off?” Jo interjected. “You make it sound like a funeral.”

“I bloody hope it’s not a funeral,” Frank laughed. “Let me think about it. We can deal with it tomorrow. I’m too tired to work it all out tonight. It’s been a busy day.”

After the events of this morning, Frank had gotten himself ready then after a bite to eat with Brad, the two of them headed out somewhere like they did every day. They’d come back a bit earlier than usual tonight - around 9pm - and had joined Jo, Kathryn and I for drinks.

“Maybe we should call it a night then?” Jo said, her eyes on Frank. Was she flirting with him? “If you’re tired, I mean.”

“Sounds like a good idea to me.” Frank picked up his beer and downed the remaining half that was left in the glass. “Erm... does Kathryn know about our little... arrangement?”

“Not unless you’ve told her,” Jo replied. “It’s kind of private, Frank,”

“Oh, okay,” Frank nodded. “Understood. I just thought with you two being best friends...”

“Arrangement?” Kathryn squeaked. “What arrangement?”

“Jo’s been sucking Frank off every night,” Brad giggled, not even bothering to keep his voice down.

“For fuck’s sake,” I hissed across the table at the young man. “Shut up, Brad.”

“You told Brad?” Jo was sitting next to Frank and nudged him hard in the ribs. “Really, Frank? I trusted you.”

“He didn’t need to tell me,” Brad shrugged. “I woke up last night and went for a pee and your bedroom door was open. I saw you. Simon was sitting on a chair watching suck you Frank’s dick.”

“He asked me this morning about it so I had to tell him we’d made a sort of arrangement,” Frank explained. “I’m sorry. Simon shouldn’t have left the door open.”

“Oh, my God,” Jo covered her mouth with her hand in horror. “How much did he see?”

“Everything,” giggled Brad. “I couldn’t *not* watch, could I? You did the 69 and Frank came in your mouth.”

“Jesus,” Jo said, covering all of her face now with both hands.

“You shouldn’t have watched,” I shook my head angrily at the kid. “When you saw what you did, you should have had some respect for people’s privacy and gone to bed.”

“Would you have?” Frank defended him. “Be honest. In his position, you’d probably have watched and had a wank too, wouldn’t you? The lad’s a virgin. He’s probably never even seen a real pair of tits and a nice hairy pussy before.”

“You’re a virgin?” Kath asked him with a laugh. “You’re how old? Nineteen? And a virgin?”

“Shut up,” Brad said, his giggling stopped now and his face dropping. “Frank, why’d you have to tell them?”

“Well, it seems like all our secrets are coming out tonight,” Frank patted him on the back, then turned back to me. “I found out the other day. He had a chance with some girl while we were out - she was all over him - and he backed out. I asked him why but he wouldn’t say, then eventually, when I pressed him - asked him how many girls he’d been with - I guessed.”

“How can you possibly be a virgin?” Kathryn asked the dour Brad. “You’re a good looking lad.”

“He’s confused about his sexuality,” Frank answered for him. “We had a long chat about it. He’s not sure if he’s gay or straight or bi or whatever. I told him he should just try having sex with someone - anyone - that’ll help him decide.”

“It’s not as easy as that,” Brad started, banging his fist on the table angrily until Frank shot him a stare.

“Calm down,” I leaned over the table and patted the lad’s hand. “Chill. It’s cool.”

“Anyway,” Kathryn turned to Jo, changing the subject, “Have you really been giving Frank blowjobs every night? You kept that quiet, you dark horse.”

“It just kind of happened,” Jo said, her face turning to me with an apologetic expression. “I’d had a bit to drink and...”

“How did you feel about it, Simon?” Kathryn reached across and touched my hand. “Are you okay with it? Brad says you watched?”

“Don’t embarrass him,” Frank said, defending me much to my surprise.

“It’s okay, Frank,” I said with a grateful smile before turning to the squeaky-voiced Kath. “Yes, I’m okay with it. It’s kind of personal between Jo and me. I don’t want to talk about it if that’s okay.”

“I can’t say I’m surprised,” Kathryn said with a nod. “She was always the kinky one when we were younger.”

“Was she?” Brad was grinning again, his embarrassment seemingly gone.

Kathryn pointed towards Frank. “Didn’t you and Danny have a threeway with Jo once? And Sharon and Jo together?”

Frank nodded but didn’t say anything so Jo spoke up. “Yes, we did all those things, but we were young and crazy. I’m older now. What’s going on with Frank right now, it’s something personal to us, like Simon says. We’re all consenting adults after all.”

“So you and Jo did a group sex thing?” Brad asked Frank, his face suddenly pale. “With my mum and dad?”

“Oh, shit,” Kathryn said, obviously feeling awkward. “I’m sorry, Brad. I completely forgot about that when I said that.”

“We’ll talk about that another day,” Frank told the young man. “Don’t go thinking any less of your mother. She’s a lovely woman and as Joanne said, we were all young and a bit crazy back then. It was a different time.”

Brad nodded, considering his words. “So are you and Jo having sex too?”

“No sex,” I replied, eager to point that out and retain some dignity, even if it was only the tiniest shred. “It’s just... what you saw last night.”

“Why not?” Kathryn asked, her face a mask of curiosity. “I mean, if they’re going down on each other and presumably making each other cum,

then they might as well just do it? It's only sex and as you say, you're all consenting adults."

"Simon's not comfortable with us going all the way," Jo explained.

I wished a huge hole would just appear and devour me. This was so embarrassing it was almost painful.

"It's late," Frank said, eyeing me. Was he aware of how I felt? "We should call it a night."

"Oh, I see," Kathryn replied, a huge grin on her face as she swept her eyes from Frank to Jo to me. "I'm sure you're eager to go to bed, for... you know what." She winked knowingly at Brad and made the gesture with one hand of holding a cock while sucking it.

"Very funny," I said, standing up as Frank did the same. "See you tomorrow, Kath."

"Yes, we'll get that little party thing organised," the big man agreed, ushering Kathryn towards the exit.

"I'm going, I'm going," she giggled as I opened the door for her. "Goodnight." Then she turned to Frank and Jo. "Enjoy your naughty fun, you two."

Both Frank and Jo simply rolled their eyes at her and then once she'd gone, they went and sat back down with Brad while I helped Zena with the closing time duties.

"Hi," the lovely mocha-skinned girl said as I helped her clear out the last couple of customers. "Is everything okay?"

"Sure," I said with a shrug. "Why wouldn't it be?"

"I'm not sure whether I should say something or not," she said, as we returned to the bar with the final few empty glasses. "It's just that... well, I couldn't help but overhear some of what Brad and Kathryn were saying over there."

Oh no. My heart sank a little. I'd been humiliated enough already but now Zena possibly knew about Jo and Frank too. "What did you hear?" I asked her quietly.

"I wasn't deliberately eavesdropping," Zena hastened to add. "I just heard something about Jo - and Frank... having oral sex. That's why I asked if everything was okay."

"Everything is okay, I promise," I said, cringing with embarrassment. Why did Kathryn and Brad have to be so loud? "It's not your fault that Kathryn's got a big mouth."

“I think half the customers in the bar heard too,” Zena said with a look of empathy on her face. “At least none of them were regulars.”

“It is what it is.” I was turned away from Zena, trying to hide my face as I finished closing the bar down and checking the till. “I’m sorry for what you heard. I hope it hasn’t made you think any less of Jo and me.”

“Not at all.” The young woman put a hand on my shoulder. “I just never had you and Jo down as the type to have an open relationship, that’s all. It’s very modern of you.”

I looked over my shoulder at her, wondering if she was having some fun at my expense and she *was* smiling - but not in a bad way. “I’ve heard it’s all the rage,” I joked. “...this open relationship thing. We thought we’d give it a try.”

“Seriously though-” Zena held my gaze with her dark brown eyes. “Everything is okay, right?”

I glanced over to the corner to see Brad, Frank and Jo chatting away, oblivious to the conversation Zena and I were having. “If you’re worried that Frank is coercing us into this, it’s nothing like that. It’s not an ideal situation, but he’s going home the day after tomorrow so it’s only for two more nights.”

Zena looked at me for a moment, weighing me up. “Okay then. If you want anyone to talk to, you know where I am, right?”

With that, she went home; all her jobs done and as I locked the door behind her, I called over to my wife and the two men. “We’re all done. Do you want to go upstairs so I can set the alarms?”

“Yes, it *is* late,” Jo said, standing up and as she did, I saw that she was holding Frank’s hand. I felt a pang of jealousy, seeing that. A pang as strong as when I’d seen them kiss. Again, holding hands felt *intimate*. Like kissing, it felt like something that should be reserved for me: her husband. Once again, like last night, I pushed the emotion down because of the absurdity of it. Jo had sucked Frank’s cock and he’d licked her pussy. They’d made each other cum. He’d even had his dick inside her, even if it wasn’t what Frank defined as ‘proper sex.’

As they walked past the bar, still holding hands, with Brad trailing behind them, and headed through the backroom door, I couldn’t help but wonder what was going to happen next. Was it going to be a repeat of last night, or were things going to progress even further?

Chapter 20

“So are you going to 69 again tonight?” Brad asked as the three of them headed up the staircase in front of me.

“Brad!” Jo said, looking over her shoulder at him as they reached the landing atop the stairs. “You can’t ask questions like that!”

“If you are, can I watch again?” the dark-haired young man asked cheekily with a raised eyebrow.

“No, you can’t watch,” Frank said, scuffing him lightly around the side of the head with one hand and then pushing him towards his bedroom. “Go on, you cheeky fucker. Get some sleep and leave the real grown-ups to our fun.”

“So that’s a yes then,” he said with a knowing grin over his shoulder as he disappeared into his room. “You’re going to 69 again and pervy Simon is going to watch and wank himself off, no doubt.”

“Goodnight, Brad.” I walked over and closed his bedroom door as he stood there smirking at me. Then I turned to Frank and Jo who were struggling to hide their amusement. “Well, that was a fucking embarrassing couple of hours.”

“I’m sorry about Brad,” Frank said apologetically just as Jo said the same about Kath.

I told them both that it wasn’t their fault as we had a brief sit down in the living room with a coffee before eventually agreeing that it was time to retire to bed.

“Are we doing the same as last night?” Frank asked Jo as she turned the lights off and we headed towards our bedroom.

I wondered if he was merely asking about the oral sex that they’d enjoyed together or if he was hinting at us sleeping together again so he could try and get his dick inside her once more while I was asleep.

“I can’t believe I’m saying this,” I replied as we entered the main bedroom, all three of us. “But yes, if that’s what you and Jo want?”

“Do I want to suck Frank’s big one?” Jo said with a mock-serious expression, rubbing her chin as she pretended to think about it. “Hmmmmmm.”

“And do I want to get my dick sucked and lick Jo’s nice hairy, juicy pussy?” Frank also mused out loud. “It’s a difficult decision but while I think about it, we should really put your little man back in his cage, Simon.”

I gave up even trying to resist or reconcile any of this to myself. *Only tonight and tomorrow night left to go*, I thought as he rummaged through the bedside drawer where he’d stored the penis cage.

“Yes, let’s get you sorted,” Jo smiled at me, obviously merry from the drinks we’d had this evening. She unbuttoned my shirt so that I could take it off while she pulled down my jeans and boxer shorts. “There he is, my little soldier, already standing to attention.”

“For fuck’s sake, Jo!” I cursed, not expecting her to pull my undergarments down at the same time, exposing my erection to Frank before I’d prepared myself mentally. “You could have warned me.”

I don’t know why my cock was already hard, but it was. Frank came over with the silvery penis cage and kneeled down in front of me. “Let’s get you locked up,” he said and to my surprise, rather than make Jo put the device over my penis, he did it himself.

I cringed as he pulled my erection down with one finger, then let go so that it sprung back up to smack me on the lower belly.

“It’s kind of cute, isn’t it?” Jo giggled.

Frank nodded and chuckled too then my humiliation was complete as he took my erection between his forefinger and thumb and then slid the cage down over it. “I was worried it’d be too small for you but it fits fine,” he noted as he closed the base ring under my balls and snapped it shut, finishing by turning the key in the small padlock.

I bent down to gather my jeans and shorts but Jo stopped me. “Just sit down like that,” she said quietly. “I want to be able to look over and see your hard little cock in its cage.”

I remembered what she’d said about it being a turn-on for her to see me being submissive. I guess this was her exploring that. I sat down as she asked, although I felt slightly uncomfortable with them seeing just how much this also aroused me.

“I’ve looked forward to this all fucking day,” Frank said in his low, gravelly voice, as he turned to Jo. She turned around so that he could unzip the black dress she was wearing, which fell to the floor as she turned back around. She was wearing a sexy black bra and panty set which made Frank take a step back to appreciate the sight before him. “You’re so fucking sexy.” He leered at her, his deep-set eyes roaming her body then focusing on her breasts as she reached behind her back to unclasp the bra.

“Thank you,” my wife said, letting the bra fall to the floor. Her dark pink nipples were hard and Frank couldn’t resist reaching out with both hands and pinching them gently between his fingers as Jo slid down her panties. “You’re way overdressed for my liking,” she said, now that she was naked.

Frank hastily removed his shirt and kicked off his own socks, trousers and shorts, his long penis looping out and bobbing around in front of him like a knight’s lance as he did so.

As soon as he sat down on the edge of the bed, Jo knelt down in front of him, shuffling between his feet as he opened his thighs to make room and took hold of his stiffening cock in one hand.

“Don’t worry,” she said, turning to me before sucking it. “You’ll get yours sucked in the morning.” Then she lowered her head and wrapped her lips around the end of Frank’s penis and began to give him head.

“I want to fuck you so bad,” Frank said, his bald head rolling back for a moment in pleasure as my wife worked his cock with a combination of her hand and mouth.

“I know,” Jo mumbled around his shaft. “I want to fuck you too, but it’s up to Simon.”

Frank turned to look at me, breathing slightly heavily because of what Jo was doing to him. “I need to tell you something,” he said. “Last night, while we were asleep, my dick went inside Joanne a little bit.”

“What?” I said, pretending not to know. I saw Jo pause in what she was doing, looking at me out of the corner of her eye.

“We were spooning and Joanne’s ass was pressed against me,” Frank explained. “I’d gotten hard again and when I moved, my hard-on slid between her thighs, beneath her ass, if you know what I mean? It was pressing against her pussy. I couldn’t help but wriggle a bit and it kind of went inside her.”

“Oh, right,” I replied, watching Jo for her reaction to Frank telling me their little secret from last night. “How much of it went in?”

“Jo stopped me,” Frank added. “She wouldn’t let me fuck her, even though I wanted to. She was worried about you waking up and didn’t want to do it without your permission but I guess most of it went in if I’m being totally honest.”

I looked at my wife, who moved her mouth from his dick and pushed her dark curly hair out of her eyes to look back at me. “And you didn’t tell me this earlier because...?” I asked.

“I was waiting for the right moment,” Jo said, wincing slightly with chagrin. “Plus it only went in and out a couple of times, so it’s not like we had sex, not really. Penetration doesn’t mean the same thing as actual sex.”

“It went in and out a couple of times?” I repeated, switching my gaze from Jo to Frank.

“I tried to talk her into letting me fuck her,” Frank raised his hands as though he were innocent. “You can’t blame me. You’d do the same in my position. But she stopped me, Simon. That’s a good thing. You should be proud of Joanne. She could easily have just let me do it. I could have done it gently until I came. You wouldn’t have woken up.”

“I almost let you,” Jo said, looking up at him with her blue eyes. I could tell she was horny. This was the most open she’d been about everything and the way she was acting wasn’t like the Jo of the past few nights.

“Do you really want to fuck each other that bad?” I asked, resigning myself to the fact that I was being a hindrance to them having what they both clearly wanted. I didn’t want to be seen like that by Jo. I didn’t want her to resent me.

“I’d love nothing more, Simon,” Frank nodded. “You know that.”

“It’d just be sex,” Jo’s eyes moved to me, staring right into mine. “I promise. I’ll love you forever if you let Frank make love to me.”

Make love. Again, I felt a surge of jealousy ripple through me. If I was so jealous then why was my cock harder than ever? Why did the idea of watching them finally fuck intrigue me so much?

“He’s already been inside you,” I sighed and shook my head, acting as if the decision was tearing me apart. It wasn’t an easy decision but it was one I’d reached without *that much* difficulty. Some part of me inside had

just come to terms with it. They were going to fuck, one way or another. It was inevitable. "You might as well just do it."

"Really?" Jo said, but Frank didn't question my decision. He looked at me for the briefest of moments and winked as if to say, 'Thanks', then bent down and scooped my wife up into his arms and tossed her onto the bed.

At that moment, I saw something move out of the corner of my eye and looked towards the door to see Brad standing in the shadows beyond it. I was about to say something to him when he put a finger to his lips, then mouthed the word, 'please' at me.

This was insane. My wife was about to fuck her ex-husband not only while I watched, but while a nineteen-year-old kid watched too.

I could have said 'no' and gotten up to close the bedroom door, which stupidly none of us had thought to do earlier, but I didn't. Frank was already enjoying Jo's body, kissing her neck and moving down along her collarbone towards her breasts, and I didn't want to disrupt their obvious lust for each other by suddenly standing up and distracting them. I also didn't necessarily want Brad to see my full nakedness. The arms of the chair covered my groin towards his point-of-view. Having Frank ridicule my small penis was bad enough without having to further endure the mirth of a nineteen-year-old.

Frank was sucking Jo's breasts, his body laying half over hers and his hard cock pressing against her thigh. As he moved further down, kissing over her stomach towards her pussy, I was distracted again by movement in the doorway. I looked, seeing exactly what I expected. Brad had only been wearing a t-shirt and shorts but now he'd pulled his own cock out and was stroking himself slowly, his eyes fixed on the bed and the two figures upon it.

Frank's head was between her legs now, his body repositioned so that he could lap at her slit with his tongue. Jo spread her thighs wider and even reached down and opened her own pussy up for him with two fingers. Then her forefinger competed with Frank's tongue for a few moments as I watched, rubbing her clit in time with his tongue's flicking movements.

"I'm going to cum," she moaned and as she did, Frank moved, replacing his tongue with his fingers, sliding two of them inside her and pumping them in and out rapidly, prolonging her quivering orgasm.

Then, as she relaxed and her orgasm subsided, he moved quickly, slithering up the bed and covering her totally with his huge body. I saw him

reach down and position the bulbous head of his erection at the entrance to her hairy pussy and then with one slow push, he entered her.

Jo groaned at the invasion of a new dick inside her, well - not totally new - but the first penis she'd had in her in over fifteen years.

"Fuck," she moaned. "That's it. Go on, I can take it. Fill me up."

I leaned forward for a closer look and could see that his length was perhaps only halfway in. He pushed his hips forward, shoving the entirety of his shaft into her and Jo moaned again; this time a sound halfway between pleasure and pain.

"You're so fucking tight," he groaned, repeating what he'd said last night.

Jo repeated the same back to him. "I haven't had a decent sized one in a long time; that's why."

As Frank began to move, sliding out and then back inside her, Jo started to make noises that I'd never heard her make before; a mixture of sounds like it was hurting her but at the same time like she was in ecstasy.

When he began to thrust faster and harder, Jo's moans became whimpers. She had her hands on his large back and I could see her nails digging into him as he gave it to her harder and deeper.

I looked sideways to see if Brad was still watching and regretted my timing because right then, he came. I saw a stream of cum jet from the tip of his dick before he hastily covered it with his hand, catching the rest of his sperm before retreating back out of sight.

I chuckled to myself. The kid had probably never experienced anything like this before. Neither had I when I came to think about it.

My dick was throbbing as I watched Frank begin to relentlessly give it to Jo. They were kissing - again wrenching my heart momentarily with jealousy - but then he stopped, lifting himself up onto his arms so he had better leverage to fuck her.

Jo orgasmed without warning, her feet both pointing up at the ceiling suddenly and the muscles in her legs spasming. "Oh my fucking god," she screamed, arching her back and then letting out what I could only describe as an animalistic howl.

"I'm close too," Frank said, gasping for breath. Once Jo had stopped shaking from her massive orgasm, he flipped her onto her front and then lifted her ass up by the hips so he could take her from behind.

Moments later, he was inside her, pulling her head back by her dark, curly hair while he expertly pounded her relentlessly from behind. I watched, marvelling at how strong he was. The sound of his groin thudding against hers was so loud, I knew Brad would probably be able to hear it in his bedroom or wherever he was recovering from shooting his load.

“Are you watching, Simon?” he said, looking over his shoulder at me. “I’m going to cum inside your wife. I’m going to cum right into her fucking womb.”

I blinked, not expecting him to talk to me in that way but before I had the chance to object, Jo looked over her shoulder. But she didn’t look at me. I might as well have not been there.

“You’re going so deep,” she moaned, “Cum inside me, Frank. Please. I want your cum in me.”

That seemed to tip Frank over the edge. He roared something completely unintelligible, then thrust his hips forward with the jerking motion that indicated he was cumming. He pulled out once more, twice more, banging himself into her hard, then slowly withdrew and flopped down onto the bed, a long string of sperm momentarily connecting the tip of his dick with Jo’s gaping pussy hole.

Jo collapsed forward onto her front too and they both lay there for a moment, gasping for breath. Then Jo pushed herself up onto her elbows, sliding her body over Frank’s and kissing him sensuously on the mouth.

“You’re an old bastard now,” she said, finally breaking off the kiss. “But my god, you know how to fuck a woman, don’t you?”

Frank grinned and nodded, then lifted his head to look over at me.

“How’s your cock holding up?” he asked and for some reason, my penis chose that moment, of all moments, to cum.

“Oh my god,” Frank chuckled, raising himself up and pointing. “Simon just came. I saw it.”

Jo sat up and turned around to look at me. I just sat there, frozen, my cock twitching as it pulsed out several small spurts of cum onto my thigh and the seat of the chair between my legs. “Oh dear,” she giggled. “I’m guessing that means you enjoyed that too?”

I felt numb. My arousal diminished now that I’d cum, I felt nothing but embarrassment. They were right. I *had* enjoyed it - which was just plain wrong. “I’m going to get cleaned up,” I said, my cheeks burning up for some reason.

I got up and walked to the bathroom, pausing for a moment when I saw Brad rushing back to his bedroom. He'd probably seen me cum too but I didn't care anymore. Things couldn't get any worse than they were right at that moment.

I washed the cum off my leg in the sink, then returned to the bedroom to find the light off and Jo in Frank's arms, the pair of them already asleep by the looks of it.

I climbed into bed alongside them and tried to sleep, my mind trying to make sense of everything and failing.

Only one more night after tonight, I told myself.

One more night.

Chapter 21

I slept soundly, only being woken by the alarm clock going off. I turned my head to see Jo, still asleep in Frank's huge arms. I wondered if they'd done anything during the night. If they had, I'd slept right through it.

They'd fucked. I'd let them do it. I'd sat and watched as Frank had screwed Jo in such a way that I doubted she'd ever want to sleep with me ever again.

Stupid, I chastised myself. *You're fucking stupid.*

I swung my legs out of bed, the feeling of the steel cage still imprisoning my penis reminding me of its presence. Now that I'd let them have sex, they'd take this off, right? That had been the deal. No sex for Frank meant no sex for me either.

I wrapped a dressing gown around myself and leaving the snoring Frank and Jo, I made my way to the kitchen for a strong coffee to bring me around.

Brad was already there, sitting at the table, his phone in his hands.

"Good morning," he said, looking up from the screen with a worried expression. "I'm sorry about last night. Curiosity got the better of me and once I started watching..."

"It's fine," I said, cutting off his apology with a wave of my hand. "We'd all had a bit too much to drink perhaps and crazy shit happened. Whatever. You can make it up to me by making me a coffee if you like?"

"Sure," the young man got up as I sat at the table, then came back with a steaming hot mug for me, which I gratefully took a sip from. "I'd appreciate it if you'd keep it to yourself about me watching last night."

"Okay," I shrugged, then tried a joke, seeing as he seemed so worried. "Hey, with you being a virgin, maybe it was a good thing. Maybe you learned a thing or two?"

I flashed a smile at him but it didn't seem to help. He sat back at the table, worrying over his phone again. Whatever it was that was bothering him, I was probably best off out of it.

I sat quietly, drinking my coffee while Brad texted whoever it was that was upsetting him until Jo eventually appeared, also wrapped in just a dressing gown.

“Good morning,” she said with a wry grin. “How do you feel today?”

“I’m fine,” I lied. I wasn’t fine. My head felt completely fucked up. *One more night*, I told myself.

“Last night was crazy, wasn’t it?” Jo said, pouring herself a coffee and sitting next to me. Then she lowered her voice. “My pussy is a bit sore this morning. The sex with Frank was incredible.”

“I’m going in the shower,” Brad suddenly announced and seemingly not wanting to hear any more of the conversation, he got up and rushed out of the kitchen.

“What’s up with him?” Jo asked, frowning at the door after him.

“I don’t know,” I shrugged. “He was texting someone on his phone I think. I hope it’s not bad news about Frank’s job for tonight.”

I hadn’t thought about that. I didn’t want anything to go wrong. I wanted Frank and Brad to do the job, then get the hell out of here so I could work on restoring my relationship with Jo back to some kind of normality.

“Me too,” nodded Jo. “Frank’s awake, by the way. I was just talking to him before he went in the shower. He’s keen on us having this little final night party tonight so I said I’d write some signs explaining that the pub is closed for one day for maintenance. We can manage that, can’t we? He only wants to invite Charlie, Bill and the others. He’s even said he’ll put some money in the till to make up for our losses.”

“Sure,” I nodded. “Whatever.”

“Are you okay?” Jo asked, putting her hand on my arm. “You seem... off. What’s wrong?”

“I don’t know.” I exhaled loudly, trying to let go of the tension that I felt building in me.

“Yes, you do.” Jo touched my face, turning me to face her. Her blue eyes gazed into mine. God, she was beautiful. I loved this woman so much. Even though she was enjoying having sex with her ex-husband, I still loved her. “Talk to me,” she said softly.

“Seeing you with Frank last night,” I said, not sure how to phrase what I felt, not sure even exactly *what* I felt. I was experiencing a whirlwind of different emotions: love, lust, anger, betrayal, humiliation, jealousy, even

fear - the fear of losing Jo to Frank who was obviously a far better lover than I could ever be.

“Go on,” prompted Jo, her eyes full of concern.

“My head feels all mixed up,” I said, looking down into my cup and watching a small speck of undissolved coffee swirl around on the surface until it disappeared. “I wish I was as *incredible* in bed as what Frank is.”

“Oh, no,” Jo said, her tone full of sudden understanding. “Simon, I love having sex with you. Don’t be jealous. Frank’s equipped for sex, isn’t he? He’s so big, physically as well as his dick. You’re not like that but when we make love, it’s different. You make me feel loved and that’s important too. Please, don’t feel bad. You’ll make me feel bad.”

“I can’t help it,” I replied. Her words made me feel better. Not totally, but a little.

“Okay.” Jo took my hand and squeezed it. “If you’re worried that I’m going to leave you for Frank, get that idea out of your head. Frank’s a big idiot who’s going to end up back in jail one day soon. I don’t want to be with someone like that. I want to be with you. I’m not going anywhere, okay? I love you. I *really* love you.”

I didn’t say anything. I looked up into her eyes and she smiled. “He’s going away tomorrow,” she said quietly. “I won’t lie. The sex last night was fantastic. I haven’t cum like that in years. I know that’s probably not what you want to hear, but I’m being honest. I’ll probably want to do it again with him tonight. One last fuck. But once he’s gone, I’ll be happy. It’ll be just you and me again. I promise.”

“But don’t you want someone that fucks like Frank does?” I asked. “I’ve never seen you fuck like that; orgasm like that. I’ve never heard you make those sorts of noises or lose yourself so totally in sex before. Won’t you miss that, once he’s gone? Will you really be happy just settling for me and my little cock?”

Jo just stared at me, licking her lips, obviously not knowing quite how to respond to that.

“Good morning, you pair of sexual deviants.” Frank swept into the kitchen fully dressed and looking fresh, like he’d had a shave or something to smarten himself up somehow. “How are you today? How’s your pussy feeling, Jo?”

“Let’s put it this way,” my wife smiled at him but kept her blue eyes on my face. “I *know* I had sex last night.”

Frank chuckled at that and nodded. "It was something else, wasn't it? I've waited fifteen years for that fuck and it was totally worth the wait. After the party tonight, we'll do it again, yeah? It'll be even better this time, now I've got those initial first-fuck-nerves out of the way."

"You weren't nervous," Jo scoffed. "Give over."

"I was," Frank insisted. "It's been so long. I wanted to impress you and because it's been such a long time, I was scared I'd cum too soon or something."

"Well, you didn't," Jo replied as Frank walked up behind her, reached around and cupped her breasts in his hands, helping himself to a slow squeeze through the thin t-shirt she was wearing.

"So, yes," he continued, continuing to play with her tits until she reached down and prised his hands away. "I've got some plans for what we can do in bed tonight but I'll save it for a surprise. It means I have to go out to fetch a few things, but I'll be back in time for our little party."

"A few things?" I asked, glancing at Jo to see if she had any idea what Frank meant but she seemed as interested in the answer as I was.

"It's a surprise," the big man's lined face creasing up and he grinned broadly. "Don't worry. You'll enjoy it."

I didn't like surprises, especially when they originated from a man like Frank but Jo didn't seem too worried, which could only be a good thing.

"And what time are we holding this little party?" Jo asked as she got up and started making breakfast.

"I've got a few things to sort today but I should be done around seven. I'll bring everyone. Oh and don't go to any trouble," Frank walked over to her, kissing her on the cheek. "I'll arrange everything and pay for the drinks, plus as promised, I'll put some money in the till to cover your losses."

Jo turned to face him as the bacon in the frying pan in front of her began to sizzle and pop. "Promise me that everyone will behave themselves," she poked him in the chest with a stiff finger. "Simon and I have got a reputation to uphold and a business to run after you've gone."

"I promise," Frank grinned, leaning in and stealing another kiss, this time on the lips. "Right now, Brad and I have a few matters of business to attend to. We'll see you at seven with the gang."

"You don't want to stay for breakfast?" Jo asked, pointing at the frying pan.

“Brad said he wanted to eat out for some reason,” Frank shrugged. “Which suits us because we’ve got a few places to get around.”

The dour young man reappeared then, his dark hair still wet from the shower. “Let’s go,” he said, tugging at Frank’s arm. Whatever had gotten into him had really unsettled him. I hoped it wasn’t anything we should be worried about.

“See you later,” Jo said, then turned to me with a smile and a plateful of food. “I guess that means more breakfast for me and you.”

We ate and talked some more while setting the bar up for the day ahead and as the day progressed, discussing what we thought Frank might have in store for later.

“You don’t have anything to worry about,” Jo told me for the umpteenth time that day but this time she extrapolated a little. “Frank used to be into some kinky stuff when we were younger but even if it is something like that, it won’t be anything to be concerned about.”

I remembered Kathryn saying something last night about Jo being *the kinky one* when they were younger. “What do you mean by kinky?” I asked. “You mean the threesome and foursome that you did?”

“It was more than that,” Jo said. We’d decided to open for a couple of hours in the afternoon just to keep the regular daytime customers happy and she looked around, making sure that no one was in earshot where we were serving at the bar. “We tried a few things, as couples do.”

“What sort of things?” I asked.

“You know...” Jo shrugged, looking like she’d wished she’d not said anything now. “You must have noticed last night that he likes it rough.”

“That’s not really kinky,” I pointed out. “It’s just hard sex. He’s a big, strong guy so he’s going to be into the physical stuff.”

“No, he used to be into the *real* rough sex,” Jo said vaguely, her eyes avoiding mine and finding a customer at the bar who wanted serving.

“Give me an example,” I said once the customer had walked away with his beer in hand.

Jo sighed, realising I wasn’t going to drop the subject. “Okay. Sometimes, for instance, he liked to tie me up and do me really hard. Not like last night, I mean *really* hard.”

“He liked to tie you up?” I asked, surprised by that. I didn’t have Jo down as a woman who used to be into that sort of thing.

“So I couldn’t move,” Jo explained. “Then he’d...” Again, she made sure no one was listening. “Throat fuck me. Fist me. Hard anal. Okay? Is that enough information for you?”

I was stunned. My mouth opened and closed but nothing came out until I finally managed to croak out a question. “You don’t think he wants to do something like that tonight, do you?”

“I wouldn’t mind if he did,” Jo replied with a wink and a smile before I had to serve another customer. When he’d gone, I turned to my wife who was still grinning. “It was fun at the time, but don’t worry, I’m sure that isn’t what he’s got in mind. He has too much respect for me these days to try anything like that.”

“So what else could it be?”

Jo shrugged. “I don’t know. Maybe he thinks he’s going to get me into another group fuck. He’s sadly mistaken though if that’s what it is.”

“You never told me about that,” I said. “What exactly happened in the threesome and foursome you did?”

“We did it more than once,” Jo said, opening up for once. “Frank liked sharing me with Danny and to be honest, I quite enjoyed it too. Danny was a good-looking guy with a great body.”

“Really?” I said, scarcely able to believe what I was hearing.

“Big dick too,” Jo nodded. “Similar size to Frank. So you can imagine, I was in heaven when they were both in me. Plus, being the centre of attention of *two* men is a real ego boost for a young woman.”

“Wow,” I shook my head, suddenly imagining the scene: my wife sandwiched between two well-endowed guys. I felt my dick throb in the cage, which Frank had neglected to remove before he went out earlier, and tried to push the thought from my mind before I got too turned on. “What about the foursomes? Did you do anything with Sharon?”

“Like girl on girl stuff?” Jo smiled but shook her head. “No. We’d just swap partners. Frank would go with Sharon and I’d go with Danny. The boys both loved it and so did I, but Sharon didn’t enjoy it so much. She only did it because she was scared of what Danny and Frank would do if she refused. I felt bad afterwards.”

“That’s not good,” I agreed.

“Plus, Sharon and I fell out over it,” Jo went on. “She didn’t know about the threesome until we did the foursome. She always saw it that I’d

somehow made Danny cheat on her. We made up, but it was never the same. That's a bit of a regret of mine."

Jo seemed to go a little bit downbeat after that, so I didn't push the subject any further, despite my curiosity still not being completely satisfied.

Shortly afterwards, we closed the pub, explaining to the customers that we had some maintenance work to do but that we'd be back open tomorrow morning. Once the bar was shut, we sat down and waited for Frank and his friends to turn up. What would tonight hold? I was nervous but Jo's constant reassurance helped.

A short time later, there came a knock on the door and I opened it.

"Hi Simon," said Bill, walking into the pub with his usual swagger. Frank, Brad, Alfie, Beth, Mack and Charlie all followed him inside. I locked the door behind them and turned to see them already heading over to the bar for drinks.

"What will it be?" asked Jo from the other side of the counter.

"Your best bottle of Champagne to start off with," said Frank. "Put some music on. Let's get this fucking party started."

Chapter 22

“Here you go,” Frank said, passing me a roll of twenty-pound notes.

“No way,” I said, trying to hand it back to him but he refused to take it. “That’s too much.”

“It’s only two grand,” the huge man shrugged. “It should cover the cost of the drinks tonight and it’s the least I can do, seeing as you’ve put me and Brad up for the last however many nights.”

“Really, Frank, I can’t accept it.”

“Take it,” he said in a firm voice and when I didn’t object again, he grinned at me and walked back over to his friends. Kathryn had joined us, sitting at one table with Jo, Frank, Charlie and Brad while Bill, Alfie, Beth and Mack had pulled a nearby table over so that they could all sit together. I’d put the jukebox on free play and the atmosphere was comfortable at the moment. They were already on their third or fourth drink, the initial bottle of Champagne soon being emptied and discarded and I was worried what they’d all be like later when they were drunker than they currently were.

Jo had dressed up for the occasion and looked stunning. She was wearing a blood-red dress which suited her pale complexion and her long, dark, curly hair. Her makeup was perfect too: smoky eyes, long black lashes and scarlet lipstick.

Most of the men were wearing simple shirts and trousers or jeans. None of them had dressed up like the girls. As well as Jo looking gorgeous, Kathryn had styled her hair into golden ringlets which dripped down her back and was wearing a summery green dress that was totally inappropriate for the cold winter season. Alfie’s young girlfriend, Beth, looked nice too. Her electric-blue hair was fastened up in a high ponytail, showing off her graceful neck and the deep v-neck of her tight white top showed off a surprisingly sizable cleavage for such a skinny girl.

I stayed out of the way as much as I could, letting Jo socialise, while I stayed on the fringes and played the role of host and barman. The evening

went surprisingly well - for the first couple of hours, at least. Until, at some point, I wasn't sure exactly when it started, things got a bit wilder.

I took another round of drinks over as requested and noticed white dust on the table. To my horror, I watched Bill tip some white powder out of a little plastic bag onto the table and make it into a line with his credit card.

"You can't do that here," I said, panicking slightly.

"Stop worrying," Frank reassured me. He was sitting with Jo on one side of him and Brad on the other with Kath and Charlie opposite them. As I looked around the group, I could see that Brad and Kathryn, like all of Bill's group, had snorted a line or two already. Their faces were flushed and their eyes were glazed and dark. Thankfully, Jo, Frank and Charlie seemed to not have touched any.

"This is risky, Frank," I said. "I never agreed to any of this."

"It's a private party," Jo reminded me. "The doors are locked. Let them have their fun, it's how they enjoy themselves. Frank and Charlie are staying sober and have said they won't let anyone get out of line."

I shook my head, not happy about the situation. "Fine, but on your head be it if anything goes wrong."

"It won't," Jo smiled at me, then to my surprise, she bent down and snorted the next line that Bill drew up for them.

"Jo, this isn't you," I bent and whispered in my wife's ear. "What are you doing?"

"I'm letting my hair down a little," she giggled, her pupils dilating as she looked at me. "Don't worry. It's just one little line."

I wasn't into drugs. I looked at her in disgust, then collected the empty glasses from the table and walked away in disgust. No wonder Frank had given me so much money; it was to keep me quiet. The sooner Frank, Bandit Bill and their cronies were gone, the better. Good riddance to them.

A little later, I gave in to their insistence that I relax and joined them for a drink. I refused to join them in putting anything up my nose, but I had a couple of drinks but realised that this particular group of people's definition of the word *relax* was different from mine. They were hyped up; excited; and as the night wore on, increasingly horny.

The three women were dancing with the two youngest boys, Alfie and Brad, leaving me with Charlie, Frank, Mack and Bill at the table. We'd been supping whiskies; Frank and I trying to educate the other men on the subtleties of Scotch, but soon the talk turned to sex.

“I’d love to fuck Beth,” Frank said, watching the women dance. They were far away enough not to hear and I was sure the music would drown our voices out even if they were closer.

“She’s got a nice body,” Charlie agreed, lowering his drink to stare too. The so-called ‘madman’ was the quietest of the group, but not when it came to women, it seemed.

“I’ve been close so many times,” Bill lamented. “Every time I’ve got her alone, she’s changed her mind at the last minute. I’ve had her naked. Fingered her but never got so much as a blow job.”

“That’s how she’s got so much influence over you,” Mack pointed out. “She flirts then keeps you at arm’s length, always thinking you’ve got a chance, when really you haven’t. I keep telling you this.”

“I know, I know,” Bill replied. “You’re right. There aren’t many women that I want to fuck and haven’t and it pisses me off.”

“At least you can cross Joanne off that list. You’d been after her for years,” Charlie consoled him, sipping his whisky then glanced over at me. “No disrespect meant, Simon.”

“None taken,” I replied, trying to keep everyone at ease, even though the comment had annoyed me slightly.

“Frank tells me he finally fucked her last night,” Bill stated, eyeing me interestedly. “Said she was every bit as good as she’d hoped - *and*,” he added, “he said that you watched. Didn’t have you down as *that type* of guy.”

“I don’t think I could stand watching another man fuck *my* woman,” the tough-looking Mack said while frowning at me. “I certainly wouldn’t get off on it, like Frank says you do. But hey, I guess we’re all different.”

“The world would be boring if we were all the same,” Charlie said quietly, with a nod and a wink that I took as reassuring for some reason.

“I wish I’d had more time to enjoy her,” Bill leaned back with a sigh, his eyes on Jo now as she danced to the music pumping out of the jukebox speakers. “I don’t know much she told you, Simon, but it was just a quick bang. I pulled her pants down and screwed her over the couch.”

“She sucked your dick good though,” Mack reminded him. “You said she nearly made you cum. She only did it for about ten seconds.”

He laughed and they all joined in, even the quiet Charlie allowed himself a chuckle.

“It wasn’t ten seconds, cheeky bastard,” Bill pointed a finger at him in warning, then looked around the table. “He made that up. She did suck it good though.”

“You and Frank are both lucky fuckers,” Mack rued, also now staring at my wife across the room. “I’d love to bed her. I’ve got the dick for it too, unlike our Bill here.”

“I can’t help what I was born with,” Bill replied to his friend, shrugging his shoulders. “It might not be the biggest, but it’s seen a lot of action, unlike yours.”

“I’ve had my fair share of pussy,” Mack defended himself, grinning at what I realised was friendly banter rather than actual genuine competition between the two. “I’m just more choosy.”

“Brad watched us fuck last night,” Frank piped up, catching me off-guard. “He’s had less pussy than even you, Mack. He told me the other day that he’s a virgin, poor kid.”

“I’ve had plenty of pussy, I just said-” Mack said, but Frank laughed and carried on.

“I saw him hanging about in the doorway,” the big man said, turning to me. “I don’t think he knew I could see him. Didn’t you notice him?”

“Yeah, but I didn’t say anything,” I replied honestly. “He was wanking off and I didn’t want to embarrass him.”

“Anyway, I’ve got Kathryn working on the virgin thing,” Frank pointed with his whisky glass. “I asked her if she’d mind showing him a thing or two tonight and she said she’d try. Should be fun to watch develop.”

I looked over my shoulder to see Kathryn dancing with Brad. I hadn’t noticed it before now, but she definitely only had eyes for the youngster. He seemed happy enough to dance with her more than the others and didn’t move away every time she got close; sometimes grinding her curvy ass into him suggestively.

“I can’t believe you three have all fucked her,” Mack shook his head. “She’s a big girl. Bill, I can understand - he’ll fuck *anything* - but I had Frank and Charlie down as men with taste.”

“Fat girls are fun,” Charlie replied dismissively. “Don’t knock it until you’ve tried it. She’s got a lovely pair of wobbly tits.”

“You’ve slept with Kathryn?” I asked, directing the question at both Bill and him.

Charlie just nodded without elaborating on when or where but Bill was happy to share. "The day after I fucked Jo," Bill answered casually. "Before we came to the party. Joanne told her where the flat was and she couldn't help but come over to see me. She *does* have an okay pair of tits and a nice shaved pussy."

"Not as nice as Joanne's though," Frank murmured, as though thinking out loud while watching her still. "Joanne's hairy down there but I don't mind."

"I noticed," Mack nodded. "I don't mind some pubes though."

"So are you fucking her again later?" Bill asked.

"Of course," Frank said as though her husband wasn't sitting next to him and a part of the conversation until he looked at me sideways. "Simon, are you still wearing your cage?"

"Oh, yeah," Bill smirked at me. "Are you?"

I ignored the bearded asshole. "You know I am, Frank. You've still got the key."

"Yes, I have," Frank grinned at everyone sitting at the table with me. Why was he suddenly being a dick to me? He must be showing off - maintaining his position as top dog.

"Hey, check out Alfie and Beth," Mack said, changing the subject and pointing across the room.

They'd all been so focused on watching Jo dance that they hadn't been paying attention to the others. Brad and Kathryn were dancing close now but it was the ginger-haired Alfie and his attractive young girlfriend who had caught Mack's eye.

They'd drifted away from the other three and were kissing - not just *kissing*, but kissing passionately. They were facing each other, their bodies pressed tight. Alfie's hands were on his girlfriend's ass, pulling her into him.

"Go on then," Mack shouted over encouragingly but they didn't hear him, nor did they hear Frank wolf-whistle. Alfie walked forward, easing Beth backwards until her back found the bar. Now his hands were grabbing at her breasts, cupping and squeezing them through her white top. Only when he started kissing her neck did either of them realise we were watching, Beth's eyes noticing us over his shoulder.

She said something to Alfie and he turned and looked but knowing that we were staring at them did nothing to stop him. He went back to kissing

her and Beth responded, also ignoring us even as Alfie worked his hand under her top, lifting it as he slid it up to reveal a lacy white bra. He pushed his hand inside the bra as they made out, but before we could see any more, he turned again and grinned at us, then took his girlfriend's hand and led her across the bar and through the door into the back.

"Woah," I said, half-standing up to stop them but Frank stopped me.

"Let them go," he said. "They won't steal anything, don't worry. They'll just find a bed and fuck."

"I think Brad and Kath should do the same," Jo said in my ear, startling me for a moment. I hadn't seen her approach. I looked to where she was pointing and saw the curvy blonde and young Brad locked in a similar embrace to what Alfie and Beth had been a few minutes before. Brad wasn't quite as bold with his hands as Alfie was with his girlfriend, but Kathryn had one of hers down Brad's trousers. Her arm was moving as they kissed.

"Get a room," shouted Frank as he noticed too but it did nothing to deter Kathryn. She ceased kissing him and dropped down onto her knees, pulling his jeans and underwear down at the same time. Brad's dick was already hard, bigger than mine but nowhere near Frank's size and Kathryn immediately enveloped it with her mouth, causing Brad's eyes to widen in disbelief at what was happening.

"This is fantastic," Frank chortled, slapping his knees with his hands. Brad saw us watching and grinned like he was the luckiest kid in the world. We watched as she sucked his dick, Brad even pushing her blonde hair out of the way so we could see better.

A few minutes later, Kathryn stopped and stood up. Brad looked disappointed at first until he realised what was about to happen next. Kathryn gathered up the hem of her green dress, lifting it around her waist and slipped down her white panties. Then she clambered up onto the nearest table, parted her legs and beckoned him over.

Brad covered the few feet between them in one, eager stride - pausing for a moment to look at her curvy pussy - then pointed his dick at her slit and shoved it in.

"Go on, boy!" whooped Frank, clapping his hands on his thighs again. "Fuck her hard!"

Brad had his hands on Kathryn's hips, slamming his dick into her slowly but forcefully, his eyes glued onto their meshed groins, watching his

penis go in and out. Kathryn was gazing at the young man, clearly enjoying how much in thrall of her he was. She reached up and pulled her breasts out of the neck of her dress and Brad's eyes locked onto them as they bounced up and down in time to his thrusts.

"Now this is what I call a party," Bill rubbed his veiny hands together in glee. "I'm going to go and see what Alfie and Beth are doing. I want to see if I can catch them at it."

As he got up and strode towards the back rooms, Brad let out a strangled cry and we saw a huge, long stream of cum shoot out of the tip of his dick as he yanked it out of Kathryn's dripping-wet pussy. Some of it landed on her bald mound; a second jet landed higher, decorating the green material of her dress at her waist, almost making it to her tits.

"That's kind of made me horny," I heard Jo say. I turned, smiling until I realised she was saying it to Frank and not me. "Let's go to bed and fuck."

Frank didn't answer. He just grabbed my wife's hand and they rushed away from me, towards the back room door, making Jo giggle as she had to run to keep up with him.

As they disappeared through the door, I turned to see Brad putting his dick away while Kathryn pulled down her dress before standing up to kiss him yet again.

"I don't know about you," Mack said with a shrug. "But I'm not going to miss out on this."

Then he turned away and went through into the back, leaving me with just Charlie.

"I'm going to head home," the handsome gangster said quietly. I turned to him, pausing while I gathered myself until he spoke again. "Can you let me out, Simon? This isn't my thing. I'd rather just go home."

"Sure," I replied, shaking myself out of my stunned stupor. I walked over to the bar, looking for the keys but couldn't seem to find them. I'd thought I'd left them on the work surface next to the glass cleaner. I didn't have time to look for them now. Things had escalated quickly and I had no idea what was going on upstairs, so I got the spare set from the safe and headed back to Charlie as quick as I could.

When I opened the door for him, the black car was waiting outside again, the same hooded figure at the wheel.

"Good luck for tomorrow," I said as Charlie left.

"You too," he replied enigmatically before getting in the car.

I watched the car drive away then went inside and locked the door. I'd taken too long and was anxious as to what I was missing upstairs. I rushed through into the back and then bounded upstairs, not knowing what I was going to come across or what was going to happen next

If someone had told me; I'd never have believed them.

Chapter 23

As soon as I reached the landing atop the stairs, I saw Mack standing at the doorway to the spare bedroom that Frank had been occupying before spending the past two nights in our bed. All three bedroom doors were open and I was aware of sex noises but wasn't sure where they coming from.

I swayed a little, realising that the whiskies and beer I'd consumed were affecting me now. The others had drunk way more than me, so they must be feeling it even more than I was. I was worried about Jo suddenly. Where was she?

"Check the body out on Beth," Mack said quietly as I reached the open doorway he was looking through. It was dark in the bedroom but the landing light above us was on and illuminated the two figures on the bed enough for us to see. Both Alfie and Beth were naked, the pretty blue-haired riding her boyfriend who was stretched out on the bed, his hands on her hips, holding her in place on his cock. Her medium-sized breasts were almost perfectly round and pert, standing out in front of her with the firmness of youth. Her nipples were pale, small and erect and her pussy was completely shaved between her legs. As she rode up and down on Alfie's smallish but hard erection, I felt my own cock hardening, reminding me of the metal cage that still imprisoned it. I'd been wearing it all day and had grown that accustomed to it now, that I'd forgotten it was even there.

Beth looked across at us both but having two men watch her fuck didn't seem to bother her. She smiled and then cupped her tits, pushing them together, seemingly enjoying giving us a show.

"This is getting out of hand," I said softly, looking away because it suddenly felt wrong to be watching this young couple making love.

"Do you want some of this, Beth?" I heard Mack say and I glanced downwards to see that he had his jeans unbuttoned and his dick in his hand. He was well-endowed, long and thick if not quite as big as Frank.

"Keep dreaming," Beth replied with a giggle.

“You and Bill can try all you like,” Alfie laughed. “You think I don’t know about you two trying it on but she’s mine, aren’t you, babe?”

Beth nodded, giggling loudly again and then as they changed positions; Beth moving on to her back and opening her thighs wide so that Alfie could fuck her missionary, I turned away, walking over to Brad’s bedroom because I’d heard noises coming from there.

Kathryn and Brad were under the bedsheets but it was obvious they were fucking again. I could see the shape of Kathryn’s legs spread out to either side and the shape moving up and down in between them was obviously Brad’s backside as he fucked her. *Ah, the vigour of youth*, I thought to myself realising that Brad had cum only a half-hour before and now he was already at it again. These days, after I ejaculated, I would expect to wait a few hours before my dick would be capable of round two.

Where was Jo? I walked towards the living room and upstairs kitchen but both were empty and in darkness. *Shit*. I heard more sounds of sex, this time coming from our bedroom. I’d left them alone too long, distracted by Beth’s incredible body and Brad’s impressive recovery time. I strode towards the door in front of me, noticing that it was the only one closed. The lights were on, however, I could see the thin line between the bottom of the door and the carpet, so perhaps they *weren’t* having sex, despite the noises I thought I’d just heard.

I pushed the door open and was almost knocked over by Frank as he bumped into me on his way out. The big man was wrapping my dressing gown around himself - or trying to because it was way too small - and had some car keys in his hand.

“Whoops,” he apologised as he barged into me. “Sorry, Simon. I’m just going to the car to get a few things I bought earlier for tonight. I’ll be back in a moment.”

Before I could ask any questions as to what things he was talking about, he was gone, leaving me at the doorway, shocked at the sight before me.

Jo was naked on the bed, laid on her back with her legs open, breathing heavily. She and Frank had clearly already started having sex. That much wasn’t a surprise. What *was* a surprise was the presence of Bill, also naked, lying next to her. His dick was short, compared to Frank’s and Mack’s especially, but he was slightly longer and definitely thicker than me.

“I was beginning to wonder where you were,” the scrawny bearded man said, with a smirk. “Why don’t you get your clothes off and join in with us?”

“Jo,” I called over to my wife, who lifted her head, only just realising I was here. “What the fuck are you doing?”

“What’s going on here then?” laughed Mack, sliding past me into the bedroom. “Fucking hell, Jo. I can see why everyone was going on about your titties. Woo hoo!”

Her tits did look good. I was shocked that she wasn’t reacting somehow to all these men seeing her totally naked with the lights on. She looked from me to Mack, smiling at his comment but making no move to cover her breasts or the hairy bush between her thighs. She didn’t even close her legs. She just lay there, her gaze going between Mack and I. Just as she was about to say something, Frank reappeared, pushing me out of the way and dropping a carrier bag onto the floor.

“Here we go,” he said, reaching inside and pulling one box out of several in the bag, which he opened. “This is where it gets serious.”

“What’s that?” I asked, feeling suddenly nervous. Jo sat up on the bed, watching. Did she know what was going on?

“Simon, just relax,” the big man stood right in front of me, his sheer size looming over me as he unbuckled what looked like a pair of leather cuffs. “You might not like this idea, but it’s happening whether or not you want it to.”

“Frank, what the fuck is going on?” I asked, backing away until the backs of my knees hit the edge of the chair and I almost fell into it.

“Chill,” Jo’s ex-husband smiled coldly. “You’ll enjoy this, I promise. Take your clothes off.”

“What?” I laughed nervously. “I’m not taking my clothes off in front of Mack and Bill.”

“Do it,” Frank said, his voice dropping. “I want to show Bill and Mack your little dick, all locked up.”

“No,” I repeated myself. “Why would I want to do that?”

“Just do it,” Jo said, standing up and walking over to me. I saw Mack eyeing her body as she came over and put a hand on my cheek. “It’s my idea. It’ll really turn me on if you do this. Please, for me?”

“If I do what, exactly?” I asked, aware that my voice was shaking. What did they have planned for me?

“I told you the other night,” Jo replied, unzipping my trousers and pulling them down. “The idea of you being submissive *really* turns me on. I like being submissive too. I want us to try this one thing tonight. Please.”

“What thing?” I asked, still not knowing exactly what she was talking about.

“Frank is going to tie you to the chair so you can’t interfere,” Jo explained, pulling my trousers down and lifting the shirt over my head. “Then he’s going to make you watch as him and Bill give me the best fucking I’ve ever had.”

“You and Bill?” I said incredulously. “Since when was this decided? We haven’t talked about this.”

“Shush,” Jo said, then kissed me on the lips as Frank bent down and finished removing my trousers so that was naked.

“That’s the cock cage,” the big man said, tapping it with one hand.

“Fucking hell, Simon,” Mack chuckled. “I think your dick’s actually smaller than little Bill. I didn’t think that was possible.”

“It’s not all about size,” Jo said with a curt look at Bill’s right-hand man after breaking off the long, lingering kiss she’d given me. “It’s about how you use it, and Simon is actually quite good.”

“Not as good as me though,” Frank smiled, pushing me back into the chair at the foot of the bed.

“I’m not comfortable with this,” I tried saying but the big man ignored me, fastening my left wrist to the arm of the chair with one of the leather cuffs. As he did the same with the other hand, Jo returned to the bed as Bill stood up and walked over to the bag that Frank had brought, dipping his hand inside it.

“What else have you brought?” he asked, pulling out another box.

“I’ll show you,” the big man said, walking over, my dressing gown flapping open to reveal his impressive dick swinging around between his legs as he bent down to take out the other box.

“What’s that?” asked Jo, looking at the strappy leather items that the two men pulled from their respective packages.

“These are for you, darling,” Frank replied, joining her on the bed.

“What?” I said at the same time as Jo, but her bald-headed ex-husband ignored us both and grabbed one of Jo’s wrists as Bill joined them on the bed, the other leather straps in his hands.

“Frank,” Jo said, trying to wriggle her arms out of Frank’s grasp. “I know you like this sort of thing, but you don’t need to. Isn’t it enough that you’ve got Simon tied up?”

“Humour me,” Frank said, fastening her wrist securely to the edge of the bed and then doing the same to the other. Bill was doing the same thing to her ankles, despite her kicking her legs to try to resist him.

A minute later, Jo was restrained on the bed, her legs and arms spread-eagled, her body totally at the mercy of the two men to either side of her.

“Consider this a lesson,” Frank turned to look at me. “I’m going to show you how to fuck your wife properly.”

“And you can watch me with two men,” Jo said with a naughty smile in my direction. She’d obviously given up on trying to resist what Bill and Frank were planning to do.

“What about me?” Mack asked. I’d forgotten the rough-looking man was even in the room. He’d been quiet for a while, just watching the proceedings unfold.

“Get your clothes off,” Bill suggested. “See how generous Joanne is feeling.”

I waited for Jo to object but she didn’t. Instead, she looked at Mack, watching him strip off then when Bill knelt in front of her and offered her his dick, she closed her eyes and took it in her mouth.

Frank’s hands were on her tits, squeezing them, then he slid one down over her belly between her legs, shoving two fingers into her. Jo twitched at the sudden invasion between her legs, but her mouth stayed on Bill’s cock, slowly sucking up and down his short shaft.

Mack sat on the edge of the bed, his dick in his hand, stroking it to hardness with one hand while his other slid up Jo’s thigh, feeling her soft skin until he got to her hairy pussy. He stroked her pubes, then his thumb rubbed over her clit while Frank finger-fucked her, making Jo’s hips twitch again.

“Nice,” Mack said, shoving his own fingers inside her once Frank moved his hand, the big man moving to offer Jo’s mouth his cock as Bill took a break.

As Jo began to suck her ex-husband, Bill turned to look at me. “Frank’s already fucked her before you got here but then he stopped because he wanted you to watch. I have to admit, it’s kind of fun doing this to a woman with her husband made to watch.”

“Do you really get off on it?” Mack asked, looking over his shoulder at me while working his fingers inside Jo still.

I looked at him, then Frank and Bill, not knowing quite what to say. I tried to lift my arms, testing the straps but there was no way out. I didn’t want to admit that this was turning me on, the powerlessness, the embarrassment of being naked in front of my wife and three men while having to wear a chastity device.

Mack shrugged at my failure to answer and instead lowered himself down, putting his face against Jo’s pussy and beginning to lick her. This wasn’t what was supposed to happen but I didn’t say anything to stop it because Jo wasn’t saying anything to stop it. Was this what she wanted? It must be because she wasn’t making any attempts to stop anything that was happening.

“I want to fuck her,” Bill said, making Mack move from where was licking her. As he did, I could see how wet she was. Her dark pubes were stuck together, matted with a mixture of saliva and her own juices.

Jo was still sucking Frank’s cock, her head bobbing back and forward along his length. She didn’t even look at Bill as he positioned himself between her thighs, angling his body so I could see his dick pressing against the pink folds as she turned to me.

“Watch, Simon,” he said, taunting me. “I want you to see my cock go inside your wife.”

He didn’t have to tell me. I couldn’t drag my eyes off the head of his dick anyway, as it pushed against her slit then slowly slid inside. I’d seen Frank fuck Jo already. Now I was seeing my wife’s pussy take another penis. I knew that Bill had already fucked her the other day, but now I was actually getting to see it.

“You have no idea how much I wanted to fuck this pussy,” Bill said as he began to ram it into Jo, making her moan around Frank’s cock, not from his size but just from how hard he was thrusting against her.

Mack moved up the bed, rubbing his dick against her face until she released Frank’s and turned her head to suck him. Again, I took a moment to absorb what was happening. She’d only ever met Mack a couple of times and she was now giving him a blow job right in front of me.

“My goodness,” said Kathryn from the doorway, making us all turn around to look at her. She had the bed sheets wrapped around her. Brad’s eyes opened wide as he followed her into the bedroom in just his boxer

shorts. Then Beth, in just her top and panties and Alfie, like Brad in just his shorts.

The bedroom was suddenly full of people, the newcomers all watching Bill fuck Jo on the bed for a moment, then they all seemed to turn to look at me, tied to the chair; naked; my erect cock contained in a steel cage.

“We brought more drinks and stuff,” Alfie grinned at me, then turned his attention to Frank who was just standing next to the bed, watching them all walk closer and holding his hand out for the plastic bag of white powder that Alfie passed to him. Brad had a crate of beer in his hands and he put it down on the floor, his eyes big as he watched Bill begin to fuck Jo again.

“I don’t need this, do I?” Kathryn said, letting the bed sheets fall to the floor, exposing her curvy naked body to everyone in the room as Frank drew a line of the white powder on the bedside cabinet and snorted it.

Then the madness truly began.

Chapter 24

It was the middle of the night. I had no idea what time because the alarm clock had been swept off the bedside table at some point during the orgy that the night had descended into.

My cock was aching in the cock cage. During the past hour or so, I'd watched Bill and Frank repeatedly use Jo's pussy, fucking her hard and rough and making her orgasm too many times to count.

Right now though, Bill was fucking Beth. Alfie had finally relented and was watching his bearded boss pound his blue-bearded young girlfriend. He didn't look too happy about it but earlier, the young ginger-haired man had been unable to resist Kathryn's offer of a fuck while Beth had been downstairs getting more drinks. When she'd returned to find her boyfriend fucking the fat blonde, she'd walked over to Bill and started kissing him.

I'd watched, ignoring Jo and Frank going at it on the bed for a moment, as Bill had stripped off Beth's top, his hands going straight to those firm tits while she wriggled out of her panties. Then just as Alfie pulled out of Kath and shot his cum all over her round belly, Beth had laid down on the floor and Bill hadn't wasted any time in getting between her legs and beginning to pound her before Alfie could even notice what was going on.

Right now, I was about to watch another new cock go inside Jo. Frank and Bill had been enjoying her all night, but she'd also sucked Mack and now she was finally going to get fucked by him. Frank was on the bed next to her but was fucking Kathryn, the big woman on all fours while he hammered into her from behind.

"I've never seen anything like this before," Brad said as I watched Mack settle his weight on top of my wife and slide his impressive dick into her. "I've heard about these kinds of parties, but to actually be involved in one is crazy."

The young man was sitting next to me and was the only other person that had been an observer like me, not joining in any of the madness.

"I never thought I'd be involved in one," I said, the first words I'd said for a while. My throat was dry and my voice came out raspy.

"Your wife is really pretty," Brad said. "Her body is amazing. Would you mind if I did it with her?"

I looked at him in disbelief that I was in a position where someone would ask me such a question.

"Everyone else has," I sighed bitterly.

"Alfie hasn't," Brad pointed out. I looked at the young man still watching his boss fuck his girlfriend.

"Not yet," I shook my head.

"Are you on the pill?" I heard Mack ask Jo, dragging my attention back to the bed.

"Yes," Jo moaned. "Cum inside me."

"He's going to cum inside her," Brad told me, as though I was deaf or something.

"Oh, fuck," Mack groaned, burying his cock deep inside her as he came and then I saw Jo's thighs quiver as yet another orgasm rippled through her.

"Have you cum in her?" Frank asked, pausing from fucking Kath for a moment and wiping sweat from his heavy brow.

"Yeah," Mack said, climbing off of the bed. Jo's pussy lips were pink and swollen and I saw a trickle of white cum seep out, dripping onto the bedsheets as she laid there trying to get her breath back.

"Nice," Frank muttered appreciatively as he leaned sideways to look between her legs. "I'm going to add mine to it."

"Don't stop," Kathryn said over her shoulder as he moved to get between Jo's thighs.

"Sorry," the big man replied. "But I'm close to cumming and I want to give it to my ex-wife here."

"Brad," Kathryn said as Frank got on top of Jo and began doing it to her slowly. "Come over and fuck me again. I need someone to help me cum."

"I want to but I thought I might be able to do it with Jo," the young man said, getting up from where he was sitting next to me and walked over to the bed.

“Come on then, kid,” Frank said as Brad ignored Kathryn and climbed onto the bed next to him. “Stick your cock in her mouth if you want.”

The big man lifted himself up onto his knees, his cock still buried inside my wife as Brad knelt next to her face then I watched in shock as he reached into his shorts and tugged out his penis. Was she really going to do this? Suck a man half her age?

The answer was yes. Jo didn’t even look at me, she just shut her eyes and took Brad in her mouth, making the young man sigh in pleasure. He reached down, fondling her tits as Frank screwed her - faster now - from where he was kneeling between her thighs.

“Here I come,” the huge man said after a few final frenetic thrusts. “Yeah. Fuck, yeah.”

Then he moved away, climbing from the bed and addressing me. “That’s two loads inside your wife, Simon. I’d give it a while before fucking her. Let her tighten up. She won’t be able to feel you after having Mack and me inside her tonight.”

He walked out of the door in the same direction that Mack had after he’d cum, presumably to clean up and I watched Jo suck Brad for a moment before looking over at Bill as he announced he was going to cum too.

“Not inside,” Alfie pleaded but Bill ignored him, wedging his cock deep into young Beth and holding it there until he’d emptied himself inside her.

“What’s wrong with you?” Bill laughed. “She’s on the pill, isn’t she?”

“Yes, it’s fine,” Beth reassured him. “I’m on birth control. If you didn’t want me to do this, maybe you should have fucked Kathryn without asking me, Alfie.”

Alfie began to argue back but I zoned out from their brewing mini-domestic and looked at Kathryn, who was laying on the bed next to Jo, playing with her pussy watching her best friend suck Brad.

“Let him fuck you, Jo,” Kathryn said softly to my wife. “I want to watch and I think Simon does too.”

“Can I?” Brad asked.

I felt like pointing out that Jo’s pussy was still dripping with both Frank and Mack’s spunk, to try and dissuade him from doing it but again, my mouth wouldn’t work. Part of me wanted him to. Some deep part of me liked it and wanted my humiliation to be complete.

“Okay,” Jo said, smiling at Kathryn and raising her head so she could see her best friend working her clit with one finger.

I kept my mouth shut as Brad positioned himself between my wife’s thighs. From where I was sat I could see his dick as he clumsily pointed it at her puffy labia and then shoved it in.

Jo was drunk from the alcohol and the white shit that she’d put up her nose tonight. They all were. Otherwise, this would never have happened. Jo would regret it tomorrow and I would have to be there for her when she did.

She didn’t look like she was regretting anything right now, however. She was moaning and thrusting her hips onto Brad as he frantically pumped his cock in and out of her. He wasn’t going to last long, I could tell and I was right.

“I’m cumming,” he practically squealed, his hips losing his rhythm and jerking suddenly as he pulled out of her.

“That’s it,” Jo encouraged him as he wanked his cock furiously, several spurts of sticky white cum spraying over her belly and some dribbling out to land on her hairy mound. “Cum all over me, Brad.”

The young man squeezed out the last few drops onto Jo’s pubes, then shuffled away, pulling his shorts up from where they’d been stretched around his thighs.

“Wow,” he breathed to Jo who was smiling at him. “That was incredible. I don’t know who’s better, Kathryn or you. I can’t believe I’ve had sex with two women in one night.”

For some reason, that was the thing that tipped me over the edge. I don’t know why. I’d seen everything tonight. My wife getting fucked by several different men, four different dicks in her mouth and her pussy. Two men cumming inside her, their spunk still oozing out. But it was the fact that Kath and Jo between them had taken Brad’s virginity that seemed to be the final straw.

“Crap,” I moaned softly, trying to stay quiet so that no one would notice but they all did, turning to look at me as I came really hard. Perhaps it was the long build-up - my cock had been aching for release all night - or perhaps it was the intensity and depravity that had unfolded tonight but whatever it was, I came strongly, a huge white stream of cum flying out of the head of my cock, through the cage and all over the floor in front of me. Another stream and then another as I sat in the chair, bucking my hips uncontrollably until I was done.

“Looks like someone enjoyed himself,” Kathryn said wryly as she watched me cum, her lips turned upwards in an amused smile.

“He loves it,” Frank said, returning to the bedroom, still completely naked. I looked around, once I’d stopped shaking from the intense orgasm. There was only Brad, Kath, Jo, him and me in the room. “The others have gone home now,” he said. “Bill asked me to pass on his thanks for a wonderful night. Alfie and Beth are having a massive argument, so he’s taking them home.”

“Can you let me out of this now?” I asked. “My arms are aching and my back is stiffening up.”

Frank looked at me, frowning in thought. “Kathryn,” he said after a moment. “I want you to go lock up downstairs - the keys are in the door and then take Bradley to bed in the other room. You’re staying the night together. I’m sleeping here tonight and I need to sleep without any distractions, okay?”

Kathryn hesitated, looking at Jo until my wife nodded that it was okay. Then she took Brad by the hand and led him out of the bedroom, closing the door behind her.

“You can take these restraints off me as well,” Jo said to Frank as he walked over.

“No,” he shook his head. “I’ll take the one wrist cuff and one ankle cuff off but you’re staying tied to the bed. In the morning, I need to make sure that you’re not going to try any funny business once I leave in the morning.”

“What?” I objected. “Me too?”

“You can sleep in the chair,” Frank said, unbuckling the two cuffs from Jo that he’d promised to. “Where do you keep your spare blankets?”

“In the drawers,” Jo pointed with her free hand. As Frank opened the drawers and pulled out the spare quilt, she looked at me apologetically. “I’m sorry, Simon. Are you okay?”

“No, I’m not fucking okay,” I said angrily.

Frank froze at the tone in my voice, then very slowly, he turned to face me, a dark look on his face.

“Simon,” he warned. “I’ve had a wonderful night. Don’t spoil it.”

I lifted my back from the chair so he could put a pillow behind me, then he threw the quilt over my legs to keep me warm.

“Now go to sleep,” he commanded, climbing into bed alongside Jo and pulling the sheets over them. Then he reached across and turned off the bedside lamp, plunging the bedroom into darkness.

I couldn't see anything at first. I could hear Jo and Frank whispering but couldn't make out what they were saying and by the time my eyes adjusted to the dark, they'd gone quiet and were laying still beneath the covers. Jo's breathing grew heavier and Frank let out a little snore. They were asleep.

I closed my eyes, resting my head against the back of the chair and let myself rest, trying to sleep, even though my mind was whirling at what had happened tonight and what tomorrow morning would hold.

Chapter 25

I did manage to sleep, despite being woken twice by the sound of Jo and Frank making love and when I woke in the morning, the sunlight streaming in through the crack in the curtains, they were doing it again.

Jo was on her side, the position afforded to her now with Frank behind her, holding her uppermost leg up so that he could drive his cock inside her cleanly. Jo kept turning her head so that they could kiss and the sex was much more intimate in general than it had been last night.

After a while, Jo rolled to her back and Frank got on top, again making love to her rather than fucking her brutally like before. They kissed through the entire thing, their tongues entwining at times as he moved against her slowly but rhythmically, eventually causing her to cry out as she came. I watched until eventually, Frank reached his own climax, holding himself deep inside her as he came. Even then, Jo kept her arms and legs wrapped around him for a few minutes, their kissing continuing, until finally, with a huge sigh, Frank rolled off.

“Good morning,” Jo said, noticing that I was awake for the first time.

Frank lifted his head from the pillow and grinned at me. “Hi, Simon. How did you sleep?”

“Badly,” I said, twisting in the chair, trying to work the knots out of my shoulders and back somehow.

“I’m sorry,” Frank said, sitting up. “But I had to do this. I’ve got a feeling that someone is up to something. I don’t know who - I don’t even have a reason - it’s just an instinct. The obvious people are you two and perhaps Kathryn. Which is why I’m going to leave you here like this, and lock Kathryn in with you.”

“What?” Jo said, looking at Frank in alarm as he stood up and stretched his arms above his head. “You can’t leave us tied up.”

“Once I’ve gone, after an appropriate amount of time,” Frank went on, “I’ve made arrangements for someone to come - with the key - and set you free. It’s just me being careful. I can’t afford for anything to go wrong.”

He got dressed as Jo and I looked at each other. She looked as worried as I felt. This wasn't happening. It just wasn't.

"Frank, I didn't think you'd do this to me and Simon," Jo said, sitting up in bed and trying to reach the sheets which were on the floor. She couldn't, so she closed her legs and covered her breasts with her one free arm. "Just let us go. We're not up to anything, I promise. We don't even know where or what the job is. You've kept it all from us, to protect us, you said."

Frank finished getting dressed, fastening up his shirt and checking himself in the mirror on the wall. "I've got a big day ahead and I can't be too careful." Then he walked over to Jo, looking at her for a moment, before suddenly pulling her arm free of her chest and pushing her to the bed.

"Frank, what are you doing?" I shouted in alarm.

"Nothing," he scowled over his shoulder at me. "Just making sure she can't get out of these cuffs." He reached down and picked up the two spare cuffs which were still dangling from the top and bottom bedposts and reattached them to her wrist and ankle, leaving her spread-eagled on the bed once again.

"Is everything okay?" Kathryn blundered into the room, bedsheets preserving her modesty again. She rubbed at her eyes, clearly, she'd just been woken up by my shouts. Bradley followed her in, looking equally dishevelled.

"Everything is fine," Frank told her. "Kathryn, I'm going now. I could stay a little while longer, but I have my reasons. I have the keys. Both sets. I picked one set up from the bar last night and I took the others out of the door last night. I'm going to be locking you and Brad in with Jo and Simon here when I go."

"Locking us in?" Brad said. "I'm coming with you."

"No, you're not," Frank shook his head. "It's too dangerous. Your job is to watch these three and make sure no one tips off the cops or anything other funny business. I've got a funny feeling that something is going on somewhere. I can smell it."

"I'm not up to anything," Kathryn insisted, just as Jo had.

Frank ignored her, walking to Brad and putting an arm around him. "I'll send Charlie over in a few hours when the job is underway. He'll have the keys for the pub and Simon's cock cage. Do not let them out of the

restraints until Charlie gets here. If you do, Charlie will tell me. Do you understand? Keep an eye on them, kid. That's your job."

"Got it," Brad replied, looking over at me and Jo with a grim but resolute expression. "I'd rather come with you though."

"No," Frank ruffled his hair. "I need someone I trust to keep an eye on things here. And I trust you more than anyone, Brad."

The young man smiled at that. "Okay, Frank."

Then the big man walked over to face me one last time. "You're lucky I don't take Joanne with me. I want to. More than anything, I want to. But I know she's in love with you. Fuck knows why, with your tiny cock but she does. I know you make her happy, so I'm going to let you have her, Simon."

I wanted to tell him to fuck himself, but I daren't. I could sense the tension in Jo's ex-husband. He was nervous about today's job. He was on edge. I wasn't going to be the one to tip him over.

"The reason I'm going now," he said, sitting on the bed next to Jo. "Is because I love you. I never stopped. I need to go before I change my mind and decide to stick around. I think I could win you back if you gave me a chance."

"Just go," Jo said, her blue eyes gazing into his. "Just go, Frank. Don't say any more."

Frank opened his mouth to say something, then changed his mind. He stood up and walked out, leaving the four of us alone in the silence that followed the sound of the pub's front door slamming shut.

"I'm going to go downstairs," Kathryn said, after a moment when Frank didn't return. "Maybe he hasn't locked us in."

"You're going nowhere without me," Brad said, grabbing her arm. Kath tried to wriggle free but Brad held on tight. "Frank gave me a job to do and I'm doing it," he said in a surprisingly hard tone, cold enough to make Kathryn flinch back from him slightly.

"Brad," Jo said in a soft voice. "Let us free. Take these cuffs off me. I promise we won't try anything."

"No," the young man glared at her. "Don't think I'm soft, Jo. I'm not. I've got a job to do and I'm going to do it."

Then he walked out of the bedroom, dragging Kathryn with him. "Let's go see if we're locked in."

"What do we do?" I said to Jo. "What if it goes wrong and Charlie doesn't turn up with the key?"

“I don’t know,” Jo said, yanking on the restraints, trying to get free but failing. I tried pulling my wrists out of mine but they hadn’t loosened all night, despite me constantly pulling against them regularly.

Kathryn came back into the room, followed by Brad. “The door is locked,” he confirmed. “So you’re all stuck with me until Charlie gets here.”

“Please just let them go,” Kathryn pleaded. “I’ll suck your dick.”

“You can fuck me again if you want,” Jo added. “Just let us go. I promise we won’t try anything.”

“You can fuck me too,” Kath offered.

“Yeah, right,” Brad said after a moment, obviously tempted by the proposal from both women. “No. We just wait this out. It’s important. Frank wouldn’t have me watching you if it wasn’t. He seems to think one of you might be a snitch or something.”

“Brad,” Kath said, lowering her squeaky voice, *trying* to sound sexy. She loosened and dropped the bed sheet that was wrapped around her, her plump body naked beneath it. “Look at me.”

“Go and put some clothes on,” the young man said, rubbing a hand through his short dark hair in exasperation. “I’ll come with you, then just stop this. You can wait for an hour or two. It’s not that much to ask. Let’s just do what Frank asked.”

Brad pulled Kathryn out of the bedroom again, leaving Jo and me alone. “Looks like we just have to wait,” I said. “Are you okay?”

“Apart from a sore pussy,” Jo forced out a laugh. “Yes. I’m so sorry about my behaviour last night. I let myself go crazy. I’m sorry. I was drunk and...”

“It’s fine,” I said, more worried about our present situation than her apologies. “We can discuss it once we’re out of this predicament.”

Then I heard a knock on the door.

“Did you hear that?” Jo asked. “Was that...?”

We heard it again.

“Someone’s at the door,” I said. “It can’t be Charlie. Frank said he’d be a couple of hours.”

“He’s only been gone fifteen minutes at the most,” Jo agreed.

The knock came again. More urgent, this time. Brad appeared in the doorway, dressed now, as was Kath. “You two, someone is at the door but it

can't be Charlie. While I'm dealing with it, don't even think about shouting for help."

The knock came once more. "Fuck," he cursed under his breath, then dragged Kath away with him to deal with it.

"We're not expecting anyone, are we?" Jo asked, still wriggling her arms like she could escape, making her naked breasts wobble with the movements.

"I don't think so," I replied, aware of my own nakedness now that there was someone knocking on the door. "I don't even know what time it is. It feels early though, right?"

"It's early morning, definitely," Jo looked at the light coming in through the window.

"It's ten in the morning, give or take five minutes," said a familiar voice from the doorway. We both turned to see Charlie standing there. It was Charlie after all.

"Is everything okay?" Jo asked, concern in her voice now. "Has the job gone okay? Frank said you'd be a couple of hours at least. What's happened?"

"Did something go wrong?" I asked, my heart sinking. If the job had been aborted then it meant Frank might come back. After last night, I wanted him gone. Jo and I had gone through last night so that he'd go.

Charlie stepped into the room but as he did, several other people joined him. One particular person pushed past him and rushed up to me before he told her to stop.

"It's okay, Zena," I said to the dark-skinned girl as she paused halfway across the room.

"I brought her in case I couldn't get into the pub," Charlie explained. "I knew she had an emergency key."

"Didn't Frank give you the keys?" I asked, completely confused as to what was going on.

Charlie turned and looked at one of the other people that were standing behind him. I recognised him as the hooded figure that I'd seen twice before at the wheel of his car. He was wearing an oversized grey hoodie and was carrying a black briefcase. Behind him were Kathryn and Brad and a third person, a glamorous-looking blonde woman who they were both arguing with.

“Sharon?” said Jo, her head turned to the side to look at the newcomers.

Sharon. Wasn't that Brad's mother? Danny's widow?

What the fuck was going on?

Chapter 26

“What did they do to you?” Zena said, taking another step towards me but again Charlie told her to stop.

“I need to make sure everything is okay,” he said, walking to the barmaid and making her step away from us.

“Charlie, what’s going on?” I asked. “Where’s Frank?”

“Zena,” he said to the dark-skinned girl. “You need to go downstairs and wait until we’ve sorted this out, okay? Don’t worry. No harm is going to come to either Frank or Jo.”

Zena looked at me and I nodded. “It’s okay,” I reassured her and after a short hesitation, she left the room, giving me one last look over her shoulder before leaving and closing the door behind her.

“Sharon!” Jo shouted, this time making the blonde woman turn and look at us.

“Oh my god,” she said, walking over until Charlie extended an arm to stop her.

“Let me explain what’s happening,” the gangster said. “Simon, I didn’t go with Frank to the job.”

“He’s been up to something,” Sharon said. “Him and Tommy both.”

“Tommy?” Jo asked. “Tommy’s dead. Can someone please let me out of these cuffs?”

“Not just yet,” Sharon said, stepping forward. “Tommy isn’t dead.”

The hooded figure stepped forward, put his briefcase down and lowered the grey hood to reveal a square face and short pale hair. “Hi, Joanne,” he said. “I always hoped I’d see you again but I never thought it’d be quite like this.”

Both he and Charlie seemed to be enjoying staring at Jo’s nakedness, especially the way she was spread-eagled in front of everyone.

“Fifteen years ago,” Charlie said, sitting on the edge of the bed next to Jo, “Tommy did a deal with the police in return for information after his arrest. He protected you, Joanne, as we all did but also protected me.”

“I know that,” Jo said. “But Frank ordered him dead. How is he still alive? And can someone please just let me free? I’m naked.”

“I noticed,” Charlie smiled, his eyes roaming her body.

“Don’t free her,” Sharon said, her face set. She looked... angry. Why? “Not yet.”

“I’ll finish explaining first,” Charlie nodded. Who was in charge here? Sharon or Charlie? What was going on?

“Let *me* explain,” Tommy interjected. “Charlie stayed in contact with Frank while he was inside. It was Charlie that he sent to kill me, once I got paroled. But he didn’t. He told Frank I was dead but really, he told me to run. He even told me where to hide. So, I did.”

“I can’t believe it,” Jo said, after a moment to digest what she’d just heard.

“Neither could I,” the blonde newcomer said. “When he intercepted me on my way here last night.”

“You were coming here?” Kathryn asked. “Why?”

I looked at the two blonde women standing in the middle of the room. They were both blonde but they couldn’t be more different. Kathryn was short and fat. Sharon was tall and slim. Jo had told me that Sharon was attractive and Charlie had said that Frank had always wanted to fuck her. That was why he let Danny sleep with Jo, so he could get Sharon in bed. I could see why. Her body was like a supermodel’s and she had the face of an actress; perfect features; bright green eyes and full, red lips. Her long blonde hair hung halfway down her back and she was dressed immaculately in designer jeans and a well-fitted black leather jacket.

“I didn’t know Brad was with Frank until you told me on the phone,” Sharon replied. “He told me that he’d gone to London with one of his mates for a stag night. When you told me he was here, I knew Frank was probably getting him involved in some shit or other so I texted him - I tried ringing first but he wouldn’t answer. He replied eventually by text. Told me everything, including where he was. So I came here to stop him.”

I remembered Brad texting someone on his phone yesterday. No wonder he’d looked so troubled. The young man was standing at the back of the room

“I couldn’t let you interrupt last night,” Tommy said. “If you’d walked in last night, you could have fucked everything up for Charlie.”

“Charlie,” Jo said, an odd look on her face. “Where’s Frank?”

“By now, he should be at the police station,” Charlie replied, “Being questioned. I’ve been working with the police, Joanne.”

“What?” everyone in the room said, almost in unison, apart from Tommy and Sharon.

“The cops approached Tommy and me,” he continued. “Yes, if you haven’t guessed, Tommy and I are together. We’re both bisexual. We always have been. Tommy protected me because he was in love with me. He protected Joanne because he knew I was in love with her. A few years after I told him to hide, I looked him up and well.. you know. Anyway, the police contacted Tommy a while ago after Bill got out. They’d information about a job he was planning, a big heist on the biggest jewellery warehouse in the north of England. He’s also been involved in drug dealing and money laundering since he got out but this was the one they wanted to pin on him. The key to it all was Frank. The cops suspected that if they let Frank out and he joined up with Bill, that’d give Bill the last piece of the puzzle he needed to attempt the job. He needed Frank’s organisational skills and brains. So they let Frank out early but the problem was how to get Frank and Bill together.”

“Luckily, Bill took Frank’s stash,” I said, then stopped, putting two and two together.

“I took Frank’s stash,” Charlie confirmed what I’d just realised. “I’ve still got it. Bill lied. I knew he would. He needed leverage to get Frank onside, I think. Or it could just have been a way of getting into your panties.”

“Either way, it worked,” Jo sighed, letting her head slump back onto the bed. “Very clever, Charlie. So what now? Are the cops going to turn up and arrest us all?”

“No,” Charlie replied. “How did you two end up like this? Did Frank and the others force you into...?”

Jo shook her head. “No,” she replied, her cheeks turning red.

“Ah, I see. You always were the kinky one, Joanne. You haven’t changed,” Charlie laughed then checked his phone as it beeped in his pocket. He read the message and smiled. “The police were waiting for them and got them all. They’re all in custody. It’s over.”

“Poor Frank,” Jo said softly. “Bill and the others I couldn’t give a shit about, but Frank... He’s not all bad, you know?”

“Don’t worry,” Charlie sympathised. “Frank is only going to get a short sentence for conspiracy. The others though, they’re facing a good stretch. Bill and his little gang have been getting their hands dirty for some time. This operation was just so the cops could get their hands on them. Bill, Alfie, Beth and Mack are going away for a long time. Frank will just get a couple of years.”

“You better run then,” Kathryn responded. “Because when Frank comes out, you’re going to be in deep shit.”

“All organised,” Charlie replied. “We’re getting on a plane tonight. I won’t tell you where because we don’t want anyone to know, especially someone as close to Frank as Joanne is, but it’s a long, long way away.”

“Why are you doing this?” I asked. “Why would you help the police?”

“Frank wanted to kill me,” Tommy answered. “I know I dropped him in it, but still, he sent Charlie to kill me. I could never forgive him for that.”

“And I always hated Bill,” Charlie shrugged. “He’s an arrogant slimy asshole. Plus, the police have made it worth our while. Immunity and a new identity. How could I refuse a new life with the man I love?”

He and Tommy shared a look which made me want to cover my nudity. They were both bisexual. I hadn’t seen that coming.

“So now can you set us free?” Jo asked for what felt like the hundredth time.

“In a moment,” Sharon replied. “There’s just one little thing I want to do while I’ve caught you both so... inconvenienced.”

The gorgeous blonde walked over to me, her vivid green eyes looking me up and down.

“What are you up to, Sharon?” Jo asked from the bed.

“You fucked my boyfriend behind my back,” Sharon replied, not taking her eyes off me. “Charlie, can I have that key?”

Charlie walked over and passed her the small key that I recognised as the one that opened the chastity cage padlock. “Frank gave it to me yesterday for safekeeping,” he said with a wink.

“Sharon,” Jo said in a warning tone. “What are you doing?”

“I just want to get my own back,” the woman replied, putting the key in the lock and turning it. As she carefully opened it and took it off, I felt a fantastic sense of relief. When they’d told me that Frank had been arrested, I was worried that I’d end up having to go to the hospital to get it cut off or something. How embarrassing would that have been?

“Thank you,” I said to the woman who was staring at me with her full lips in a gentle upwards curve.

“You’re welcome,” she replied then she turned to Jo. “After being with Frank and his big cock, I wouldn’t have expected you to end up with someone this small, but whatever.” Then she dipped her head down and took me in her mouth.

“Oh, my god,” Kathryn said and I saw her turn away with a smirk. “Brad, you shouldn’t see this.”

“I think we’ll go and wait outside too,” Tommy said, taking Charlie by the arm and walking him out of the bedroom.

Sharon sucked my cock, working her full lips up and down it expertly. It felt so fucking good but all I could think of was Jo, who was watching in horror from the bed.

“This isn’t funny,” my wife shouted. “Sharon, stop. That’s my husband.”

“Danny was my boyfriend,” Sharon shrugged her indifference, then stood up and looked down at my cock, which was rock-hard and standing straight up. “That should do.”

Then she undid her jeans and slid them down, along with her panties. Her pussy was as perfect-looking as the rest of her, immaculately waxed with just a thin landing-strip of light brown pubes. She turned around and slowly sat down, guiding my dick inside her until she was fully impaled on me.

Jo didn’t say anything but the look she had on her face was one that radiated fury.

“Sharon, stop,” I said, for my wife’s sake.

“Not until you’ve cum inside me,” the woman replied, riding up and down my cock. I tried not to cum, but the events of last night; seeing Jo get fucked by four different men; seeing Beth’s gorgeous young body get fucked by both her boyfriend and Bill; even seeing Kathryn get screwed by almost all the men in the room; it had all had such an effect on me that being ridden by this gorgeous woman in front of me was too much.

I came.

“Oooh, that’s it, Simon,” Sharon grinned victoriously at Jo. “Give me all that cum.”

When my dick finished twitching inside her, she finally stood and pulled her panties and jeans back up, then leaned forward and kissed me. I

immediately pulled away from the kiss the moment our lips touched, but she still seemed satisfied that she'd managed to steal a kiss as well as my cum.

"Nice to meet you, Simon. Goodbye, Jo. We're even now," she said, turning away and walking out of the door. Then we heard her shout, "Come on, Bradley. We're going home."

Kathryn walked into the room, going over to Jo first and undoing her restraints before doing the same for me. Jo sat up, rubbing her wrists and ankles. "That fucking bitch," she said, looking over at me. "I can't believe she just did that."

"I couldn't stop her," I said, trying to rub the circulation back into my hands and standing up slowly because my back was really stiff and sore from being sat in the same position all night.

"Your dick didn't put up much of a fight," Jo rolled her eyes. Was she mad at me? I couldn't tell.

"We're going now," Charlie said, walking back into the room. "Tommy and I have a flight to catch."

Tommy walked in too, picking up the briefcase and handing it to Jo, who was getting dressed. "What's this?" she asked after she'd pulled a t-shirt over her head.

"Your half of the stash," Charlie replied. "I hope you don't mind, but Tommy and I have kept the other half to help us set up in our new home. There's plenty to go around, I'm sure you'll agree."

With trembling hands, Jo popped open the catches on the case and opened it. Inside were twenty-pound notes. Hundreds of them. She looked at me, her eyes wide, then suddenly slammed the lid down as Zena walked back into the room.

"See you around," Charlie said as he and Tommy left.

"What's that?" Zena asked, pointing at the case.

"You don't want to know," I replied, putting my hands over my dick, suddenly aware that I was naked in front of the young woman without even the cage to partially cover me.

"And why were you tied to the chair?" she asked, then turned to Jo. "And you to the bed? I know you said you were having a party, but if I'd known it was *that* sort of party, I wouldn't have minded an invite."

I stared at the young woman. "Really? What...?"

“I’m kidding,” Zena said and I laughed, all the tension suddenly draining from me. Kathryn laughed too but Jo was still solemn-faced, angry at what had happened between Sharon and me. “Shall I make you some breakfast or something? If you’ve been tied up all night, you must be hungry and thirsty,” the young barmaid suggested and when we nodded, she went downstairs, leaving the three of us alone for a moment.

“Is it over now?” Jo asked softly as I wrapped my dressing gown around myself, the one Frank had worn last night.

“I think so,” I replied, tying the belt around my waist.

“Shame,” Kathryn said, in her squeaky voice. “I was rather enjoying myself.”

That finally made Jo laugh. “If I’m honest, I was too,” she giggled.

The two women looked at me, waiting for me to say something.

“What?” I said, wondering what they wanted me to say.

“Didn’t you enjoy last night?” Jo asked quietly.

I thought about it for a moment before answering. It was stressful and more intense than I’d liked, but if she was asking if I enjoyed the eroticism of watching her with other men, the only honest answer to that was yes.

“Let’s just say it was a hell of a party,” I said diplomatically. “Now let’s go downstairs and have breakfast.”

The two female best friends looked at each other and giggled. “He enjoyed it,” Kathryn said.

“He definitely did,” replied my wife, taking my hand and leading me downstairs.

Epilogue

“You’re always on that thing,” I said to Kathryn who was sitting on the other side of the bar while I finished stocking up the fridges ready for the day ahead. She was on her phone and had been constantly texting someone the whole time she’d been here.

“I’m messaging Brad,” Kath glanced up at me, before immediately returning her eyes to the screen. “He’s so excited that I’m visiting him, rather than the other way around.”

In the past year since Bill and his gang had been sentenced to prison for ten years, Kathryn and Brad had become an item; even though it was a long-distance relationship due to Brad deciding to go back to university to retrain for a ‘proper’ job. Sharon had trouble accepting it at first because of the age gap, but she saw that Kathryn made Bradley happy, so she eventually relented and the two had been seeing each other every few weeks. Brad usually came up to Manchester and stayed with her for the weekends, but this time Kathryn was visiting him and staying at his student flat in London for the first time.

“I hope you’re not sending him dirty messages while talking to me,” I chuckled, putting the final few beers in, making sure they were turned ‘label-facing-forwards’ and closing the fridge door.

“I might be sending him a naughty photo or two,” Kathryn replied with a half-smile. “Doesn’t hurt to whet his appetite. You want to see?”

“Go on them,” I said, standing up and leaning over to look at her phone.

“I was joking!” the curvy blonde said, turning her phone away quickly before I could get a glimpse.

“I’m ready,” said Jo, as she finally reappeared after going for a shower over an hour ago.

“You’ve been ages,” Kathryn pointed out, finally putting her phone away into her handbag. “You look nice though.”

“I want to impress him as much as I did last time,” Jo replied, doing a twirl to show off the sexy pink dress she was wearing. The low v-neck offered an eye-watering view of her creamy cleavage and the mid-thigh length showed a tantalising amount of leg. “Do you think he’ll like it?”

“He’ll love it,” I said honestly. Her dark hair was down, the curly ringlets cascading over her shoulders beautifully and her make-up was perfect. “He better anyway, with the amount of time it’s taken you to get ready.”

“Shall we get on the road then?” Kathryn said, looking at the time on the clock above the bar. “I told Brad I’d be there mid-afternoon.”

“Yes, I want to get checked in to the hotel as soon as I can for when Frank comes over,” Jo said, walking over to me to give me a kiss. Frank had only gotten a light sentence, unlike the others. Charlie had somehow worked that out as part of the deal he had with the police. During his time inside, he’d written constantly to Jo and she’d written back and then a couple of months ago, he’d been allowed on his first day release and they’d met up in a nearby hotel for sex. I was happy for her to do it. Since that fateful night I’d spent tied to a chair in our bedroom, our sex life had taken off. The memories of what had happened drove us both crazy with lust and we agreed that we wanted to do something like that again. While that hadn’t happened yet, she’d spoken to me about seeing Frank for sex again in the future and at that first opportunity, they’d done it, spending a full day together and having sex four times. She’d come home the following day with a sore and swollen pussy and several horny photos to show me on her phone.

“Don’t forget, you’re supposed to be videoing it for me this time,” I reminded her as she kissed me on the cheek and then followed Kathryn over to the door.

“I’ll video some of it,” she said. “I want to enjoy getting fucked, not have to worry about camera angles and stuff but I’ll see what I can do.”

Then she left, setting off for her second ‘conjugal’ visit, as Frank had described it on his application for day releases to the authorities. Jo wasn’t still his wife, she had been once, but they didn’t know any of that. I felt my dick twitch in my shorts at the thought of what they’d be getting up to in the hotel that Jo had booked in just a couple of hours.

“Morning,” Zena said, breezing into the bar a few minutes after Jo and Kathryn had left.

“Hey you,” I smiled at the gorgeous young barmaid as she walked over and joined me behind the bar. “You’re early. You’re not due on the bar until lunchtime.”

“Well,” she said, wrapping her mocha-coloured arms around my neck and drawing me forward for a kiss. “I thought we could chill out for an hour in bed before we open up?”

Zena knew everything, including Jo’s visits with Frank for sex. She’d probably been waiting outside for Kathryn and Jo to leave. Jo knew about Zena and I and was cool with me having some extra-marital fun too, as long as I kept it discreet.

“An hour in bed sounds good,” I smiled as Zena unbuttoned her top and opened it to reveal that she wasn’t wearing a bra underneath. Her brown handful-sized tits looked amazing, her dark chocolate coloured nipples called out for me to suck them. “I don’t know about the ‘chill’ bit.”

“Haven’t you heard the expression ‘Netflix and chill’?” Zena giggled, taking me by the hand and leading me upstairs. “Let me show you what ‘chill’ means to my generation.”

As soon as we reached the bedroom, the rest of her clothes came off - as did mine - and then she started to show me exactly what she was talking about by taking my cock in her mouth.

I set the alarm clock on the bedside table to go off in an hour and then laid back, enjoying the blow job before eventually returning the favour by going down on Zena’s pretty little shaven pussy.

After we’d done fucking and I’d emptied my balls inside the young barmaid, I pulled her into my arms and felt her fall asleep against my chest. I didn’t sleep. I just looked up at the ceiling, waiting for the alarm to buzz while wondering how the hell I had gotten so lucky.

Life was good. All I had to figure out next was how Zena and I were going to tell Jo about the baby.

A Note to the Reader

I just wanted to say thank you very much for purchasing my book, and reading it right to the end! At least I hope you did, and that you didn't just skip forward!

By purchasing the book, you're helping to support me in writing future novels - make sure you follow me on my social media channels and website or join my mailing list (you get a free book!) to stay updated about those future projects.

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Thanks again, for buying and reading my books, it's really appreciated!

Until next time, Paul

About the Author

Paul Garland is an author of erotic novels and short stories, guaranteed to keep you turning the lust-filled pages until the early hours of the night. He lives with his wife and two children in a small house in the suburbs of Sheffield, England along with a lazy green budgerigar, an African Grey parrot that curses and a tubby tabby cat which would love to eat either. (Preferably the vulgar-tongued parrot.) He has been writing since the turn of the millennium but only turned to the erotica genre in 2018 with his *Cerulean Erotica Presents* series and *No Angels* series of books which rapidly gained him a following. In 2020, he began 'The Cuckold Collection,' a brand new collection of cuckold-themed books and two new series of shorter stories: *The No Angels Stories* and *The Sexy Season Shorts* and has yet another as-yet-untitled series in the works for 2021.

His website is [here](#). It's got his blog and a link to all of his books.

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